THE BIBLE AND BAPTISM

HARRY BULTEMA

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by Harry Bultema

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Foreword

Buried within the hidden hollows of my father's heart, was always a deep desire to present the message of God's grace through the printed ministry. This was the seed that set him to work in extensive research on the great doctrine of baptism.

He was given further impetus by the confusion in Christendom regarding this cardinal Bible subject. His burden was to spotlight from God's Word the warning against clinging to the "divers baptisms" and to set forth the blessedness of being submerged into the Lord Jesus Christ by the one great baptism.

After many years of prayerful pondering, his efforts came to fruition, for in May, 1952, this work was published in mimeographed form. In September, 1952, Pastor Bultema was taken from a long, fruitful ministry, and was ushered into the presence of his blessed Redeemer, whom he dearly loved and longed to see.

The first bound edition of *Bible and Baptism* was published in 1955. We are humbled to know that God in His goodness has graced the ministry of this book. Now that the supply of the first edition is exhausted, we find a continuing demand and GRACE PUBLICATIONS is privileged to produce this second edition.

May the Holy Spirit, who has inseparably baptized us into the Lord Jesus Christ, instill within our hearts an ever-increasing desire for the deep truths of His Word, and for a living, vibrant love for our wonderful Saviour.

Daniel C. Bultema

A NOTE OF APPRECIATION

We express our gratitude to

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Introduction

The great Bible student, John Nelson Darby, was asked what he held in regard to Baptism, and he dryly answered, "My mouth." Several late Bible scholars who taught throughout the land, studiously followed this example of Darby. Not one of our great Bible Institutes seems to have mustered enough courage to state boldly their creedal stand in this matter, and even in many seminaries the trumpet does not give a certain sound in regard to this grand doctrine of the Bible.

However, the Bible speaks often about it, and in no uncertain tones, and it is, therefore, incumbent upon every Christian, and especially upon every Christian teacher, to give a "thus saith the Lord" about this truth. To dodge the issue and be silent as to God's will in this matter is cowardly, and to teach against God's will is worse still. Protestantism has maintained for four centuries against Romanism that the Word of God is a light and that believers are sufficiently illuminated by the Spirit of God to have a clear grasp of every doctrine of the Word, if they prayerfully study the Scriptures.

In the light of history, and of every day experience, we find four widely different estimates of baptism. First, the ancient and most universal view of baptismal regeneration, held by Romanism, Lutheranism, Anglicanism, and by several small sects. A second view, also ancient, pronounces baptism the necessary test of membership in the Church. Only adults should be immersed upon the declaration of their faith in Christ. This is the view of ten million Baptists in our land and perhaps five million beyond our borders. This view abhors the other view. Third, Paedo-baptism regards baptism as the initiatory sign and seal of the covenant of grace, obligating the young lives to a life of obedience to God. This view generally holds that baptism has come in the place of circumcision, and it conscientiously regards the first two views as erroneous. In the fourth place, there have always been some like the Quakers who do not regard baptism as an ordinance for this age, and this view contests the other three views. It is historically incorrect to think that the Quakers were the only sect holding this last view for there have been, in the course of history, numerous groups who did not regard baptism as meant for this age. Good and godly men like Roger Williams, Johan De Liefde and H. P. Scholte, the founder of Pella, Iowa, came to the same conviction.

Of all the grand doctrines of the Bible, baptism is in Christendom the most shunned, the most misunderstood, misconstrued and misapplied. What can be the cause of this strange confusion? God's Word is a light, a revelation and every true believer has the enlightening Holy Spirit as the abiding guest. This confusion in Christendom becomes all the more grotesque, when we remember that God has focused and safeguarded this doctrine as no other, by saying that we should leave the doctrine of baptisms, Heb. 6:1, 2, in order to cleave to the one baptism of Eph. 4:4, 5.

The cause of this confusion lies mainly in the identification of Israel and the Church. Although the Bible clearly teaches the vast difference between the earthly and the heavenly people, Protestantism has almost *"in toto"* followed Romanism in this identification and so has taken over the legal ritualisms of God's earthly people Israel.

The following brief research is the result of years of pondering and study of the Scriptural doctrine of baptism. In the early years of his ministry this writer sprinkled five hundred babies. When he, for conscience sake, quit this practice, dear brethren of Baptist persuasion assured him that they were praying that he might see the truth as to baptism and join their ranks, and this was greatly appreciated and he himself prayed earnestly that he might come to know and do God's will in this matter, and the result was that he gradually came to the profound conviction that Christianity at large does not know the mind of the Lord in this matter.

The modern philosopher, John Dewey, has said in one of his books that this age suffers from "The blight of externalism" and this is true also of Christianity. The grand truth, that we have been made eternally one with the risen Lord by means of a baptism made without hands and without any element, so clearly taught in the Pauline Epistles, has been well nigh completely lost in Christendom. Because of the false identification of the Church with Israel, the true identification of the Church with the glorified Lord was not appreciated. In fact, the two are mutually exclusive.

Fundamentalism was forty years ago a Spirit-led movement for the truth of the Blessed Hope and kindred truth, but it soon became evident that it did not progress toward the profound truth of our identification with Christ, through the one glorious baptism, and it became clear all too soon that there was no whole-hearted cooperation of all the brethren who trembled at the majesty of the Word; and that this great movement did not have the corrective for the fanaticism that spread through evangelical Christianity like a prairie fire.

If this brief study should become instrumental in leading some soul deeper into the truth of our unbreakable union with the risen Lord and to a greater loyalty of life and labor for Him, our task would be richly rewarded. He who searches the hearts knows that the purpose of this study was not to fight any group of brethren, but to earnestly contend for the truth of the one exalted baptism that submerged us into the Lord Jesus Christ forever.

The verbal and plenary inspiration of the original manuscripts is the doctrinal basis of this historical and exegetical study. May He who has exalted His Word above all His name richly bless it! Nothing but love for the truth has actuated us to write, and we like to remind at the outset that truth is not to be decided by majorities, but by what God says in His Word. The writer is not striving merely to prove a point or ride a religious hobby, but to expound a most profound and consolatory truth all too long neglected.

Harry Bultema

Muskegon, Michigan

May 1, 1962

CHAPTER I

The Baptisms in the Old Testament

It has been doubted that there was any baptism under the old covenant, but a brief look at the facts can quickly decide this question. In fact, Heb. 9:10 is sufficient proof in this matter. Here the apostle speaks of the imperfect sacrifices which could not make even the priestly servants perfect. Further he speaks of the Mosaic dietary laws and he says that they consisted *only* in meats and drinks. This "only" speaks a volume of truth. According to good manuscript authority the little connective word *and* should be dropped so that the expression *"carnal ordinances" is* an explanatory opposite of the ancient sacrifices and dietary laws. But the characterization of only *"carnal ordinances"* applies also to the *"divers baptismoi,"* put immediately after the meats and drinks. Here the truth is divinely stated that there were baptisms, various baptisms in the age of the law economy. For dogmatical and practical reasons the commentators as a rule hastily assure us that these baptisms were the ancient Levitical purifications. Good, but then we know for sure that these Levitical ablutions were essentially baptisms. God says so and this should be the end of all contradiction. We shall presently see that there were divers or various baptisms. Since we do not keep the *carnal* ordinances of Israel, that is the ordinances for the bodies and for other external and material matters, there is positively no reason whatsoever why we should keep these baptisms in whatever form they may come. These baptisms are on a par with the dietary laws and this gives food for thought.

The word *imposed is* a legal term and not a grace term. The various baptisms were hung like a hard yoke upon the neck of those who were under the law, Rom. 6:14. According to Peter the law was a yoke which neither the forefathers nor their offspring were able to bear. It was an intolerable yoke. History has abundantly proved that water baptism in its various forms has had the same harsh effect as the law; often working wrath and bringing believers in servitude to rules and forms, all in opposition to the liberty in Christ and to the freedom of God's wondrous grace in Christ, while it often divides the true believers.

We are emphatically told that these dietary laws and baptisms were imposed on *them,* i.e. on the Hebrews. God gave His law to Israel and to Israel only. The council of Jerusalem in Acts 15 is very careful not to lay the heavy yoke of the law upon the neck of the Gentile saints. God gave the law to his peculiar people that He had led out of Egypt, as He puts on the foreground in the introductory statement of the Decalogue (Ex. 20). The added rubbish of the Jews to the law of baptisms, did not undo the fact that these baptisms were imposed by the great Lawgiver Himself. These baptisms were designed to purify the *flesh* of the Jewish worshipers, Heb. 9:9, 10, 13, 14. After Calvary they are called the beggarly elements of the world.

We are also told that these baptisms as carnal ordinances were but *for a time.* The termination is clearly given. They were imposed on the Hebrews "until the time of *reformation."* Reformation always presupposes *deformation. I*srael's sins brought great deformation, distortion and contortion. An upright man like Nathanael was evidently a happy exception in the decadent times of our Saviour. A general

rectification, a setting straight of things was badly needed. Christ came to bring about a divine reformation. By his messages and miracles and above all by his redemption, he reformed, retrieved and recovered Israel to the extent that he formed a marvelous remnant according to the election of grace in the midst of the Nation that rejected him. The little word *until* warns us that Christ did not start baptism, but ended it as belonging to Moses.

These ancient carnal ordinances could not be an ordinance for the Body of Christ, the Church, since we are expressly told that these ordinances were *abolished* for us, Eph. 2:15; *blotted* out, Col. 2:14. When we, nevertheless, subject ourselves to these ordinances, then we act as though we were living in the world, Col. 2:20. With ordinances there is ever the categorical must of the law, and this never goes with the Body of Christ. There we are exhorted, admonished, and besought but not put under the law. Remember, worldliness and the subjection to ordinances are for Paul essentially the same thing.

At the time of our Lord, baptism was a familiar rite to the Jews. When the Jews came from the market where they had rubbed elbows with some Gentiles and had defiled themselves, they would not take a meal *"except they baptize,"* Mark 7:3, 4. The Pharisee, at whose table Jesus reclined, marveled that he had not first *baptized* before dinner, Luke 11:38. The Pharisees did not challenge John's right to baptism but rather his authority to call all the nation to his baptism, seeing he was neither the Messiah nor his forerunner, the prophet Elijah.

That these various baptisms were well known to Israel is of supreme importance since it interestingly clarifies the fact, which made so many wonder, that we have no instruction as to the form of baptism. God had of old given accurate instructions as to the form, and he did not need to repeat these for the simple reason that Israel had known them for nearly two thousand years. Baptisms were sprinklings to purify.

When we go to the ancient baptisms, then we find not a single ordinance for the immersion of any person whether great or small. We can lay it down as a safe axiom that the person was never applied to the element, but the element whether blood, oil or water was invariably applied to man, or to a part of man. This rule is corroborated by the fact that in all the wealth of figurative language in Scripture we find many figures of sprinkling, ablution and affusions, to picturize the methods of God's purifications, but never any figure of immersion, neither in the Old or New Testament. Tradition may find many immersions, but sound exegesis finds not one. Dr. Carson is dead sure that the divers baptisms of Heb. 9:10 include immersion and exclude sprinkling, but he fails to give any valid proof for his assertion and an assertion without proof is an assumption.

In the first great passover sacrifice the blood was sprinkled on three places, on the lintels and on the two doorposts of the houses. From that day on the sprinkling became, in Israel, the standing emblem of the application of the blood of deliverance. This is true to such an extent that even the blood of Christ is called the blood of *sprinkling,* Heb. 9:9-14, 19-28.

When Israel was organized into a separate nation with its own constitution, or ground-law, it was signified, symbolized and sealed with the blood of sprinkling. There are two words in Hebrew that denote sprinkling. *Garak* occurs thirty-five times, and is

so rendered except in Isa. 28:25, where it is translated *scatter,* while in II Chron. 34:4, we find it as *strew,* but in both passages the word *sprinkle* could have been used. In Hos. 7:9 it refers to the gray hairs *sprinkled* on the head; but in regard to the application of the blood this word is used invariably, Ex. 24:6, 8; 29:16, 20; Lev. 1:5, 11; 3:2, 8, 13; 7:2, 14; 8:19, 24; 9:12, 18; 17:6; Num. 18:17; II Kings 16:13, 15; II Chron. 29:22; 30:16; 35:11. It is also used of the water of separation that had to be applied by sprinkling, Num. 19:13,20. In the future national baptism of Israel this sprinkling will be again the divine method, Ezek. 36:25.

Where *Garak* denotes more the dispersing, scattering and spreading abroad of a wide sprinkling or aspersion the word *Nazah,* occurring twenty-four times, denotes a more focused sprinkling upon one definite object. In the Septuagint it is rendered *rhaino,* whence our *rain,* and *rhantizo,* which also means *sprinkle,. Nazah is* invariably translated *sprinkle,* and is used of all the three liquids in the tabernacle, the oil, blood and water. We know that the blood is ever the type of the blood of our Saviour, the oil of the Spirit, and the water of the purifying power of the Word and of the Spirit in his purifying power with the Word. The sea water with its incessant roar, its restlessness, its monsters, and its dangers, is an emblem of the evil world powers; whereas the dew, and the rain and the fountains of living water emblematize the Holy Spirit and His refreshing and purifying operations.

There are also several words that denote various washings with water.

Duak, found only four times in II Chr. 4:6; Isa. 4:4; Jer. 51:34; and Ezek. 40:38. This word implies the washing more than it expresses it. Our *duck* and the Dutch *duik* are apparently derivatives.

Shataph means to pour water over the surface; to rinse, Lev. 6:28; 15:11, 12; Ezek. 13:11-14 and it never means immersion, but a thorough washing. Hands were washed by pouring water upon them.

Kabas, to tread, trample, denotes the art of the ancient fuller who fulled or washed his goods by trampling upon them on riverside or at some brooklet or stream. It occurs forty-six times with this uniform sense. David used it figuratively twice in Ps. 51:2, 7, *wash* me.

Rachats is used over seventy times of the washing of the surface in a self-washing of the body, notably the hands and the feet. The word is used of the washing in water exclusively.

Jaher is used more than 20 times for cleansing. It is the same as *Katharizo* and never is immerse.

The word *baptizo is* used with the greatest latitude in secular and sacred writings. Over thirty different shades of meanings have been gathered, but these can be reduced to three main senses as follows: In classic usage to use the words of Canon Girdlestone, in his *Synonyms of the Old Testament, Baptize is* a dyer word and signifies *to dip so as to color.* When some older versions spoke of John the *dipper,* or *dooper,* they gave only the literal rendering of the classic meaning. In the Old Testament the word *baptism* stands for all the ceremonial sprinklings, pourings and washings, as is abundantly proved by a reference to Heb. 6:2 and 9:10. Thirdly, we find

in the Pauline writings an entirely different use of this word. Here the word means *a submerging so as never to emerge,* hence identification, and that with the crucified and risen Lord.

We were baptized *into* Jesus Christ, Rom. 6:3.

We were baptized *into* his death, Rom. 6:3, 4.

All the Israelites were baptized *into* Moses, I Cor. 10:2.

We have been baptized *into* Christ, Gal. 3:27.

Here the many baptisms have gone while this one baptism is left, Eph. 4:5.

We are entombed together with Christ in that great Calvary baptism, Col. 2:12.

In view of this grand and glorious baptism we are exhorted to leave the ancient water baptisms in order to cleave to this one magnificent baptism, Heb. 6:1, 2; Eph. 4:5. The picture is as clear as the sun.

When the historical Church failed to get this distinction between the ancient water baptisms and this grand identification-baptism, she lost, at the same time, her greatest proof for eternal security. It is mainly because of this that even now throughout the length and breadth of the land God's dear children violently debate the question whether a child of God can be lost forever. A right grasp of Pauline baptism would go a long way to obviate all this needless debate, since all saints have been baptized, submerged, into Christ.

There is just one immersion in the Old Testament and this is found in Lev. 11:32, where it speaks of unclean things that must be put *into the water* and be unclean until the evening. This passage is of great interest to show - A. that it refers to things and not to persons; B. that when immersion is intended it is so clearly expressed that it cannot be misunderstood; C. that the immersion was not just for a moment or a triune immersion for three moments, but for a day *until the evening; D.* that it was for the purpose of making the unclean clean; E. that immersion was purely ritual; F. and that immersion was for God's earthly people Israel. The conclusion is unavoidable and impregnable that immersion of one person by another person was entirely unknown to Israel. The modern rite in this form finds no proof or precedent in the ancient scriptures.

The Old Testament knows a future baptism and this will be by sprinkling, Isa. 52:13-15; Ezek. 36:24-27. The Septuagint renders Isa. 52:13-15 *astonish,* but it is evidently the astonishment of the sprinkling, for it will be a unique and unprecedented sprinkling of the Holy Spirit. He will sprinkle the clean water that flows from the throne of God, i.e. the Holy Spirit, upon all flesh, Joel 2:28, Acts 2:17 with the astonishing result that Israel and the nations and even the animal life of land and sea and sky become filled with the Spirit. In that day the so-called great commission of Matt. 28:19, 20 will be fulfilled. This is the future Spirit baptism.

It is of prime importance to see that the ancient baptisms by sprinkling had their commencement at the time that Israel was made at Horeb, a Kingdom of priests and a holy nation. Baptism is here just as in the New Testament connected with Israel. It is in its commencement, character and culmination, thoroughly Israelitish if the Word

of God is to be the final authority. The first time the word *baptizo is* used in the Septuagint is in the story of the cure of Naaman as related in II Kings 5:10, 14, where we read that he went down and *dipped* himself seven times; and our Baptist brethren have always made a strong argument out of this. Let us see what the facts in the case are.

The word upon which the argument hinges is *tabal,* which is rendered *"he dipped." Tabal* comes from the root *taba,* to sink, from which we get the words for baptism in all the West European languages: dip, the Dutch *doop,* the German *Taufe,* and the Scandinavian *Daabe. Tabal* occurs in all but fifteen times. By looking up the passages where it is used we can readily find the correct meaning of the word, that never can be a ceremonial washing of man.

Joseph's coat was *dipped* in the blood of a kid, Gen. 37:31

The priest's finger was *dipped* in blood, Lev. 4:6, 17; 9:9

The living bird was *dipped* in the blood of the slain bird, Lev. 14:6

The finger was *dipped* in oil, Lev. 14:16

The feet of the priests *dipped* in the brim of the water, Josh. 3:15

Ruth *dipped* her morsel in the vinegar, Ruth 2:14

Jonathan *dipped* the tip of his rod in honeycomb, I Sam. 14:27

Hazael *dipped* a cloth in water, II Kings 8:15 Yet thou wilt *plunge* me in the ditch, Job 9:30, 31

This word *tabal* is ordinarily translated *bapto* in the Septuagint. Its Chaldee equivalent is *tseba,* used thrice of Nebuchadnezzar, *wet* with the dew of heaven, Dan. 4:Z3, 25,33.

The passage that comes nearest to immersion is, however, II Kings 5:10, 14 where Naaman *dipped* into the Jordan. Gesenius gives this as the only example of *immerse,* but even if we would allow that Naaman was immersed, then there would be not even a shadow of proof for the immersion theory. But it is reasonably sure that Naaman did not immerse himself, when we consider the following facts.

1. The prophet told him to *wash*, and so Naaman understood it, and his servant also, II Kings 5:10, 12, 13.

2. It is inconceivable that a general and a leper at that, would have taken a dive in an extremely muddy and dangerous river with its strong currents.

3. It is still less conceivable that he would have taken a dive seven times in succession.

4. If Elisha had given the foreign field marshal an order to immerse seven times then he would here have openly flouted the Levitical law of purification for the leper. The leper had to wash himself and bathe his flesh, Lev. 14:7-9. This is what Elisha ordered according to law, and thus the general and his servant understood it.

5. If there were here an immersion, then it was a self-immersion or a se-baptism. These and other considerations make it certain that we have here a self-washing. The

word *rachats* is used in verse ten and this means wash. He did exactly as the prophet had told him, he washed himself seven times to symbolize that the God of Israel, who alone does wondrous things, gave him a perfect cure. If he had been immersed, then this was without authority of the law and without any example in the Word, without congruity as to the law of purification, and without any motive or explanation why the washing of the leper was here disregarded and suspended.

CHAPTER II

Baptism in the Apocryphal Books

In many old Lutheran and Reformed Bibles the so-called Apocrypha - meaning, "hidden away," secret in contrast to God's revealed will, - was placed separately with the following heading: "Here are the books which are numbered by the ancients among the biblical writings and which are not found in the Hebrew Canon .... It is true that they are not to be despised, inasmuch as they contain good and useful teaching. At the same time, it is very right that what was given by the Holy Spirit should have preeminence above what came from men." The famed Synod of Dort held in 1618, made the strongest plea for complete elimination of these books, but were not entirely successful. As late as 1827, the British and Foreign Bible Society finally decided to completely exclude them from the Bible and from this date on, the Protestants have not published them as part of a Bible, and now all the new versions except the Catholic, ignore them. The Council of Trent decided in 1546 that the Apocrypha are an essential part of the Word of God and anathematized all who would question the validity of that decree. Now the Knights of Columbus, through strong advertisements accuse the Protestants of having an incomplete and mutilated Bible and many are more or less perplexed on reading or hearing this. However, the Protestants had sufficient reasons for rejecting these books as uncanonical and uninspired. They are superstitious and teach that devils can be expelled by the smoke of the heart of a fish or a little piece of it, Tobias 6:5, 7, 8. Christ taught it was in his name that Satan was cast out, Mark 16:17. This is what Peter practiced in Acts 3:1-8, 16 and also Paul in Acts 16:18.

They teach salvation by works as alms, fasting, etc., Tobias 12:8, 9, Ecclesiasticus 3:33. Sins are pardoned by prayer, Ecclesiasticus 3:4. In II Maccabees 12:43-46 we find prayers for the dead *"that they may be loosed from sins"*; this implies purgatory and the doctrine of a second chance, with praying for the dead - not less than three serious errors.

They teach temporal torments, where there is a "hope full of immortality," Wisdom 3:1-4. This doctrine of purgatory became to Rome the greatest source of revenue, as a Catholic priest, sailing through the Suez Canal, said to a Protestant missionary, "The Suez Canal is for England what purgatory is for us, the greatest source of revenue."

In Tobias 5:15-19 the angel Raphael tells a brazen falsehood. There is in Judith 8:5, 6 a woman that fasts all the days of her life except a Sabbath! Judith 9:2 praises the Lord for the sword of vengeance against strangers. Original sin is denied and immaculate conception is taught in Wisdom 8:19, 20 and this is not wise but otherwise. In flat contradiction to our holy Bible, they teach mercilessness and cruelty, Ecclesiasticus 12:6. It is no wonder then that the Catholic church uses these books in order to substantiate its unscriptural system.

A detailed study of these books goes to show that they have contributed enormously to the darkness of historical Christendom in doctrinal and ethical matters, and they have also contributed their share to a wrong concept of Biblical baptism. Ecclesiasticus, or The Wisdom of Jesus the son of Sirach, was written by a priest of Jerusalem about 200

B. C. His name was Joshua ben Sira ben Eliezer. The book has been always held in high esteem by Jews and Christians, but we saw above that it teaches some errors. Though some Talmudists and the Catholic Church thought it worthy of a place in the holy canon, the Spirit of God through a special providence has deprived it rightly of that place.

An instructive proverb on baptism is found in Ecclesiasticus 31:30, where we read: "He that is baptized from the dead and again touches the dead, what availeth his washing?" The reference is here to the water of *nidda,* separation, of Num. 19 to which Heb. 9:13 also alludes. This was given to Israel as a perpetual statute for cleansing from contamination contracted mainly through tactual defilement from the dead. A red and perfect young heifer upon which no yoke had ever come, was to be slain without the camp. The priest had to take the blood with his fingers and sprinkle toward the tabernacle seven times. Thereupon the whole animal was to be burned with cedarwood, hyssop and scarlet. When the offering was consumed by the flames, the ashes were to be laid up in a clean place. These ashes mixed with clean water were used as the waters of *nidda* for cleansing of the defiled. The word *nidda* occurs twenty-three times. Its fundamental idea is banishment, exclusion or separation. Cain's *Nod is* of the same root meaning. Those who were defiled, especially from contact with the dead, were banished, separated, from God. Five times in Num. 19 this water is called the water of *nidda,* separation, and once in Num. 31:23. Christ's blood is the fountain for sin and for *nidda,* Zech. 13:1. Israel's whorings were before God as *nidda,* Ezek. 36:17. *Nidda is* then sin's exile, sin's *Nod;* but God will purify Israel by means of the real antitypical sprinkling.

The proverb in Ecclesiasticus now calls this sprinkling a baptism and a washing. The writer acknowledges that the sprinkling of Num. 19 was the divine method of cleansing. This water of *nidda* was designed for the defilements which lasted seven days, and it was ordained for all classes and for all times. Hence we find that it was in full use two centuries before Christ. Cleansing from contact with a dead body is called baptism also in Ecclesiasticus 34:25.

It is most interesting to note that it is in Ecclesiasticus 31:30 called a baptism not only, but a *"baptism from the dead."* The thought is here of the tactual defilement from the dead, while the sprinkling of the water of *nidda is* here called the baptism from the dead. But this sprinkling is here also called *washing.* Hence we see that both sprinkling and washing were regarded as a baptism. It was unquestionably one of the divers baptisms of Heb. 9:10. The selfwashings are never called purifyings, but they are called baptisms. The real purification came always from God and antitypically through Christ and His Word and Spirit. When David found himself leprous with sin, he cried, "Purge me with hyssop!" - where he alluded to the water of *nidda* and to this baptism from the dead.

Death, however, had no reference to natural death alone, but also to the spiritual death of the Gentiles before God, as appears from the story of Num. 31:12. The men of Israel had defeated the Midianites, but took the women to Israel's camp. Moses was *wroth* and had all the married women destroyed and the virgins left for Israel, but not until the water of *nidda* had been applied to these girls. By *baptism i.e.,* by sprinkling, they were incorporated into Israel. This story of the law shows that the Gentiles were

just as unclean as death itself and treated the same as those defiled by death. Death in Israel is always regarded as the wages of sin and as vile as sin.

Many commentators have thought, and correctly so, that Paul, in that most difficult text of I Cor. 15:29 was thinking with his baptism for the dead, of this proverb with its baptism from the dead. Paul regarded himself as a martyr in the hands of the unclean Jews and Gentiles, and he asks why he and his helpers should undergo all that if it were not for the resurrection from the dead. They could easily give up their body into vile hands and vile death, because they would soon get a new resurrection-body. He was regarded as defiled, but the waters of *nidda, i.e.,* separation from this body and from this natural life, were richly sprinkled over him and he called it with Jesus the son of Sirach, a *baptism,* as also our Lord had done in Matt. 20:22, 23. A violent death was baptism.

Orthodox Jews till our day, call a deceased person a *Bar Minan,* a son of separation; and we find no orthodox Jews as undertakers. Their washing of the dead body, as was done to the body of Dorcas, is still a baptism for the dead, going way back to Num. 19. When an orthodox Jew dies, the whole house is defiled and the Jewish purifications must be applied, though the Rabbis tell us that only nine red heifers have been slain by Israel up to the Babylonian Exile. But if the Hebrews have been delinquent as to their ordained baptisms, the Gentiles have made all the more of it till this day.

Another mention of baptism we find in the book of Judith 7:12-21; 12:5-8. We read in the latter passage that the heroine Judith, who delivered Israel, "went out nightly into the valley of Bethulia and *baptized* in the camp at the fountain of water."

Here was then a baptism, but the following should be noticed.

1. This baptism was performed statedly every night as a preparation for prayer. No one else would so baptize every night. Here was a constant *sebaptism* and *rebaptism.*

2. This baptism was *in* the camp and *at* the fountain, not in the fountain, as our immersionist friends seem to think.

3. Judith was a young and beautiful widow in the midst of a host of rough and rude soldiers, who held the fountain for their own water supply. It is entirely unthinkable that she could have there undressed and gotten under the water.

4. Immersionist writers cite the statement, that as she *went up,* she prayed; but we read of Rebekah that she went down to the well, and *went up,* Gen. 24:15, 16. The fountain of Bethulia lay in a valley and she naturally had to go up, but she did not immerse any more than Rebekah did.

5. It is quite evident that we find *baptism* here not as an obedience to the law, but as a superfluous work of self-righteousness. The self-imposed washings became oral law in Israel as we can see on many a page in the New Testament.

CHAPTER III

Baptism in the Talmud

In the Talmud we find the oral law and the traditions of the ancient Rabbis. The self-righteous spirit breathing in this vast work generally tends to an addition, aggravation and intensification of what God has said. If the law itself was a yoke which neither the fathers nor the children were able to bear, the Jewish scholars have made that yoke far more intolerable than it was. A proselyte means a stranger that becomes a convert to Judaism. The Talmud knows two kinds of proselytes: the proselyte of righteousness and the proselyte of the gate. Only the former became fully part and parcel of the Jewish nation; but there were three prerequisites for the incorporation: circumcision in the case of a male, baptism and a free will offering. According to the law, only the water of *nidda* had to be applied, and as we have seen, this was done by sprinkling, but true to their legalistic tendency of making the yoke heavier, the Jews translated the sprinkling by the word *tabal, dip,* and that in face of the fact that this word is never used by Moses to designate the purifying rites of any kind whatsoever. Yet the Talmudists fell in love with the word *tabal* in that it went a little deeper into the elements, whether water, oil or blood.

However, the *tabalinqs,* or baptisms, of the Talmud, were invariably self-performed se-baptisms, and never the act of an official administrator. The intrinsic religious value of the baptismal act was uniformly recognized by the ancient Jewish teachers, and also the efficacy of water as a cleansing fluid in religious matters. The proselyte, or *Ger,* stood disrobed in the water and was then instructed by a scribe in the precepts of the law. After having heard these, he plunged himself under water and when he came up again, he was an "Israelite in all things." The water rite had a certain mysterious and magical effect of renewal it was thought. A woman was attended by women, while the scribes stood at a distance and read the precepts of the law. And when she immersed herself, they turned away their faces and they left the scene on her emerging from the water.

This *sebaptism,* self-immersion, was purely an invention of the Jewish scribes for it is perfectly clear that it is wholly foreign to the law of Moses and consequently without divine warrant. The only element of truth found in them is the fact that a purifying with water was prescribed in the reception of the heathen proselytes. That this sprinkling of the water of *nidda* foreshadowed the purifying power of Christ and his Spirit and the future sprinkling or spirit baptism upon Israel and upon all flesh, was utterly hidden from the view of the Talmudists. After they lost the Temple and Jerusalem, they fastened themselves more fanatically than ever upon the Rabbinic accretions of the oral law. Not the obedient heart, but the religious legalistic feelings now spoke.

Their *tabalinqs* were the first immersions for religious purposes known in history, i.e. in the history of the ancient people. The immersions had their origin in unbelieving Israel after they had rejected their true God. *It can be laid down as a stated rule of history, that when men deny the power of godliness, they always cling all the more tenaciously to the forms.* Israel rejected not only the Messiah, but also all the Scriptures that typified

the Messiah and his Spirit, because the sprinkling of the water, blood and oil indubitably pointed to the application of the Messiah's blood and Spirit. In the sprinkling or pouring - which was only an abundant sprinkling - the recipients were passive, while in the self-immersion self-righteous man was active. The sprinkling picturized God's work who said: "I will pour water upon him that is thirsty . . . I will pour my Spirit upon their seed," Isaiah 44:3, 4 whilst the self-immersions were man's works of self-will and self-righteousness. The prescribed sprinkling and pouring in the law portrayed most beautifully man's total inability apart from heaven's might, whereas it set forth clearly, under the picture of the sprinkling or the pouring rain from heaven, God's omnipotent power and kindness for man on earth. The water from earth is always vile and germ-laden, whereas the water from heaven is running water, pure and germless, true emblem of God's Word and Spirit. Immersion under the water often makes the baptismal candidate feel uncomfortable for the moment, whereas the sprinkling, sparkling dew and rain in the East lavish the dry earth, quicken man and beast, soften the hard and sterile clods, while refreshing and fructifying all plant life.

It was, therefore, not merely incidental that disbelieving, Christ-rejecting Israel repudiated also God's method of symbolizing and typifying of the Messiah's work and blessing. Israel's self-immersions revealed the inherent logic of apostacy from the living God, for where God never used the figure of immersion and ever the symbol of the sprinkling or pouring rain from heaven, there man in his self-sufficiency and in the pride of his self-efforts clearly showed that he did not need heaven's help, but could make himself pure in God's sight by means of splashing in much water.

We have now seen that baptism was *imposed* as a legal yoke for Israel as part of the Levitical system of purification. There is in the law no immersion, nor even a figure of immersion, whereas the Scriptures abound with figures of sprinkling and pouring. There was only one immersion of objects slightly defiled, but never of persons, and there the language is unmistakably plain that the defiled thing was to be put *into* the water. With the sprinklings there were self-washings, but in the Septuagint and in Paul's language these were all designated baptisms. The gradation of these sprinklings and washings, their frequency, the scarcity of water and the circumscribed facilities in the East, all make it certain that there were no immersions. The ancient forms were only two: i.e. *aspersions* and *affusions*: but the Talmud made them *tabalings,* or immersions, and a good part of Christendom has followed the Talmud, not the Bible.

Besides the self-immersions the Talmud prescribed endless rules for the washing of the hands. In *Orach Chaiim* it says: "Let him wash his hands and pronounce the benediction for the washing of hands." This little precept gave rise to many disputes, for the law works wrath! - as to the *water,* as to the vessel containing the water, as to the measure of the water, as to the kind of water, as to the washer, as to the hands and as to the manner of the washing. *Hikhoth Mikvaoth* oracles states, "Everything that is an impediment in *baptism is* an impediment in the washing of hands" and now the question arose, what constituted an impediment? They found scores of impediments. Before and after the meals the hands must be washed. "All bread with salt in it requires a washing after the eating lest perhaps it might be the salt of Sodom" and this could make a man blind. A man had to wash his hands three times, "For an evil spirit rests upon the hands" *(Orach Chaiim).* The Rabbis of the Talmud were often unscrupulous and harsh in the

extreme. If a man had only enough water to drink, then he still had to use part of it for the washing of hands. Anyone who despised the washing of hands was guilty of excommunication *(Orach Chaiim* 158). They once excommunicated a man for this reason and they insulted him in his death by rolling a big stone on his coffin. *Sotah* followed four oracles: "Everyone who eats bread without washing of hands is as guilty as if he had committed fornication."

In one of their prayers they say: "Blessed art thou, O Lord our God! King of the universe! Who hast sanctified us and commanded us to wash our hands." Now this is a religious falsehood. God has never given to the people the precept of religious washing of the hands. This is a matter of cleanliness and common sense.

We see in Mark 7:1-23 that the contemporaries of our Lord had exactly the Talmudic notions of the washing of hands. The Lord elaborates there upon the truth already briefly stated by Samuel, that God does not (like man) look on the outward appearance, but on the heart, I Sam. 16:7. They did not know that to the pure all things were pure.

Strict orthodox and Talmudic Jews still regard the *Netilat Yadajun,* the washing of hands, as a most important ritual practice. On rising in the morning, before and after meals, before prayers, they religiously wash their hands. And all these endless rules and regulations, with condemnations, arose not merely from the fear that they might touch a dead fly or any other dead insect, but they were motivated by the well nigh universal desire to do something for God by means of the most universal element, water. They called these washings *baptisms.* However, the ancient Rabbis were superstitious men and they were also actuated by fear. When strictly traditional Jews awaken the children in the morning, they wash their eyes and finger tips for the Rabbis taught that the little demons are liable to cleave to the fingertips and should be washed off lest the child touch the eyes and these imps cause blindness.

We see therefore, why Simon wondered why Jesus did not first *baptize, ebaptisthe* before dinner, Luke 11:37-41. Also Mark 7:1-4 shows that this silly washing of hands is called a *baptism;* but they did not wash their hands in innocence like the Psalmist of Ps. 26:6.

It is interesting to note that, as all archeologists tell us, this washing of hands was in the East, not done in the same manner as we wash our hands today, but by sprinkling the running water upon the hands. The symbol of pouring is precious to God's heart as appears abundantly from the Scriptures. As the rain - so the word, Isa. 55:10. As the rain - so the baptism of the Spirit, Ezek. 36. God pours out his blessing, Mal. 3:10. Prayer is a pouring out of the soul, Job 30:16; Ps. 62:8. Grace is poured out on the lips of Messiah, Ps. 45:2. He pours out his Spirit, Prov. 1:23; Isa. 44:3; Joel 2:28; Acts 2:17. His name is an ointment poured forth, Cant. 1:3. Christ poured out his soul unto death, Isa. 53:12. In judgment his fury will be poured out like fire. But Christ-rejecting Israel was blind for this beautiful emblem of blessing and called it a *tabal,* or self-immersion.

Philo, the Jew, tried to combine the Mosaic law with Greek philosophy, but he showed, with all his indifference to the Prophetic Word, nevertheless a vital interest in the *loutron,* washings; and *perirrjaanterion,* sprinklings. He too, thought of the

water of *nidda* of Num. 19. In fact, the ashes of the red heifer mixed with water for the daily cleansing, based upon the shed blood of the atonement, has gripped the imagination of the holy writers of Israel and even of other nations more than any other ceremony of Israel. We have seen above that the Talmudic *tabalings,* or self-baptisms, were based upon it. Philo in his teaching on this matter clearly alluded to it.

Josephus was a Jewish priest, but extremely Romanized, and he describes the manner of purifying in Israel as follows, "For any persons being defiled by a dead body, they put a little of these ashes and hyssop into spring water, and *baptizing* with these ashes in water, sprinkled them on the third day and on the seventh." This shows that he too called the sprinklings with these ash waters a *baptism.* Josephus himself clearly states that the mode of application was by *sprinkling* and this he called baptism. However, the tendency of self-righteous religion was always away from the God-ordained sprinkling toward the laborious self-immersion, always away from the little water to the much water. So modern Judaism too has what it calls *Mikvah,* meaning a pool or reservoir for ritual purification. Rabbi Hiller says in his *Vocabulary of Jewish Life,* "Jewish law requires immersion in a ritually prepared bath of purification in accordance with prescribed standards and regulations," but this Jewish law is the Talmudic law and not the inspired law of Moses, for there is not one iota of God's law about a required immersion for purification. The only dipping that was done here was of the dipping of the hyssop into the ash-water of the red heifer to sprinkle the defiled. It was the uninspired oral law of self-righteous Talmudic Judaism that ever gravitated away from God's little water to man's much water. The daily ablutions of the Mohammedan world also go back to the sprinklings of the law of the Lord. Mohammedanism is like Romanism, a religious mixture of Judaism, Christianity and Paganism. So we have seen that the Levitical sprinklings were always known in history as baptisms.

Immersion is a Talmudic word, but not a Bible word. It never occurs anywhere in the sacred volume and is never required or justified by the original languages. The word *water* is mentioned 500 times in the Bible, but it does not in a single case suggest immersion. The word *wash* occurs about 125 times, but this too, never has even the remotest suggestion of immersion. A lethargic and lamentable traditionalism closes the eyes for these patent facts to Bible scholars.

CHAPTER IV

The Baptisms in the Gospels

We have seen, that as a result of the purification laws, Lev. 13 to 16; Num. 19; 31:19; Acts 21:24; Heb. 9:10-13; Israel had many baptisms. It was later that the word would go forth that the *heart* was purified by faith, Acts 15:9; I Pet. 1:22. Christ is now the great Purifier who purifies to Himself a peculiar people (Tit. 2:14). After He purchased the Church by his blood, He purifies it with "the washing of the water by the Word" and soon will come the presentation without "spot or wrinkle or any such thing."

In the course of history, Israel had not always obeyed the baptismal laws. We read in II Chr. 30:17-30 that a multitude of the people of four northern tribes had not cleansed themselves and in disregard of the laws had, nevertheless, eaten the passover meal. God's wrath was kindled and he sent a plague among the people, but at the intercession of the godly king, the Lord healed the plagued. In some cases a second passover was held for those who could not partake of it because of a certain defilement, Num. 9:6-11.

Let us now trace, in the Gospels, a few of these legal baptisms referred to in Heb. 6:2; 9:10-13. We find in Mark ?:1-4 that they kept the traditions of the elders by washing their hands often, which after nearly two millenniums is still true of traditional Jews. "And when they come from the market, except they *baptize (ean me baptisontai)* they eat not and many other things there be which they have received to hold, as the *baptisms (baptismous)* of cups and pots, brazen vessels and tables," or beds.

The washing of the hands was a sanctimonious and self-righteous imitation of the priests and of the words of Ps. 26:6, "I will wash my hands in innocence, so will I compass thine altar, O Lord." Even Pilate thought that he could wash the innocent blood from his guilty soul by washing his hands. This washing of the hands was evidently included in the baptism here mentioned, because it is altogether inconceivable that they would immerse every time they returned from the market. There was no time, no water and no facilities for such an action. In all fairness it must be stated that the manuscripts differ as to the word *baptisontai,* which is found in the *Alexandrian,* dating from the fifth century. The two older manuscripts *Sinaiticus* and *Vaticanus* have *rhantisontai,* sprinkle. Evidently, these two readings existed side by side as being of the same meaning. We have seen that all self-washings, sprinklings and pourings were baptisms and are emphatically so called in the New Testament, in Heb. 6:2; 9:10 as well as here. We have also seen that the washing of hands was always by pouring, dashing, water on the hands. Hence, the word *shataph,* dash, pour, is used in Lev. 15:11. And all the household furniture mentioned in Mark 7:4 was certainly not immersed, though it was baptized.

Another occasion when this rite comes into notice is found in Luke 11:37-41, where we read that a certain Pharisee marveled that he did not first *baptize, ebaptisthe* before dinner. Here, too, only the washing of the hands was meant.

The Pharisee did not realize that he had the great Lawgiver Himself at the table and that to the Pure and Holy One of Israel, all things were pure. He followed the written, not the oral law, the *Tenach*, not the Talmud.

In Cana of Galilee were six water pots of stone, "After the manner of the purifying of the Jews," - commentators differ as to the capacity of these pots, but the estimates range from ten to eighteen gallons. However, even at the highest estimate, they were altogether too small for the purpose of immersion of the guests. The Jews, in their arrangements for purifying of the guests, knew full well that the law never demanded immersion for persons; not even in one solitary ease. They, according to the law, provided only for sprinkling and pouring. The wine of the Spirit was now to take the place of the waters of the law?

We read in John 11:55, that passover being nigh at hand, many came from the rural districts to get to Jerusalem before the passover, "to purify themselves." The ashes of the red heifer were kept in Jerusalem and there was performed the sprinkling with the hyssop by the priests. The necessary self-washings could ail be performed at home, but they had to be sprinkled at Jerusalem. Those rejectors of the Messiah clung fanatically to the waters of the law. Less than a century after Christ there was the famed Rabbi Akiva, president of the Sanhedrin. He was committed to prison for his support of Bar Cochba's insurrection against Rome, and was awaiting execution and was at the point of death from thirst. The jailer, to add to his agony, poured most of his supply of water on the ground. *Akiva,* though tormented by thirst, directed that the remaining water be poured upon his hands for purifying, explaining: "It is better to die with thirst than to transgress the tradition of the elders."

This brief research in the gospels clearly shows the following facts.

1. That the ancient laws of purification were never entirely forgotten by Israel. The traditional Jews of our day have not completely forgotten them.

2. That the legalistic self-righteousness and the traditions of the elders had furnished many additions to the divine laws as e.g. the many hand-washings and the baptisms of the furniture.

3. That sufficient preparation was made for the strictly legal purifications, as was proved by the six water pots in the little town of Cana in Galilee.

4. That there was, on the other hand, not any provision made for immersion of the whole body by an administrator.

5. That the traditionalists showed that the law works wrath by their rejection of the great Lawgiver, while they, at the same time, clung meticulously to the external minutiae of the oral law.

6. That the wickedness of the traditionalists has been set before God's people in all following ages as a beacon in the sea of time to warn us never, under any conditions, to cling blindly to mere forms and externalities as e. g. in regard to the water, whether little or much, or none.

7. That the age of grace for the Body of Christ eliminates not only all the self-righteous traditions of the elders, but also all the ritual sprinklings, pourings and washings of the law of God, since we are not under law, but under grace, Rom. 6:14.

CHAPTER V

The Baptism of John

When John came on the scene, Israel was in a most deplorable condition, nationally, morally and spiritually. Nationally they were smarting under the galling yoke of the foreign oppressor, the Roman Empire. The nation was split into five parties. The Pharisees were the popular party of the majority and Matt. 23 can tell us what the Saviour thought of them. The Sadducees were the aristocratic party of the intelligentia, the modernists of their day, even worse than the Pharisees. The Herodians were the political party, who blindly followed those in the saddle. The Essenes were the mystic and separatistic party, while the Zealots were the radical and revolutionary party of the day, ever advocating and plotting violent revolution against the foreign oppressors, and time and again they broke out in unsuccessful insurrection.

The whole nation was defiled by sin and heathenism, and according to the law God could only meet with a clean people, as the sacred history of Israel abundantly proves.

It was into such a defiled nation, leprous with sin, that John was sent as the friend of the bridegroom to prepare and lead the bride to the bridegroom. As an Old Testament prophet, he could only do this according to the law and with the divinely prescribed purifications. According to Isaiah and Malachi, he was the special messenger of the Lord to prepare the way for the Messiah. This greatest of prophets was himself an object of prophecy. He predicted the imminent destruction of the nation with the statement that the ax was laid at the root of the trees. He is called the messenger of the covenant, and by this covenant is meant the national Sinaitic covenant once introduced by the baptism, sprinkling, of the water of *nidda.* His mandate was to the nation as a whole, a nation defiled, but to be made clean by a baptism leading to repentance, or a change of mind. At Sinad, Israel accepted Moses as mediator, now they had to accept Christ as the mediator between God and man. At Sinai they had accepted the fiery law, now they had to accept the grace and truth that came by Christ. When Moses sealed the old covenant, he sprinkled the book and the people with the sacrificial blood and water, saying: "Behold, the blood of the covenant, which the Lord hath made with you concerning all these words." - Even against the old, Christ based the new covenant in his own blood, Matt. 26:28. The old conditional covenant of Horeb was completely broken and the whole nation utterly defiled. Judgment should have overtaken them and the ax of judgment was there, but it was *laid* and it was grace that it did not cut down the sinful nation. John's preaching was there to call the nation back to God, and his baptism was there to purify them for the All-Pure God and Savior, Messiah.

Since John was living under the old covenant, his baptism was an old covenant affair, Jewish mass purification for the Messiah and his rule and kingdom. That John's works were purely on legal ground appears from the fact that his words were entirely legalistic. When the people asked him, "What must we do?", the answer was not, ‘Believe in Christ and be saved'; but give away one coat if you have two and do the same with your surplus food. Here was a do-religion and not a resting in faith on the finished work of Christ, for it was still on the other side of Calvary. When the publicans

asked what they had to do, the answer was simply, "Exact no more than that which is appointed you." In other words, all they had to do was to quit their meanness and bad practices. To the soldiers who came with the same question was given a threefold negative: no violence, no vilification and no villainous discontent with their wages. Here was nothing but works according to the ancient rule: do and live. And like the law itself, John's words were mainly negative.

His baptism belonged to the *carnal* ordinances, Heb. 9:10, exactly on a par with the ancient laws of eating only clean foods. Here was still the *imposed* yoke, hard and heavy, for it is never easy to give one coat away if you only have two. The Roman soldiers just got the merest paltry pittance, just salary enough to buy salt for their food and it was a harsh demand to be content with that. It is in this harsh and legal setting, however, that we must take John's baptism. It was carnal, Jewish; works and no grace; and John himself put it in vivid contrast to the baptism with the Spirit and with fire by Christ.

As to the *extent* of John's baptism, we read that all Jerusalem and Judea went out to him and that all the people and the publicans were baptized with the baptism of John, while the Pharisees and the lawyers were not baptized of him, Luke 7:29, 30. However, when they rejected John's baptism, they rejected the counsel of God against themselves. This last statement clearly shows that though John's water baptism was a part of the harsh and intolerable legal yoke and a carnal ordinance for Israel, on a par with the dietary laws, as we can clearly see in Heb. 9:10, it was, nevertheless, the counsel of God, and when Israel's leaders refused to be purified from their filth, they rejected the counsel of God against themselves. Nothing stronger could have been said in regard to the divine character and will of John's legal baptism for purification. Just as John was the foretold forerunner of the Messiah, the last and the greatest of all the prophets of Israel, so was his purification also the last and the greatest. As our Lord later hints in a parable, the whole house of Israel was now swept and garnished. Only the leaders refused to be cleansed and they promptly coaxed the people into the rejection of the Messiah. With the rejection of the counsel of God against themselves came quite naturally the rejection of the Son of God and subsequently of the Spirit of God and of the gospel of God, with the man of God, Paul. In this light we can fully understand the hot blasts of holy anger against these leaders on the part of our Savior and on the part of John before Him and Stephen after Him.

The *mode,* of John's baptism has been a matter of dispute for centuries, and yet the matter is very simple, if we are only willing to let the Word decide and not our pet theories. John was a minister of the old covenant and of the law as we have seen. He had a legal *do-religion* and not a gracious *done-religion,* for the law still functioned in the absence of a finished work. That law knew but two modes of baptisms, sprinkling and pouring, but never any immersion of persons by another, nor any self-immersions for that matter. It is altogether unthinkable that John would have turned his back upon the ancient ordinances of the law in regard to the mode and manner of purifying the unclean. John did not explain the meaning of his rite for the simple reason that the people knew the rite from the ancient law and practice; but the rite of immersion would have needed an explanation, since this would have been a novelty and innovation in Israel. An immersion illustrative of the burial of the Lord Jesus would have been utterly mystifying to the

people. It would have seemed foolish to them. Furthermore, immersions in the Jordan are very unlikely for several practical reasons. The vulgar arguments of the *much water is* thoroughly sophistical, for the expression in Greek does not mean much water, but *many waters,* or springs, necessary for culinary, lavatory uses and the various legal Jewish purifications. Any Greek student knows that *polla hudata* can not mean *much water.* The Jordan is very cataractic and treacherous and it is highly improbable that a whole nation would be exposed to its dangers. Then John did not have a waterproof suit for the chilly snow waters that stream from the sources of Lebanon. Neither were his baptismal candidates nicely fitted out with immersion robes. There was no change of dress, so badly needed, after the discomfort under the chilly water. But in Israel for a woman to have even the upper and the lower parts of her body exposed to the sight of men would have been regarded by both sexes as gross indecency and shame, as every Bible student knows full well. Especially the flowing Eastern garb would easily lead to such an indelicate and indecorous exposure as no one in Israel would stand for, it being entirely unoriental.

The *number* who submitted to John's baptisms precludes immersion. From two statements in Josephus it appears that the population stood then at least at four million souls: and remember the whole nation was baptized with the exception of its leaders. If we now suppose that John stood in the cold snow water three hours every day and that he immersed them at the rate of one per minute, then he could, with the deduction of the twenty-six sabbaths in the half year that he preached and baptized, baptize thus only fully thirty thousand people out of the four million; and still all the people were baptized as we have seen, Luke 7:29. He would have needed at least thirty years to immerse all the people. It is generally assumed that John in some miraculous way, immersed them all in his brief ministry, but we read emphatically that John *"did no miracle,"* and this deprives us of all right to put some miracle in his ministry.

Let us look at the text. John, we are told, baptized in water, Matt. 3:11; Mark 1:8; Luke 3:16; John 1:26. The picture is clear. John stood in water and the people stood on the river bank or in some shallow water and then he sprinkled the running water of the Jordan upon the thousands before him. John was a true prophet and a true prophet of Jehovah always meticulously kept the law. If John had immersed, he would not have kept the law, but the self-righteous traditions of the elders.

All the embarrassments of immodest exposure in Israel are obviated by the safeguards of the ancient legal purifications, while they are greatly enhanced by the self-willed traditions of the elders in the Talmud. John evidently dipped a heavy bush of hyssop into the stream and therewith purified the dense throngs before him just as God had of old prescribed it.

It is quite generally taught that John took over the *tabalings*, or immersions, of the Talmudic Jews after the Exile, but this is positively untenable, for John's baptism was from heaven, theirs from the earth. John's baptism was the counsel of God - so that all who rejected it, rejected the counsel of God, as Israel's leaders actually did - theirs was Rabbinic counsel. John's baptism was divine, theirs merely human self-will. John clung strictly to the law, as all prophets did, and he would have shrunk back in horror from a self-righteous human ceremony. He did not adopt the traditions of the fathers from a few centuries before, but went back to the old paths of God's law for Israel and that meant

for him dipping with hyssop to sprinkle the unclean. In this sense, and in this sense only, can he be called, as the Dutch version has it, John the Dipper; but he can in no wise be called with some new Baptist translations, John the Immerser. To do so betrays ignorance or deceit and bigotry.

The active verb *baptizo* appears 25 times in the New Testament. As a passive verb it occurs 48 times; as a participle 5 times; while once with the article, Mark 6:14. As a name *Baptistes* occurs 14 times in reference to John. As an act *baptismos* occurs four times and *baptisma* as the result of the action, or state, appears 22 times. In this total of 118 times the word can not bear the translation of immersion in a single case, as many scholars have proved.

CHAPTER VI

Christ's Baptism by John

We find this baptism in Matt. 3:13-17; Mark 1:10; Luke 3:21-22 and John 1:32-34. The question is ever recurring, why the perfect Lamb of God was baptized. Many different answers have been given to this question. The following commentators and comments furnish a good example of the answers given.

Prof. Gran thinks that Jesus wanted to show that, although he was no citizen of the kingdom, but the King, he nevertheless wanted to enter the kingdom in the divinely ordained way, hence an example of humility.

Mackknight thinks that Jesus by being buried and raised from the water, wanted to give a picture of his near death and resurrection, hence a type or a picture.

Archbishop Thomson found in Christ's baptism a threefold purpose: *a.* to justify John's baptism by his own example; *b.* to give John the assurance that his course as the herald of Christ was now completed; *c.* that some token might be given that he was indeed the anointed of God. Here it is concern for John.

Witsins thought that Christ was baptized to authorize John's Baptism and to set a good example for all his followers to desire baptism and to picturize first the suffering and death and after this the resurrection and the glory. Here it is a good example and a picture.

DaCosta says that Jesus was treated in the immersion as a doom-deserving sinner and in his rising from the water as the great Conqueror of death. Here reality and type are combined.

Dr. Dale thinks, and many with him, that Jesus' baptism was a public and official announcement of his entrance upon the work of fulfilling all righteousness. Dale vehemently denies that Jesus was baptized with the baptism of John. "It is one thing to be baptized by John and quite another to receive the `baptism of John.' " The baptism of John was for sinners, demanding repentance and fruit and promising the remission of sins. But the Lord Jesus was not a sinner and could not repent and could not receive the remission of sin. Hence he calls the reception of John's baptism by Jesus impossible, untrue and absurd; and he calls this baptism His inauguration into the office of fulfilling all righteousness.

Scott says that it behooved Christ to fulfill all righteousness as our surety and example and to make us see that we should walk in all of God's commands and statutes.

VanAndel. Christ wanted to be like unto his people in everything. He wanted to differ from them in nothing except in holiness. He wanted to give proof that he was obedient to the law, even if he covers his glory with it for the time being.

Doddridge. Jesus had no need of the washing away of sins and still he was baptized and God glorified baptism here to such an extent that just at that moment the Spirit was sent upon him and how can we expect the Spirit except by a meticulous and humble keeping of the divine laws?

Olshausen. The immersion symbolized the negative, one expulsion of the old life, Rom. 6:4, and the rising the positive resurrection of the new man and then the Spirit comes.

Another theory holds that just as the consecration of Aaron was by baptism, anointing and sacrifice, so all were realized in the baptism of Christ as his priestly consecration to his Messianic work. Here was first the baptism of John, then the antitypical oil, the Spirit, descended upon him, while the self-sacrifice of the Lamb of God would not come till the end of his earthly ministry. Fatal for this view is the fact that Christ was not an Aaronic Priest, but a Priest after the order of Melchizedek.

Prof. Richard M. Smith says in his studies in the Greek New Testament, "He honored his forerunner, noble, faithful John, by a public acceptance of him and his work -None of us knows exactly what our Lord meant to teach by being baptized with John's baptism, which was unto the *"remission of sins."* He may not have meant to teach us anything, anymore than he did by his circumcision. Here we end our list of views, which could be lengthened almost indefinitely. Though some contain a modicum of truth, on the whole these views are extremely unsatisfactory. They all miss the fact that on earth Christ was the minister of the circumcision, as Paul says in Rom. 15:8, and that He was made under the law, Gal. 4:4. He was the representative of the last Adam and as the surety and substitute of his people, he was treated as a defiled sinner, totally unclean. How godly and learned men have missed the comfort that even here the just took the place of the unjust, that he who knew no sin was made sin for us, in order that we might be made the righteousness of God in him!

In Matthew 3:15 he uses the plural *us*. In this passage that so definitely states the reason of his baptism by John, not only Himself, or Him and John, or Him and us, but all *Israel under the law,* with which he had identified Himself. Our Lord clearly showed in all his life on earth that he was under the law. He was not only baptized but also circumcised and purified with his mother. He kept the Passover and all the Jewish feasts and ordinances and he told his followers to do all that the wicked men in Moses' seat commanded. The Levitical purifications were part of the law and Christ would not have been an obedient Jew, if he had refused these prescribed purifications. Moreover, he was unclean, not through His own sin, but through the sin of the world that God as judge had laid upon him. It is astonishing that Dale and other commentators do not even see this simple and most important truth, so full of comfort for the trusting soul.

John's baptism was from heaven and he obeyed heaven.

John's baptism was the demand of the law and he obeyed the law.

John's baptism was for purification; our sins made Him as an unclean one.

John's baptism was to be followed with fruit, - our fruit is all of Him and His Spirit.

We see, therefore, that we are with John's baptism of Christ, not on the ground of Christian grace, but purely on the Jewish ground of law. He was made sin - (not a sinner) - for us, that we might be made the righteousness of God in Him. His obedience here heralded His finished work and so the heavens opened up for Him, the Father attested Him, the Spirit descended and abode on Him and filled Him; - behold, the triune God!

Dr. Williams, worthy successor of the celebrated Dr. I. Haldeman, maintains in his booklet on Baptism, that immersion is a matter of righteousness, and he bases this upon Matt. 3:15. For righteousness' sake every believer must be baptized. In itself this is high ground; nevertheless it is false ground, because Christ was made under the law in that he kook the sinner's place in the midst of Israel. Hence the law made all its exactions upon him, treating him as a vile sinner in need of cleansing. He identified himself with sinners in order that sinners might later be identified with him as saints, and be not under law but under grace, Rom. 6:14. Saints today cannot be baptized as Jesus was, because he needed no saving faith, nor repentance; nor confession of faith; but He, on the other hand, did have at his baptism what no Baptist has today, a Baptist preacher who forbade him, the opened heaven, the descending Spirit and the Father who testified of His Son. The righteousness of the law was for Christ to fulfill and at Calvary He did fulfill the last farthing of this righteousness, which is the all-sufficient ground and reason why the saved sinner need not be baptized for righteousness' sake. His Surety and Substitute has done it perfectly for him. We cannot truly sing: "Jesus paid it all," and then try to pay some of the bill. We cannot glory in His finished work and still try to do our bit.

Since our Lord could not repent of any sin nor could confess any sin or guilt, there could be but one fundamental reason why He submitted to John's "baptism of repentance" and this is, that *He took the place of sinful men.* He who knew no sin was made sin for us, that. we might be made the righteousness of God in him. To accomplish this end, he had to be numbered with the transgressors, as Isa. 53:12 had foretold seven centuries before.

John did not yet grasp this and forbade Him saying, I have need to be baptized of thee, and comest thou to me? Matt. 3:14. John was mistaken in a twofold way: Christ did not baptize with water, and could not, since He did not bring shadows but fulfilled them; while on the other hand, He had to be baptized in order to fulfill all righteousness, which does not mean that His baptism alone would fulfill all righteousness, but that His baptism, or purification, was one of the things necessary to the fulfilling of all righteousness. If Christ had fulfilled all the many requirements of the law and not this, then He would simply not have fulfilled the whole law and He could not be the end of the law. In fact, He would then be a transgressor needing a Savior. By the perfect obedience to every detail of the law He made many righteous, Rom. 5:9. He became obedient even unto the death of the cross, Phil. 2:8.

John's water baptism was only an emblem, a shadow, a picture of an entirely different and infinitely higher baptism that would be the substance of this shadow, the baptism into the death of Christ, Rom. 6:3, and into Christ Himself, Gal. 3:27 and into his Body, I Cor. 12:13. Our brethren as a rule miss this wondrous union completely.

Those who totally ignore these blessed facts go down into the waters of death today. But what are they in reality doing? In their ignorance of the finished work on Calvary they greatly dishonour his perfect sacrifice at the cross. While they may detest the following of an earthly Jesus by the Modernists, they themselves want to follow the Christ on the one point of his water baptism. As Galatianists they want to cling to Christ and to the law, (but read in this connection Gal. 3).

CHAPTER VII

Did Our Lord Ever Command Water Baptism?

When an assumption is ancient and general, it is hard to get rid of it and this applies here. That John had water baptism is an undeniable fact. But note the strong contrast put between the baptism of John and that of Christ (Matt. 3:6; Mk. 1:4; Lk. 3:16; Jn. 1:26; Acts 1:5; 19:4). The strength of the exclusive and absolute contrast between John's water baptism and Christ's Spirit baptism is given in the Greek by the little particles of contrast, which can best be rendered by "I on the one hand - but he on the other hand”... Now, after this strong and repeated emphasis, it would be passing strange, if Christ should now go from this higher baptism to the lower rite of John, thereby effacing the whole contrast.

Second, John emphatically limited the water baptism to *Israel.* He came to baptize with water for the very reason that *"He should be manifest to Israel"* (Jn. 1:31) The natural conclusion is that the water rite would have outlived its purpose and usefulness after Christ was manifest to Israel. The question is often asked, why there was suddenly so much water baptism in Israeli with John. This was because he as the forerunner of the Messiah had to purify the unclean people to prepare and present them as clean to the Messiah, and he had to do this according to the law with one of the "divers baptisms." He could legally use only a "carnal ordinance" which had been imposed, like a yoke, on them until the time of the reformation (Heb. 9:10).

Third, Jesus confined the water baptism to the righteousness of the law (Mt. 3:15). What room was there left for this rite after He fulfilled on the Cross all the required righteousness of God's law? This all-important question should be faced frankly and squarely. The Body of Christ is not under the law.

Fourth, Christians are generally saying, - Jesus was baptized and hence we ought to follow Him in this rite. If they knew the value of Christ's vicarious and substitutionary work as our Representative New Adam, they would change this exactly around, and say, because our Surety was baptized, we need not be baptized. He was washed as an unclean sinner in order that we might be a pure saint in Him. - O wondrous grace! He was also circumcised and this is no reason why we should be circumcised, but just the reverse, this is sufficient reason why we need not be circumcised. He fulfilled the ordinance of circumcision for us as well as that of baptism (Col. 2:10-12). In Him we have the real antitypical circumcision as well as the great antitypical baptism.

Fifth, if we want to follow Christ's example, why do we not consistently follow Him in the example that He Himself did not baptize with water (Jn. 4:2)? If there had been any inherent blessing in it, then He who overflowed with mercy would have also bestowed this blessing; but according to Hebrews 9:10 it was only the imposed yoke of a carnal and temporal ordinance; and Christ did not impose the heavy law yoke, but the light yoke of his wondrous grace, which excluded the purifyings.

Sixth, Christ spoke in Matt. 20:22-23, Mark 10:38-39 and Luke 12:50 of a baptism that had not a drop of water associated with it, as all commentators admit. There are only two passages that are generally taken to be water baptism (Mt. 28:19, 20). But

here He does speak of a baptism *in* the Name, but "eis," i.e., *into* the Name. Just as the Jews of old were baptized into Moses (I Cor. 10:2, compare Ex. 14:29 and Heb. 11:29, the latter two references proving it to be a "dry" baptism) so as to become his subjects and his people, so in the coming age all nations will be made disciples and put into the *essence* (name here stands for essence) of the three Persons of blessed Trinity. The Greek preposition "eis" (into) is also used in Romans 6:3 where the baptism is *into* Jesus Christ and into His death. Matthew 28:19-20 is a text of Scripture that looks to the conversion of all nations in the Millennium, as many godly scholars have admitted and the next chapter shows.

Seventh, it is clear that the disciples themselves who received this command from the risen Lord, never understood it to be a rule and formula for them, for they never preached to any but unto Jews as seen in the book of Acts and it is a question whether any of the twelve ever went to the nations. Roman legends affirms this, but the Bible does not. They certainly never used the trinitarian formula for any baptism, in the book of Acts. All Baptisms were in the Name of the Lord Jesus (Acts 2:38; 8:16; 10:48). Consider Peter's words in Acts 10:28, it was not lawful for a Jew to go to another nationality, how could they then have preached and baptized according to the so-called Great Commission?

Eighth, the other passage that might be construed as a possible command to baptize with water is Mark 16:16: "He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved." If this is the order today then all are wrong and only the baptismal regenerationists are right, for the baptism is here not put *after* the saved but *before.* Then baptism is absolutely necessary for salvation and all Quakers are lost, and all others who were never baptized with water. But notice the tense of the verb. It is the present "is" and not the past tense of a past action. *If* there were water baptism, and immersion the form, it would mean to hold the water candidate under water all the time and thus drown him, for the present tense of the verb denotes a continuous action. Further, consider the following. All believers must then cast out demons, speak with new tongues, pick up poisonous snakes, drink poison and not be hurt or harmed. Then they also must lay hands on the sick to heal them; in short, accept the whole Pentecostal program (Mk. 16:16-18). It is therefore evident that here, too, our Lord did not go back to John's water baptism, but thought of His own miraculous and abiding baptism that belongs to the Messianic Kingdom. (Note further the two chapters following).

Ninth, we read in Heb. 9:10 that the baptisms were imposed as the heavy yoke of the law - upon Israel until Christ. The Greek adverb *mechri* means *up to a given point, so far and not farther.* When used with time, as here, it answers the question, how long will it last? This adverb alone shows how utterly wrong it is to commence the so called Christian or believer's baptism with Christ. Instead of commencing baptism, He concluded it. It was here as with the whole law. The *telos* of the law was Christ, Rom. 10:4, and so also the *telos,* the finality or purpose reached, of baptism was Christ. Baptism, as we saw, was an integral part of the law. Was it not in the light of this word then impossible that Christ could command baptism for this age? We cannot at the same time conclude a certain thing and then turn around and command the same thing to be done in the future. We may not assume such a glaring inconsistency in our unchangeable Lord.

CHAPTER VIII

Baptism and the Various Apostolic Commissions

These are found (besides Matt. 28:19-20; and Mark 16:15), in Lk. 24:47; John 20:21; Acts 1:8; 10:42; I Cor. 1:14-17. The only recorded mention of water baptism ever made by our Lord was in Acts 1:4, 5; 11:16 and here He made a most emphatic difference between John's water of the past and His own baptism with the Holy Spirit, and this was fulfilled at Pentecost. This contrast was the last word of the Savior prior to His return to the Father in ascension. Not a word was said that would as much as hint at a command to baptize with water. This apostolic commission stands prominent and is corroborated by the fact that Peter quotes it and regards is as fulfilled in the outpouring of the Spirit upon the household of Cornelius. Christ was the end of all religious water, oil and blood.

In John 20:21, Christ simply said: "As my Father hath sent Me even so send I you," and again not a word of water baptism. The whole Gospel of John does not contain one solitary hint that the disciples were to baptize with water. Contrarily, John's record completely excludes the water. The same can be said of Luke's commission, (24:47, 49), often regarded as the Gentile commission for this age of grace. Here also is not a single word or even a suggestion of water baptism. Luke tells us of our Lord's own baptism, but why did he not mention a command to baptize? Plainly because there was no such command or we would find it here.

Mark mentions baptism, but he mentions also five signs that shall follow all that believe. There is plenty of true faith in the world, but these five signs are absent in every place and in every circle and our conclusion can only be that the signs and the baptisms have altogether been removed. Take these signs and you have Pentecost. Take this baptism and you have salvation by baptism, for the order is not as is generally thought: *belief, salvation, baptism;* but *belief, baptism, salvation.*

Take the casting out of devils and you must have exorcism of devils today. Take the serpents and you have the wild-eyed, snake-huggers and snake-meetings of the South. Drink the poison and you fall into convulsions, or death. Lay hands on the sick, and your hands may catch some germs, but the sick will not be healed by them. Take the tongues, and you have "tonguism" and all its folly and its unintelligible gibberings. The book of Acts is, at least partially, the fulfillment of Mark 16:16-18.

Even in Matthew 28 no water is mentioned and the baptism is not at all *in* the name, but *into* the name of the triune God. Name stands for the essence of God's Being. Here is no baptism in water, but *into the Godhead Himself.* This has been shamefully lost sight of. This mountain command is like all other mountain commands connected with Israel, and the command had to be for Israel, since the Body of Christ is not under law but under Grace. The Apostles never obeyed this command in the past and knew full well that our Lord looked (over this whole age) into the Kingdom age, and hence they never baptized a single person in the name of the triune God. And never were the nations made His disciples; they are becoming by the day, more disciples of the terrible

Karl Marx. The so called Great Commission has become the great blunder of the Church.

Many Baptists realizing that the baptismal formula *"in the name,"* is contrary to the Greek text, have made it a baptism *"to the confession of the name,"* then maintain that the baptist candidate should first confess His name, but this is contrary to the text as well. Several other subterfuges have been invented but they all violate the text. The Apostles would not have dared to depart from their Lord in this matter, when they baptized without the trinitarian formula, Acts 2:38; 8:12, 13, 38; 9:18; 16:15, 33; 18:8, 25. Hence, we may freely conclude that Christ never commanded water baptism in the trinitarian formula for the Acts period.

To refer once more to the contrast between John's water baptism and Jesus' Spirit baptism, in every passage of the Gospels - and they all have it in the first part of the Gospels and twice in Acts - the contrast is a complete contradiction of two things that can have nothing in common and are mutually exclusive. The Spirit has so stated in the Greek, that Christ has nothing to do with water baptism. The four Spirit baptisms in Acts were the early rain promised by Joel (2:23). The water baptism continued in Acts is no proof to the contrary, since the whole Jewish regime went on until the awful judgment of Acts 28. They insisted that Paul and others should adhere to circumcision and they naturally carried an the Levitical purifications, which John the Baptist had reinstituted on a large scale.

The great diversity in the seven times recorded commission of our Lord shows that with all the variety there was unanimity in leaving out the water. It amounts to positive evidence that they understood their Lord to prescribe no formula for water baptism of any sort whatsoever. The phrase *in His name* as quoted by Luke means *in His power* or better *in His Being.*

The argument against water baptism as a command of Christ, grows to absolute certainty when we hear Paul say of his own commission: "Christ sent me not to baptize but to preach the gospel." We have again the exclusive contrast in I Cor. 1:14-17.

Peter in referring to Christ's commission in Acts 10:42, never even as much as intimates that our Lord had commanded water baptism. While he emphatically mentions His command, he does not mention water. The first Christians did not so understand the *so-called* Great Commission, for they certainly would have clung to the formula of Christ and yet this formula was never used as far as the sacred record goes. The names Father and Spirit are never stated in the Acts baptisms. They baptized with water before Christ and after Christ went to heaven, proof in itself that they did not get it from Him. The great church historian, Schaff, says that the trinitarian formula of Matt. 28 is not traceable earlier than the fourth century.

CHAPTER IX

Baptism and the So-called Great Commission

In his *Simple Studies in Matthew,* Wm. L. Pettingill wrote:

"It seems at first sight, a surprising thing to find that, beginning with Pentecost, which was but a few days after `The Great Commission' was given, and down to the end of the New Testament history of the Church, all the baptisms recorded were simply `into the Name of the Lord Jesus,' instead of `into the Name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost.' (See Acts 2:38; 8:16; 10:48; 19:5) In seeking an explanation, it is well to remember that the Trinitarian formula is found only in Matthew, the Kingdom Gospel. The full accomplishment of "The Great Commission," therefore, may be looked for in the future, in connection with the manifestation of the Kingdom, rather than during the present Dispensation in connection with the Church of God."

In his *The Gospel of Matthew,* A. C. Gaebelein, one of the greatest Bible Students of our day, wrote the following about this:

"This is the Kingdom commission. A time is coming when this great commission here will be carried out by a remnant of Jewish disciples, who are represented by the eleven. It is the same remnant as in Matt. 24."

J. N. Darby, quoted by A. C. Gaebelein in *The Gospel of Matthew,* has this to say on the Great Commission:

"It is well to notice what has been alluded to: the ministry in the Acts is not the accomplishment of this commission in Matthew, but of the mission in Luke, the book itself being, as is known, the continuation of His Gospel; nor was the ministry of Paul, who took up by a separate divine mission the evangelization of the nations, the carrying out of this (the commission here in Matthew.) His was fully more even yet a mission from the ascended and glorified Saviour, to which was added the ministry of the Church." It connects itself even much more in its first elements with Luke. The ministry here established stands alone. The disciples are not sent to Jews, as in Luke. But Jerusalem is rejected and the remnant is attached to Christ (His brethren and owned in this character) sent out to Gentiles. This as far as Scripture teaches us has never been fulfilled. The course of events under the hand of God, the disciples remain in Jerusalem. "A new mission is sent forth in the person of Paul, and that connected with the establishment of the church on earth. The accomplishment of the commission here in Matthew has been interrupted, but there is the promise to be with those who went forth in it to the end of the age. Nor do I doubt it will be so. This testimony will go forth to the nations before the Lord comes. `The Brethren' will carry it to warn the nations. The commission was given, but we find no accomplishment of it. It connects the testimony with the Jewish remnant owned by a risen Lord of all, with earth and His earthly directions, and for the present it has in fact given place to a heavenly commission, and the Church of God."

The *Christian Workers' Commentary* of Dr. James M. Gray has this:

"This is the Kingdom commission, as another expresses it, not the Christian commission. The latter is in Luke, distinctively the Gentile Gospel, but not here, which is distinctively the Jewish gospel. And this is all the more remarkable because in Luke, the disciples are commanded to go to the Jews (Luke 24:27), while here they are commanded to go to "all nations." It points to the close of the age when the commission will be carried out by the faithful remnant of the Jews so often spoken about. It has not yet been carried out. The story of Acts is not its fulfillment. Its accomplishment has been interrupted, but will be taken up before the Lord comes to deliver Israel at the last."

Many other immersionist brethren have spoken in the same manner about the Great Commission. We should mark the following: (a) Matthew is the Gospel of the Kingdom and not of the Church. The Church is only mentioned twice and then as something future. (b) We have here the Kingdom signs as the earthquake, the angels, and the risen Lord. (c) According to Isa. 49:6 and 66:19, the faithful remnant was to bring glad tidings to the nations. We have here the same thing. (d) All Power is given Me in heaven and on earth. This is prophetic in the same way as in 26:64. It is the prophetic perfect for from Heb. 2:8 we know that all things are not yet put under Him. Satan is the god of this age, and Christ does not execute all His power on earth as the crime and cruelty of our times clearly show. In the future He shall do this as we see in Rev. 5:12. (e) We have at least four commands here, and not one has ever been fulfilled or obeyed, because the Apostles *never went to the nations, never baptized in the name o f the triune God, never made disciples of all nations, and they have never taught all nations to observe the "all things."* (f) Peter never understood the *go ye* to mean that they should go to the nations at that time, because in Acts 10:28 he says: "Ye know how that it is an unlawful thing for a man that is a Jew to keep company, or come unto one of another nation," and even later he separated himself from the Gentiles. (g) There is no record in Acts that Peter or the other eleven Apostles ever preached to the Gentiles outside of Palestine. Roman traditions send the Apostles in far-off heathen lands, but the Word states that they remained at Jerusalem, Acts 8:1. (h) The Word *disciple all nations* has no reference to the Church, since the word *discipline is* not used for the Body of Christ, furthermore the Church is one people for His Name *from* among the nations. (i) *All nations* exclude Israel since Israel, according to Num. 23:9, is not reckoned among the nations. (j) If it was the purpose of the Great Commission to disciple all nations, then the Church has most dismally failed, because there are over a billion people on earth who have never heard of Christ. (k) According to the construction of the Great Commission, the nations must be discipled by baptizing them (as nations) *into* (eis) the name of the triune God. Without a doubt our Lord here had in mind the promise of Isa. 52:15. There we see that the nations who had never been told of the crucified Christ shall see Him and consider Him and be sprinkled by Him; i.e. with the baptism of the Holy Spirit. And as Peter in Acts 10 was the faithful remnant who brought the Holy Spirit baptism to the Gentile so also the faithful remnant of the future day shall be instrumental in this baptism. (1) Teaching *them* (nations) to observe all things. But today the Church does not think of observing all the things our Lord has spoken. He had told the disciples to heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils, not to take any gold, silver, or brass or shoes or two cloaks, Matt. 10. (m) *Lo, I am with you* could not apply to the Church, for we mourn His absence and He is not with us, but according to Pauline truth *in us* and we in Him. All these facts barely mentioned here

have accumulative power and clearly show that we have here no Church truth. (n) Since the church is not under law she does not get commands from Christ in Palestine, but from Paul. The church did not get orders on mountains as Israel, but from Paul's deep hole, the prison. The misunderstanding of this word results from two sources: the revolt from Paul - and the denial of Israel's place and future.

The words of Mark 16:15-18 are generally put on a par with those of Matt. 28, but there is a vast difference, for while the so called great commission will be fully realized in the future restoration of Israel, these words in Mark find their realization from verse 16 to 18 in the Book of Acts. While Mark looks to the "early rain" baptism, Matthew eyes the far off "latter rain" baptism.

Our brethren generally point with satisfaction to the order of faith before baptism and then claim that infants cannot believe. True, but the order is here against the immersionist brethren as well as against the Paedobaptists. The Paedobaptist order is - baptize, believe, salvation; but this is not the order in the text. The Baptist order is believe, salvation, baptize, but again this is not the order. The Campbellite order is like that of this passage: believe, baptize, salvation; and this was the Jewish order, which we find also in Acts 2:38: repent, baptize, remission of sins. They remind us of the important fact that the risen Lord spoke and commanded here, and they hastily conclude that with His resurrection the whole legal regime of Israel was abrogated and our present age of the Church as His Body had begun, but this is far from the truth. Christ prayed for Israel on the cross - and Acts was the answer from the Father, and hence we read that Christ continued in Acts what in the Gospels he *"began to do and teach."* Hence, we see that in the whole Acts period of thirty years the Temple and the Priesthood functioned, the law and circumcision and even the bloody sacrifices. Paul brought bloody offerings to the Temple and took a Nazarite vow nearly thirty years after the Lamb of God had died on Calvary; and he fought a good fight so that he could set himself as an example, whence we are compelled to conclude that he did not make a serious lapse as many think, but did fully according to God's will. As long as the law for Israel functioned every Jew was bound to keep it punctiliously. This is exactly what he and all the Jewish believers did. With fervent love for the crucified and risen Lord they kept the law but the Gentiles never. The council of Jerusalem in Acts 15 on the one hand did not free the Jews from the law, but on the other hand they did not put the Gentiles under the yoke of the law. They in their few decrees decided what the Gentiles should observe. If baptism had been meant for the Gentile believers of this age, they certainly would have so charged. This silence speaks with eloquent voice against baptism.

Five signs were to follow the believers according to the Savior in this special Acts period while He still worked with the Jews as the God of Israel, who alone does wondrous things.

1. In his name they were to cast out devils, or demons, and this was done in Acts 16:18; 19:12.

2. They were to speak with new tongues, - and all through Acts we find the new tongues.

3. They were to take up serpents without harm, - in Acts 28:3-5 we see this verified.

4. If they were to drink a deadly potion it would not hurt them; - though we do not find an example of this in Acts, the presumptive argument is that this was true and workable as well as the others.

5. They were to lay hands on the sick and heal them; - Peter and Paul healed many in Acts.

Frightful have been the results of the misinterpretation of this passage, and the Baptist interpretation has led to the serious misunderstanding and misapplication of these words. They should have honestly admitted that their order is not the order of Mark 16:16, but that baptism here stands before salvation. They should have also honorably admitted that true belief in Christ is here followed by these signs and that the Pentecostal brethren are more consistent than they. They should have seen that the baptism and signs are inseparably joined together. We simply cannot take the one and leave the others. No wonder that our Fundamentalist brethren have not the answer to the would-be exorcists, tonguists, snake-people, poison-drinkers, and faith-healers of our day, which are flourishing in the south and west of our land, saying: "We believe, and Jesus said these signs would follow."

The right view of this passage is that all the six signs, baptism included, were for Israel and the nations during the Acts period, when God was still in mercy and long-suffering, pursuant to the plea of Christ on the cross, dealing with Israel, the nation of the many signs and wonders and healings. Missionary Bishop and other godly men have clearly shown that the signs and tongues and healings are not God's order for the Body of Christ today. We live in the day of super-abounding grace for every testing and trial, and have positively no need of these signs. There are more believers in the world today than ever before, with the same spiritual qualifications, but these signs do not "follow them."

CHAPTER X

The Baptism of Fire

John says in Matt. 3:11: "He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and *with fire."* What is meant by this fire baptism? The commentators have identified it with the baptism of the Holy Ghost on Pentecost, and found its fulfillment in the fiery tongues. The Pentecostal folk have eagerly appropriated this false exegesis as their own and it has led even to some "special fire" sects. Against this interpretation count the following facts.

In the New Testament the word *fire is* generally taken in its destructive sense of the fire of judgment, when metaphorically used as here. Matt. 13:42. 18:8. 25:41: Mark 9:43, Luke 9:54; 12:49; 17:29, I Cor. 3:13,15; II Thes. 1;8; Heb. 1:7; 10:27; 11:34; Jas. 3:5; II Pet. 3:T; 3:12; Jude 7, 23; Rev. 20:9, 14. Hence the presumptive argument is that its metaphorical use is here *also* taken in its unfavorable sense of judgment.

The context decides in favor of the unfavorable sense of judgment. John addressed the leaders of Israel as a generation of vipers, a brood of snakes, a brood of the old serpent and he asked them, "who hath warned you to flee from the *wrath to come."* He warns them of near and threatening judgment when he speaks of the ax as laid on the trees and even to its roots. He compares the Messiah to the great Harvester who will thoroughly purge the threshing floor, gather the wheat into the barn and burn the chaff with unquenchable fire. Not only the preceding context, but also the following speaks of the fire of judgment, and now it must be considered as highly improbable that John would inconsistently sandwich the fire in a favorable sense between the terrible judgment fires.

The following context also decides in favor of a baptism of fiery judgment, for John's predecessor, Malachi, ended his prophecy with fire, Mal. 3:2, 3 ; 4:1-3. We have there also the same two groups, the godly and the ungodly. For the former, there will be the beneficial fire of the "Sun of righteousness with healing in his wings," but for the latter, the unbounded fires that shall burn them as stubble and leave them neither root nor branch. Hence to make this fire with Dr. Addison Alexander and others the purifying influences of the Spirit is way beside the mark.

It is very evident that John develops the figure of fire of his predecessor, Malachi, who pictured the coming of the Messiah with fire. The figure of fire is in the Scriptures not arbitrary, fitful and variable, but fixed, constant and invariable, meaning judgment whether on Calvary or in the judgments of the future. The first judgment at Eden was a flaming or fiery sword. Fire was rained down upon the cities of the plain. *Fire* consumed the sacrifices foreshadowing Calvary's judgment. Fire was not to be kindled on the sabbaths, because there will be no fiery judgments in the millennial sabbath of Christ's glorious Kingdom. All through the Scriptures the fire is emblematic of judgment and an instrument of judgment, (Gen. 19:24; Ex. 9:23; Lev. 10; Num. 11:1; 16:35; II Kings 1:10; Amos 7:4; Rev. 8:8). Hell is an everlasting fire, (Deut. 32:22; Isa. 33:14; 66:24; Mark 9:44; Jude 7; Rev. 20:10). Think of a lake of fire, Rev. 20:14. Our Savior is presented to

us seventeen times as the Judge of the world, in whose hand the Father has laid all judgment and (twenty-four times) He is put before us as the Executor of the punishment of the wicked. He, therefore, shall use the fire upon the wicked.

There were in Israel two instruments of purification: water and fire. Water was the weaker, fire the stronger medium of cleansing. John came with the weaker, Christ with the stronger of the two elements of cleansing. He boldly stated His commission in these words, "I am come to send fire on the earth." - This fire is no symbol of grace, but of awful judgment, Luke 12:49-51. Compare Num. 31:10; Isa. 48:10; Mal. 3:1, 2. It is certain then that the baptism of fire is the Lord's exercise of his judicial office in the fiery penalty of the wicked in the day of the Lord. It may nevertheless be asked why this is called a *baptism.* This question is to the point and its answer is rich in instruction for the doctrine of baptism. The baptism is here identical with the rain or outpouring of fire upon the wicked of which we read so frequently.

The purgation of the ancient world in Noah's day was by the *pouring out* of rain for forty days and nights, Gen. 7:11, 12.

The Lord *rained* brimstone and fire upon Sodom and Gomorrah, Gen. 19:24. We read that some day he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone and a horrible tempest upon the wicked, Ps. 11:6. The seven last plagues of Revelation are inflicted by the *outpouring* of the vials of his wrath, Rev. 16. The final destruction of Gog and Magog is described by a downpour of fire from heaven, Rev. 20:9. All this belongs to the baptism of fire. As we have seen heretofore, the *pouring is* called a baptism, and so the outpouring of the fire of wrath is called the baptism of fire.

More than thirty times the figure of pouring or outpouring is used in the Scriptures to indicate the infliction of God's wrath upon the wicked.

All these facts and figures of speech are divinely designed to exalt and glorify God the Son as the Judge of the universe; and the very throne of grace upon which He is now sitting shall some day be changed into the throne of judgment from which, as we see in Revelation, all the thunder and lightning, the fire and brimstone, proceed for the wicked. Judgment is the pouring or baptism of fire, while the unalterable state of the wicked is represented under the figure of an everlasting existence in the lake of fire. Both are a baptism. The pouring is the Old Testament idea of *baptizo,* while the submersion into the lake of fire is the Pauline meaning of this word.

We see then that Matt. 3:11 and its parallel passages in the Synoptics have a threefold baptism: John's water baptism, Christ's Spirit baptism at Pentecost and the fire baptism of the future judgment. John's water baptism was a ceremonial requirement foreshadowing the perfect purification by the blood of the cross. This baptism with hands foreshadowed the baptism without hands of which Col. 2:10-12 speaks. The cross was the antitypical baptism as well as the antitypical circumcision.

According to Dr. Franz Delitzsch, the foremost Hebrew scholar of his day, there are three hundred and thirty-three distinct prophecies about Christ in the Old Testament. About eighty of these were literally realized in His birth and suffering and death. This leaves fully two hundred and fifty prophecies to be fulfilled in His second coming. Though His mediatorial suffering and death are perfectly finished, and likewise His

resurrection, ascension and session at the Father's right hand, the greater part of His work is nevertheless still to be performed in the future; but this baptism of fire will be an essential part of his future mediatorial work. The greatest descriptions of this future fire baptism are found in Isa. 63:1-8 and in Rev. 16. This baptism will be a pouring out of the fire of the wrath of the Lamb. Unlike water baptism, it is not a type or symbol, but a fearful reality, a fire baptism.

CHAPTER XI

The Pentecostal Baptism in the Spirit

Many widely different views are held in regard to the so called baptism of the Spirit as it is generally named. Through a misunderstanding of this baptism, a world-wide movement in Christendom has been born about a half century ago; and though mixed with some good, much wild fire has resulted, with even some scandal and insanity, although many, we are glad to say, have now settled down to a more sedate and sedulous service for the Lord. They quite consistently take not only the water of Acts but the whole program except the raisings from the dead.

On the west coast of our land many meetings were held to "get the baptism" as they called it. No secret was made of the endeavor to work up an emotional excitement to the exclusion of the reason and the will. To "let go" was the watchword. A total oblivion of the fact, that Satan and the evil spirits look for just such an opportunity to slip into the unguarded citadel of the human heart. To add to the "let go," a "let God," does not change the situation, for Satan well knows that God will not come into the person that has set aside the God-given faculties of reason and will. Hence, after the pious exhortation to "let go" is given, the room is often filled with weeping and wailing, groaning and moaning, praying and praising, screaming, howling and laughing, while a violent emotion sweeps men and women off the seats and under the seats, rolling, writhing, foaming, shrieking, the women in hysterics and utter collapse. But these same men and women subsequently testify with satisfaction that thus they got "the baptism!"

Many who abhor these extremes nevertheless view with the late man of God, Dr. Ruben Torrey, the Pentecostal baptism as a special and most desirable endowment and enduement for service. According to Dr. Torrey, no one could serve the Lord right without this baptism, and many godly Fundamentalists have taken Torrey's view of the matter and believe that by complete self-denial and prayerful endeavor this special baptism for service will clothe God's child with power and eloquence for service in the vineyard, as they put it.

Some Californian sects have identified this particular baptism with the baptism of fire, mentioned in Matt. 3:11. In this verse we have three baptisms: John's water baptism, Christ's Spirit baptism, and his future baptism with fire. John the Baptist preached Christ's coming to judge, and this fiery judgment will be the baptism of fire. Throughout the Scriptures fire is descriptive of judgment, Gen. 19:24; Ex. 9:23; Lev. 10; Amos 7:4; II Thes. 1:8; Rev. 8:8; Isa. 66:15; 24; Matt. 13:42.

Many Christians just identify this Spirit baptism with the fulness of the Spirit of Eph. 5, but all these thoughts must be rejected as unscriptural. The Holy Spirit has given us a clear-cut idea as to the meaning of this baptism in the Spirit, as it literally reads in the text.

It must first of all be taken in vivid contrast to John's water baptism for six times this exclusive contrast between John's water and Christ's Spirit baptism is repeated. The Holy Spirit is mentioned seven times in connection with baptism, Matt. 3:11; Mark 1:8;

Luke 3:16; John 1:26; Acts 1:5; 11:16. The first passage in Matthew is representative of the first six texts and could be paraphrased thus: "I on the one hand baptize you in water with a view to a change of mind, but he on the other hand, who is coming after me, is mightier than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry; He shall baptize you in the Holy Ghost and in fire."

The contrast is here emphasized strongly into an exclusive antithesis between John as the slave, and Christ as the great Master; between John's water baptism, or Jewish purification, and Christ's Spirit baptism. Both men are here put before us as baptizers, but all else is contrast. In every Gospel this great contrast is emphasized. To slight this contrast is a grievous exegetical sin unworthy of an Expositor of the Word.

Two passages make it plain that the predictions of John were at least partially fulfilled at Pentecost. According to John 7:39 the Holy Spirit was not yet given when Jesus was the minister of the circumcision and for that reason John naturally could only baptize with water. He simply could not have baptized with or in the Spirit, even if he had possessed the right and might to do it. The other passage, which is as the hand that points to the Pentecostal outpouring, is found in Acts 1:5, where we read: "John truly baptized with water, but ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost *not many days hence."* It is evident then that the Pentecostal effusion was the baptism of the Holy Spirit. It was not individual but national for Israel. Not once do we read of an individual baptism of or in the spirit. It is always collective.

We should deeply ponder the fact that John, as an Old Testament Prophet, came with the type, the shadow, while our Lord's baptism gave the antitypical substance. John's sprinkling and affusion of the running water foreshadowed the sparkling dew and sprinkling rain of the Holy Spirit. And just as the rain in Palestine came in two parts as the early and the latter rain, so this baptism in the Spirit comes also in the early rain of Pentecost when the Spirit's power was poured out on the Israelites, whereas the latter rain will fall upon Israel not alone, but upon all flesh, i.e., according to I Cor. 15:39 upon all the fourfold flesh of men, of beasts, of fish and of fowl. This latter rain will not fall in this age, as the Pentecostal brethren think, but in the beginning of the next age, the Kingdom age.

That the exclusive contrast of John in all the Gospels and in Acts really meant to convey the thought that the water baptism would reach its end in Christ as well as the law itself is deducible from the following facts: 1. Christ never baptized with or in water. 2. He, as we have seen, never commanded water baptism. 3. In Rom. 6:4 we are said to have been baptized not into water, but into Jesus Christ and into his death. 4. In Heb. 6:1.2 we are told to leave behind the water baptisms. 5. In Heb. 9:10, 11 we are told that the water baptisms were *imposed* like a yoke until the great reformation of the High Priest. 6. Finally, we are told in Eph. 4:5 that there is for this age of grace, but one baptism. This could not be water for there are at least a score of water baptisms. Leave the many baptisms -- and cleave to the one. How could the Lord have revealed this truth plainer than he has done?

CHAPTER XII

The Baptism in Acts

The Gospels, and especially Acts, are the bulwark for the water baptizers. The book of Acts dispensationally is undoubtedly the least understood book of the Bible. In the first verse we have the golden key. In Luke, the beloved physician related what Jesus began both to do and to teach, and here he narrates what He continued to do and to teach. *When we remember that Christ was the minister of the circumcision (Israel i.e. Rom. 15:8), we find a surprising light upon the book of Acts. Thus we find that we have here primarily the Acts of the risen Lord, and that this book deals mainly with Israel and the promised Kingdom. Acts is the sublime narrative of the miraculous doings of our glorified Lord for the earthly nation Israel. The viewpoint throughout is not heavenly as in Ephesians but the powers of heaven are working upon earth.*

The general thought concerning this book is that after Christ arose and ascended to heaven, and after the outpouring of the Holy Spirit, something entirely new has begun, but this is not correct. We have here not a new beginning, but a continuation of former things, be it a new development of the things of the Gospels. Our Lord did not speak concerning the Church, but concerning the Kingdom during the forty days after His resurrection. The Apostles thought only of the Kingdom, (1:6) and from Luke 24:45 we know that their minds had been opened so that they could understand the Scriptures. They were right with their question, as appears from the answer of our Lord, for that which never comes cannot have any *times* and *seasons.*

In 1:5 we find the contrast between John's water baptism and Christ's Spirit baptism for the fifth time. The same promise and contrast is found four times in the gospels and twice in Acts.

The choice of Matthias was God's choice. He is the twelfth Apostle and not Paul as is often taught. "The lot is cast into the lap but the whole disposing thereof is from the Lord." As to the *Lot* see Lev. 16:8, 9, 10; Num. 26:55; Neh. 10:34. Peter was too rash, they claim. We know he was, but not here, because he did it with the Word and with prayer, and a believer does not act rashly when he acts in harmony with the Word and combined prayer. Further, it should be remembered (a) that Peter had received the Holy Spirit, John 20:22; (b) that his mind had been opened to understand the Scriptures, Luke 24:45; and (c) that he with the others had received private lessons for forty days from the risen Redeemer; (d) finally, the Holy Ghost has set His seal upon Matthias, for in 2:14 we read: "Peter standing up with the *eleven"* and in 6:2 He mentions the *"twelve."*

Since this is an important matter and at the same time proves that Paul was not one of the twelve, we quote Dr. Barnhouse in his periodical "Revelation":

"Paul himself recognized that he was not among the twelve apostles, for he speaks of them without including himself in the number. `And that He was seen of Cephas, then of the twelve .... And last of all He was seen of me also ....' (1 Cor. 15:5, 8). Men have made a difficulty of this, saying that there were only eleven apostles at the time, but it is

very evident that in the mind of God the twelfth, Matthias, had already been chosen, and that the Lord showed Himself to him with the other eleven. The fact that the lot was used in the choice does not mean that there was any chance in the matter. There is no chance with God. `The lot is cast into the lap, but the whole disposing thereof is of the Lord' (Prov. 16:33). Before God's Word was completed and the Holy Spirit had come to indwell men, God many times used this means to reveal His will, as in the case of Achan, and in the dividing of the land of Canaan among the tribes. It is true that the disciples had not yet been baptized by the Holy Spirit into the Body of Christ, but the Lord had breathed upon them and said, `Receive ye the Holy Ghost.' They were distinctly able to appeal to Him for guidance. We may as well argue that no Old Testament believer had any right ever to make a choice, as to argue that these men could not make a choice that could be guided by the Lord before the day of Pentecost. Paul was an apostle, but he was an apostle of a special class, ‘one born out of due time,' an apostle to the Gentiles. It is true that the twelve apostles will be seated on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel (Matt. 19:28) and that their names will appear on the twelve foundations of the New Jerusalem, as the names of the twelve tribes will appear on its twelve gates. But Paul, as the apostle to the Gentiles, is not numbered with these, but retains a separate and special position."

Yes, indeed, and Paul could never have fulfilled the requirements of verses 21 and 22. It is of supreme importance to see that he never worked under the "Great Commission." The Church-truth was revealed to Paul. Hence Peter could not speak of it.

Pentecost is a glorious fulfillment of the five times repeated promise of the Spirit baptism in contradistinction to John's water baptism. Let us at the same time not forget, however, that Pentecost was a Jewish feast which had been observed for many centuries only by the Jews. Even the Jews in the dispersion came to the homeland to celebrate this feast. And so it was here. Many Jews and proselytes were gathered from all parts of the earth at the time of this feast. After Is. 53 was fulfilled to Israel in the suffering, death, and resurrection of the Messiah, Is. 54 and 55 could be preached to them. Even Paul first preached the gospel of the kingdom to them until the things which happened in Acts 28: 23-28, when the Jews went away and were hardened and this hardening of Israel had been repeated seven times. At that time not a change of dispensation but of operation took place.

The outpouring of the Holy Spirit was not the fulfillment of Joel's prediction that the Spirit was to be poured out upon all *flesh.* According to I Cor. T5:39 there are four kinds of flesh and the Spirit was not poured out upon all this flesh, and not even upon the flesh of all men, but only upon some Jews and those who had become Jews. The Pentecostal outpouring was the definite fulfillment of John's prophecy concerning the mighty one who was to baptize with the Spirit and not with water. This is the great baptism which has five or six times been put in contra-distinction to the water baptism. Consequently we do not read that the Apostles were baptized with water at Pentecost but the others were baptized with water *with a view* to *obtain (EIS) remission of sins* as we read in 2:38. Hence, baptism was here needed for salvation.

No intelligent and Spirit-taught preacher would preach today what Peter preached in his Pentecostal sermon about repentance, baptism, and the gift of the Holy Spirit. For Israel nothing else could be preached, because (a) they had to *repent*. i.e., *change*

their mind about Jesus of Nazareth; (b) they had to be washed according to law, thereby acknowledging themselves filthy, and (c) they would receive then the *gift* of the Holy Spirit, including the other gifts.

It is evident, therefore, that in connection with the Jewish preacher and hearers, and the Kingdom gifts and miracles, the water baptism is in its right place. There were the following miracles: the rushing wind, the tongues of flame, the speaking in tongues, the miracles of hearing and understanding, the strange tongues, the mass conversion and mass filling with the Spirit, and the communion of goods. This all points to the Kingdom signs.

In 3:19 Peter preaches again repentance and he puts it before conversion, and both are given as a condition for the Millennium, which he describes here as the *"times of refreshing from His face"* and *"the times of restitution of all things,"* the former phrase referring to Israel, the latter to creation and the nations.

We see in this chapter also that although the temple had been declared to be a den of thieves, yet Peter and John went up to the temple to pray. Our Lord had pronounced destruction upon it, but in His longsuffering He gave them more than thirty years to repent. He had revealed all His virtues to Israel, except the one of longsuffering, and this we see in Acts. The Gospel is offered first and most of all to Israel by Peter, Stephen and Paul, but the Jews were hardening themselves unto the awful judicial hardening of God as described in Acts 28. At Pentecost there were 3 divisions in regard to the harvest: (a) Israel received the main harvest; (b) the corners were for the *poor;* and (c) the gathering of the ears were for the strangers. Antitypically we find the gospel sent to the poor Samaritans in chapter 8 by Philip, who preached concerning the *Kingdom* and not the gospel of grace for the Body. Let it be further noticed that he cast out the unclean spirits, cured the palsied and the lame, brought mass conversion to poor Samaria, and brought even proud Simon to his knees; the angel of the Lord spoke to him, and the Spirit in a special way spoke to him, and the Spirit of the Lord caught him away and transplanted him to Azotus. In the midst of all these miracles we find water baptism, and no wonder, for no Gentile, let alone a Eunuch, could be incorporated into Israel without water baptism, which could not wash away the gall of Simon, but which was necessary for a Gentile to become incorporated into Israel. If he had been a proselyte as some think, then we are still more on Jewish ground. He came at any rate from a Jewish city and a Jewish temple, read in a Jewish book of a Jewish prophet concerning a Jewish Messiah about a Jewish baptism, for seeing he had no chapter division in Isaiah's scroll, he must have read 52:15 and received his notion of baptism from that place, and finally, he was taught by a Jewish deacon and baptized in a Jewish way. No one can deny then that everything was Jewish here and that his baptism was but natural, and if the eunuch was immersed, then also Philip, because we read that both went down into the water and both came out of it.

In 9:18 Paul is baptized with two baptisms: water and the Spirit, while years later he tells us that there is only one, Eph. 4:5. Here again we have many miracles and externalisms: (a) Saul was miraculously saved; (b) the men did not hear the voice calling, "Saul, Saul," but only a sound and they stood speechless and trembling; (c) Christ spoke from heaven to Ananias; (d) Ananias laid hands on Saul which was said in the year 64 A. D. a thing to be left behind (Heb. 6:1, 2) ; (e) Saul's blindness was cured. It is

no wonder then that during the transitional stage and as concomitant with miracles and externalisms, we should find water baptism. It simply belonged to the whole Jewish regime, Heb. 9:10. In Acts, Paul as a Jew, had to keep the whole law, so too the law of cleansing.

Of 10:44-48 the same can be said. There were great miracles and tongues, visions and angelic visitors, and according to 10:2, Cornelius was a proselyte for he was *devout, feared God, gave much alms to the Jews, and prayed to the God of Israel alway.* He also received two baptisms: water and the Spirit, which some time later was excluded by the statement of Eph. 4:5. Cornelius received the *gift of the Holy Ghost* and this included all the gifts of Rom. 12 and I Cor. 12 in that day. The water baptism is here fully in line with the Jewish Kingdom ground and Kingdom miracles, yet it is remarkable that Peter himself did not baptize, and also that Cornelius and his house were not baptized according to the precept of the Great Commission.

In 13:24 we see that John the Baptist had preached a national repentance to Israel, and that he preached a national water baptism as a means to the national repentance.

In 15:28, 29, baptism is not mentioned among the *"necessary things"* which the Gentiles were to keep.

The baptism of Lydia, 16:15, took place on a Jewish Sabbath, in a Jewish place of prayer, and by a man who was a Jew to the Jews. Paul also in those days circumcised Timothy. Remember it was a household baptism by a Jewish miracle worker, 16-26. Also, the Jailer and his household were baptized, a baptism which again was the concomitant of at least four great wonders: (a) The Spirit did not allow them to go into Bithynia. (b) The man of Troas called him to Europe. (c) The evil spirit was cast out of the damsel. And (d) the Lord delivered them out of prison by an earthquake. Here also the water goes with the other signs.

Apollos knew only the baptism of John, Acts 18:25, and it can readily be understood that Aquila and Priscilla, who had been taught by Paul, could expound to this eloquent man the way of God *more perfectly. Only* the baptism of John. Many folk have never paid attention to this important little word *only,* which we find also in Heb. 9:10: "Only meats and drinks and divers baptisms and carnal ordinances, imposed on them until the time of reformation." Paul at this time acted in everything like a Jew, 18:18, and so in 19:1-7 he had two baptisms: that of John's baptism in the name of the Lord Jesus, and the baptism of the Holy Ghost. The transition time was not yet ended, but five years later he had but one baptism and no laying on of hands, Heb. 6:1.2 Eph. 4:5. The Jewish temple was still standing. Israel was yet in the land. Jewish preachers preached yet the Jewish kingdom truth and performed Jewish miracles. The twelve stayed mainly at Jerusalem; the severity of the law was still felt according to the rule; "The soul that sinneth shall die" - and Ananias and Sapphira dropped dead. They were so Jewish, that the conversion of Cornelius made quite a stir and Peter had to defend himself for going unto a Gentile, and especially in the first twelve chapters Jerusalem was the center and criterion of truth, since the Word of the Lord was to go forth from Jerusalem.

CHAPTER XIII

The Baptisms and the Transition Period

We have seen formerly that the baptisms were as purifications, an integral part of the law. Now the Word clearly teaches that the law was fulfilled by Christ, Matt. 6:17, Rom. 5:18; 8:3, Acts 15:24; 28:3; Gal. 2-6; Eph. 2:15, Col. 2:14; Heb. 7. Israel had rejected everything God ever gave to them: the Prophets, the law, the Forerunner of the Messiah, the Messiah himself, the Twelve, and later Paul, the Spirit and the Gospel, and they had made the house of the Father a den of robbers. Hence, the order came, cut it down. John saw the ax at the root. God said cut the barren fig tree down; but there was one intercessor who prayed for lengthened mercy with the desire to dig and dung around the tree. It is on Calvary's tree that the Intercessor prayed: "Father, forgive them, for they know not what they do!" And we know that He was always heard and answered. The Book of Acts is God's marvelous answer to that prayer for there God gives His Spirit and the Gospel of the Kingdom to Israel first of all with many signs and wonders. Here God fertilizes the tree with the gospel of the risen Son.

Here we see that God always addresses Israel either exclusively as at Pentecost or gives them in their synagogues and elsewhere the honor of priority. The many signs and wonders were the many Kingdom signs. There were mass healings by shadow making, raisings from the dead, and angel visits from heaven. The Spirit was not once but four times poured out. There were not only speaking miracles in regard to the tongues, but also hearing wonders by which the Spirit-filled could understand every strange tongue. There was a Christian communism and there were special and immediate judgments upon the wicked just as during the coming Kingdom. There were Prophets, predictions, fulfillments, miraculous earth quakes. The Jews still had not only their circumcision, but they kept the whole law in all its details, even all its fasts, and feasts, and vows; yea, even bloody offerings were brought by Paul nearly thirty years after the Lamb of Calvary had been slain for our sacrifice. Every Sabbath, of course, was strictly kept.

Inasmuch as the whole law was kept, it was but natural that the baptisms, or purifications should also be kept by the Jews, and by the Gentile proselytes of righteousness. Hence, we see in every chapter in the Book of Acts, several miracles, and with these miracles and the keeping of the law we find several baptisms as well as circumcisions.

The Book of Acts is the rich seed bed of many sectarists in our day. The Adventists paint here to the Sabbath keepings. The "Tonguists" here appeal to the tongues, both speaking and hearing. The Christian communists appeal to the communism of Acts. The Spirit baptizers refer us to the Pentecostal outpouring. The Fire baptizers point to the tongues of fire. And so the Baptists refer us to the many baptisms found here. What shall we say to these things? This, that Acts is not the first chapter of Church history, but the last chapter of Israel's law and Kingdom in the New Testament. In answer to Christ's prayer on the cross the barren fig tree was fertilized with the glad news of the risen Messiah for over thirty years.

Even till the very end of Acts there are three great miracles. First, though all were shipwrecked and thrown into the water, they all came safe to land, even those who could not swim. God literally fulfilled his pledge to Paul, 27:24. Second, he fulfilled the promise of Mark 16:18, that the believers would take up poisonous serpents without hurt; and third, Paul healed not only the Governor Publius, but all the sick of the island Malta and there must have been many, so that it was a mass healing.

But almost immediately after this, something epochal and pivotal happened that has entirely changed the course of history until our day, and that nevertheless is hardly known by the Church of Christ. It was nothing less than a change in God's dealings and operations with the children of men. Ever since the call of Abraham nearly two and a half millenniums ago, God had dealt with just one little nation. As the Psalmist said, He had not so dealt with any other nation. When Christ was on earth, His ministry was exclusively to the Jews, for he repeatedly declared that He had not been sent but to the lost sheep of the house of Israel. The disciples might not even go to the Samaritans, who could with some degree of justice be called half Israelites. At Pentecost Peter three times addressed the crowds as men of Israel. During the whole Acts period of thirty-three years God always went with the glad news of the risen Christ first of all to the Jews. In the Gospels the motto was: alone to the Jews, in Acts it was: first to the Jews.

Hence, even when Paul came to Rome, he went first to the Jews and had a Jewish Conference with them, which proved most momentous and consequential. These Jews in the metropolis of the world represented world Jewry. Would Israel, who in Jerusalem and Judea and in all other parts of the world had rejected the risen Messiah, finally accept Him yet in this hub of the then known world? This was the question agitating in Paul's righteous soul. He reasoned with them out of Moses and the Prophets and from dawn to dusk to prove that Jesus was the Messiah. And what was the result? The effect was here as everywhere; Israel rejected, as a whole, the Messiah to the bitter end and had at this date rejected everything that God had ever given in His special grace from heaven.

It was at the end of this momentous and most significant Conference that the words of Isaiah 6:10 were repeated for the seventh time, that they heard and did not understand; saw, and did not perceive, while their heart had waxed gross, so that they as a nation should not be converted and be healed. This awful pronouncement was the mighty word of divine judgment that laid Israel for its sins under the judgment of judicial hardness and blindness. With Israel, the law stopped functioning. Now came the *metathesis,* of the law of which Heb. 7:12 speaks, by which the law was transferred from Israel’s past to the future of Israel, when this same law will be written on the tables of their hearts, that they may walk in his statutes. With Israel set aside the law was set aside - not abrogated or nullified! - and with the law the purifications or baptisms; and with the baptisms all the miracles, prerogatives and priorities of Israel. Though we can not say that the Body of Christ started here, we have a right to say that God now stopped his special dealings with Israel (*Lo-Ammi*) as a nation and inaugurated the age of pure grace, and pure faith without the works of the law and without the purifications of the law just as we have it in this long day of grace.

From that day on, the miracles from heaven have ceased, except of course the miracles of answered prayer, the miracle of the new creation, and the wonders of God's special providences. In answer to the question whether miracles have ceased, we must be careful to define our terms well. What do we mean with miracles? According to some, miracles are only a violation of the laws of nature; but according to this view sin is the greatest and the most universal miracle. By miracles we mean here Scripturally the special signs and extraordinary acts that God performed anciently through his prophets, then through the great Prophet and his Apostles during the Gospels and Acts periods, by which the sick are healed, the eyes of the blind opened, the ears of the deaf unstopped, the lepers cleansed, the devils cast out, the dead raised, the hungry fed, the storms stilled, and men walked upon the waters of the sea, as our Lord and Peter did.

All these special Jewish miracles ceased when God discontinued for this age His special dealings with Israel as a nation, while of course His miracles of nature and grace and special providences continued in the course of history till this day. When He worked with Israel, He worked as the God of Israel “Who alone doeth wondrous things," Ps. 72:18*. The special miracles belong to Israel as well as the law and the temple, and the divers baptisms.*

A careful student who will pay attention to a rightly divided Word can convince himself of the fact that of old there were miracles only when God dealt with his people Israel. The real miracles commenced with the call of Abram and especially with the call of Moses. There were no miracles for Israel in Egypt till the Exodus. There were no miracles during and after the Exile when Israel was in sin, but great wonders reappear with the coming of the Messiah into the world. He did so many signs and wonders that if all were written in books, the world could not contain them, according to the testimony of John.

It is passing strange, to say the least, that Bible students have not paid heed to the fact that, when Paul, solemnly, and for the seventh time, lay that ancient judgment of Isaiah 6:10 upon the world Jewry at Rome; he peremptorily dismissed the Jews, the law and the miracles, the prophets and fulfillments, with all the nine things mentioned in Rom. 9:4, 5 went temporarily away with the Jews to make place for the new regime of pure faith and pure grace all apart from the law-works. And with the setting aside of Israel's regime went all the purifications of the law. The waters as part of the law went with the law.

Scripture and facts fully harmonize here too. We may look where we will, but we can find after this dispensational cleavage of Acts 28 not any miraculous healing except by prayer as we find it today, not any angel visit, not any raising from the dead, not any miraculous earthquake, for Paul had to stay in jail. We now find no more prophets or predictions; no more sabbaths and sacrifices; no more fasts and feasts or vows; no more pleadings with Israel as a nation; no more Jewish priority; no more Jewish synagogues to visit; no more law and legal purifications.

This dispensational boundary line is so transparent that even a little child can see through it, but it seems to have been hidden from the wise and the prudent theologians of the Church. They think that the Church age of grace commenced with Christ's

resurrection, and this certainly was the greatest miracle of all history, but due to Christ's intercession on the cross, He extended fully thirty years of mercy to the sinful nation, and His pleadings in Acts were the result.

Israel is the nation with minutely prescribed rites, elements, forms, ordinances, and a religion of just so and not otherwise. Modalism naturally goes with ritualism and legalism; but Israel committed the great national sin of unbelief concerning the Messiah, John 1:11, 12. Israel *would* not believe this was Israel's national sin. Israel finally *could* not believe and this was the great national judgment, as we see in John 12:39, 40. In Acts we see the wrath of God fast overtaking them until in Acts 28 the nation is judicially blinded and set aside. There was in that period a transition away from this wondrous nation with all its wonders, and prescribed religious forms unto the signless Church without prescribed forms and rites. It is utterly inconsistent to pick out the water baptisms of Acts and repudiate the miracles of tongues, mass healings, resurrections, earthquakes, sudden judgments, prophecies, angel visits, Sabbaths, sacrifices, trances, visions, voices, outpourings, communion of goods, etc. These stand or fall together. The accepting of these baptisms have led other sects boldly into fire baptisms, baptisms for forgiveness, tongues and other heresies ostensibly based upon Acts.

Even when granted that the water baptisms of Acts might be lifted out from the midst of all the other external things and miracles, then they would not provide a basis for immersion, for the water only trickles where the eunuch was baptized as we have seen when there in 1927, Acts 8:35-39. Saul could not have been immersed for he was baptized on his feet. We read he *"arose and was baptized."* In order to be immersed one must not arise but lie down. No intelligent Baptist preacher will today baptize a believer for this purpose i.e., "remission of sin," Acts 2:38. There are at least a dozen miracles in Acts 8; who now gives any man the right to take the one material rite and leave the miracles as belonging to the past? With this method we stand dumb before the Pentecostalists and other sects. There is a gospel of supposition in regard to the modalism in baptism. It is *supposed* that the apostles dipped three thousand persons in a few hours. It is *supposed* that Ananias took Paul to a stream and there dipped him under the water, 9:18. It is *supposed* that Peter took Cornelius and his family of adults to some pool or stream and immersed them all. It as *supposed* that Paul took the jailer and all his household of adults to some stream at midnight to dip them, Acts 16:30-33. It is *supposed* that a whole nation can go dryshod and be immersed at the same time, I Cor. 10:1; Exodus 15:19. It is *supposed* that John immersed the millions of Jerusalem and Judea and all the region round about. Altogether too much is taken for granted by our brethren.

CHAPTER XIV

Baptism in Romans

Is water baptism a burial with Christ? This is a claim often put forward by the brethren who glory in immersion, but the Word does not say so. We know full well that we read in Rom. 6:4 and in Col. 2:12 that we are *buried* with Him in or by baptism, but this does not give a shadow of proof for the generally held dogma. Most expositors, it is true, think of water baptism in Rom. 6:4, but this is a serious error and can easily be refuted. If there is water baptism in Rom. 6:4, immersionism would not necessarily be correct, as the graves in Palestine are not always down but often hundreds of feet up in the air, but then the Papal doctrine of baptismal regeneration is correct. The Anglican theologians always base their baptismal regeneration upon this text. See the work on Regeneration by Bishop H.U. Onderdonk. And if there is water in Rom. 6:4, these men are correct. We are constrained to say, however, with Dr. Godbey in his commentary on this passage: "God forbid that we should run into papistical dogmas of baptismal regeneration by giving a materialistic interpretation of this passage. It does not say: *baptized into water,* but: *into Jesus Christ.* Hence, the construing of it simply to mean water baptism, materializes God and runs into idolatry." Many of the newer expositors begin to see this in our day. John Brown, in his famous commentary on Romans, has this on said passage: "The phrase `baptized into Jesus Christ' occurs only here and in Gal. 3:27, and cannot be understood of the baptism by water." Moses Stuart has this on the passage: *"The being baptized into his death, therefore, is* an internal, moral, spiritual thing." The great Calvinist Shedd has this: "This word (buried), contrary to the opinion of many commentators, has no reference to the rite of baptism, because the burial spoken of is not in water, but in a sepulchre. The word means burn, inurn, enter, entomb. Burial and baptism are totally diverse ideas and have nothing in common." Campbell Morgan says on the word *buried:* "He, of course, referred to that work of the Spirit whereby in answer to faith men enter into actual relationship with Christ." W. R. Newell, first rightly maintained that the Spirit of God would never say to men merely baptized with water: *"reckon that ye are dead unto sin."* Venn remarks, of the common water-view of this passage: "This view cannot be reconciled with the doctrine of justification by faith alone." W. G. William writes: "The words, *'buried with him,'* or more exactly, put in the grave with him, are not figurative, but literal, and mean that we were laid in the literal tomb of the Arimathean with the dead body of Jesus (though, of course, only constructively, i.e., imputatively, mystically, representatively). To press the mode of baptism from these words, and to find proof of immersion in this passage, and in the parallel passage in Col. 2:8-12, shows ignorance of Greek and of the logical connection of the passage. Such an exegesis misses the point in the passage.

Dr. James Gray has a most beautiful note on this passage in his *Christian Worker's Commentary,* which we cannot refrain from quoting: "The believer is identified with Christ in His death and resurrection, kom.6:1-10.The baptism into Jesus Christ is the rich experience, which becomes the birthright of every believer the moment he believes. He is then baptized by the Holy Spirit into the body of which

Christ is the Head. I Cor. 12:13; and being so baptized he is considered as one with Christ as any member of a human body is one with the head of that body. This means, of course, that he is regarded in God's sight as having died when Christ died - he was baptized into his death. The sequel, however, must be equally true, and he is regarded as having risen from the dead when Christ rose. Hence he is now in a legal or judicial sense walking before God 'in newness of life.' " - A. C. Gaebelein, Norman Harrison, L. Tucker, S. J. Baird, R. Thomson, and many others in our day begin to see that this is the exact meaning of the passage and that we could not possibly have any water baptism here. Many expositors would have never fallen into the erroneous exposition, if they had not been biased or blinded by prejudice and tradition or if they had possessed a clear view of the Pauline doctrine of union of the saints with the Savior. Paul teaches in this chapter this union of believers with Christ, and he uses to this end the words *baptism* and *planting.* They both stand for initiation and identification. Paul always uses the words *baptism* and *baptize* in the same sense except once, and then he thanks God that he did not baptize any of the many baptized Corinthians save three. Even in I Cor. 10:2 he uses baptism in this sense of initiation and identification. Israel was initiated into the leadership of Moses. Four times it is stated that they went over dry ground, Ex. 14:29, and yet old and young were baptized. Also our Lord uses the word *baptism* in this sense in Matt. 20:22. Also in Col. 2:12, Paul is thinking of identification with Christ in His death. As Thomson remarks, it would be anomalous to introduce anything physical or tangible here.

We should think here, not of the water baptism, but of the one great baptism described in I Cor. 12:13, Gal. 3:27; Eph. 4:5; Col. 2:10-12. The following grounds should settle this for every unbiased believer.

1. In the Greek we have here not merely a baptism but *the* baptism, i.e., the only well-known, the unique baptism. Baptism in general makes the reader think only of water baptism.

2. All believers have this particular baptism. *We,* in Paul's letters stands for all the believers, but all believers have not been in "the watery grave." Brother Ironside feels this difficulty and in his note on Col. 2:11 he says: "Nor is this to say that persons who for various reasons, valid or otherwise, may not have been scripturally baptized are not in Christ. In drawing an illustration from what is scripturally correct, one does not unchristianize those who fall short either because of ignorance or willfulness." We appreciate the largeheartedness of our late brother, but he has missed Paul's argument. In Col. 2:11 as well as here, we have not simply an illustration but glorious facts which are true of all the saved. All truly saved people have this baptism, and yet they have not all been immersed. Here is no possibility of ignorance or willfulness - no dodging the issue, because all believers have this baptism. It is high time that this should be emphasized and recognized.

3. This *baptism* is not the *burial, as is* generally taught, but the *dia* with the genitive, points to baptism rather as the undertaker through which we were entombed with Christ. This fully harmonizes with the thought that the one baptism is meant, because through the operation of that baptism we have been identified with the death, burial, and

resurrection of Christ. No water baptism could ever accomplish this. Believers are alive in Christ and it is a ghastly crime to bury the living.

4. With water baptism you take the same old sinner out that you put in, but with this baptism the old man is put in and the new man is taken out, as is clear from the following context and the exhortations in this chapter. "Reckon ye yourselves to be dead indeed unto sin," Rom.6:11. God has left the old man forever buried without flowers.

5. The old and general interpretation, which sees here only water baptism, does not do justice to the beautiful contrast which we have in this passage between the burial and the resurrection. They materialize the burial and spiritualize the resurrection, whereas both are equally real and spiritual.

6. As Shedd has well said, the word for *buried* can point to a burning and inurning, but *never to a going down into the watery grave.* The whole idea is absurd and paganistic, and could have been upheld so long only through the awful power of traditionalism. No standard Lexicon of Creek ever defines baptism as a burial.

7. The following image of the one *plant is* never materialized into a material plant, and then logical consistency demands from the expositor that he should neither do so with the baptism or burial.

8. Never in all the Word is water baptism put before us as a burial. The graves in the Holy Land are often hundreds of feet above the ground and it is against the symbolism of all Scriptures to tell believers to go down. Whenever the Bible saints went down, there was a moral slip of some kind. Our official seat is with Christ in *epourania, i.e.,* the upper heavens; and God would not tell us to go down into the element which is still under the curse. The wicked always go down and our call is ever up, Col. 3:1-4.

Confusion would be ended in this matter as soon as believers would understand the glorious union with our Lord in crucifixion, death, burial, resurrection, session in the heavenlies and future glorification. This mystical union is the most comprehensive Pauline truth, which sheds rays of light upon our justification, sanctification, our eternal security, our not being under law but under grace, and even upon the pre-tribulation theory of the rapture, as in Him we could never be struck by the wrath of God, and so it also gives light upon our baptism, because in Him we have been lifted above all legalisms, materialisms, externalisms, and waters of death.

Finally, the fruit of this baptism is glorious, whereas we know that water baptism, in whatever form administered, has never had any sanctifying influence upon anyone. Many churches are filled with Modernists who were once immersed, but not baptized into Christ and into his death.

CHAPTER XV

Paul's Praise for Not Baptizing

This praise is found in I Cor. 1:14-17. The thanksgiving of the apostle of the Gentiles is most significant, when we come to analyze it in this connection. It has not received the emphasis it deserves for various reasons.

First, it shows that Paul never commanded water baptism for it would have been utterly anomalous and even preposterous first to command a rite and then to glory that he did not keep it. In fact it would be thoroughly inconsistent to first teach for the Gentiles perfect freedom from the law. and then to put them under the water law. Such inconsistency cannot be expected from the man of Tarsus.

Second, it showed that Paul was not a Baptist preacher nor any ritual preacher, whether Roman or Protestant, for then he could have never used this thanksgiving; but on the reverse, he would then have glorified God for baptizing many instead of not any, or just a few.

Third, we see here as an interesting sideline of truth, that Paul did not keep a baptismal record for after mentioning Crispus and Gaius as exceptions, he mentions still later from memory the household of Stephanas and meaningfully adds: "I know not whether I baptized any other." One glance in his baptismal record would have precluded this statement. Should a great missionary and church organizer not keep a baptismal record? If there had been as many baptisms as now, there certainly would have been a record.

Fourth, we see here clearly that Paul did not coordinate the Word and "Sacraments" as Protestants now so generally do, but he contrasted the baptism to the preaching of the Gospel. This exclusive contrast or contradiction has not received the attention it merits. The late Dr. Harry Ironside never baptized anyone in his large Moody Church. When this writer asked him for the reason of this, he answered in this word of Paul: "Christ sent me not to baptize, but to preach the Gospel"; - then I answered: "This is fine, but this applies equally to your assistant Pastor, and to every preacher," to which he could not agree.

Fifth, it clearly disproves the false doctrine of baptismal regeneration, for in that case Paul would have glorified that there were not any, or at least not many, regenerated, and this would have made his thanksgiving positively wicked. With glee this word has been hurled against the sacramentarians with their sacramental grace, but remember, this boast of Paul proves far more than is generally and superficially thought.

Sixth, this praise further demonstrates, that there is and cannot be any real spiritual blessing in water baptism whatsoever. It shows beyond the shadow of a doubt that there is no baptismal grace, for under no circumstances and for no reason whatsoever could and would Paul ever have thanked God for not baptizing, if there had been only the least blessing inherent in it.

It has been objected that Paul thus thanked God with a view to the abuse made of his name and work. This is fully correct, but the deduction made from this fact is incorrect, for listen, it was a stated rule and principle with our apostle never to forsake a truth for the abuse of that truth. According to this fatal principle, we would have to surrender all truth, because it has been abused. Think only of the doctrine of grace and justification without the law works. Though he knew that these truths were hated and abused, he never faltered to teach and apply them boldly.

This praise of Paul simply tells us that there cannot be any good whatsoever in baptism, no comfort, no sanctity, no separation, no zeal, no sign, no testimony, no burial, no divine ordinance, no following of Jesus into the waters of death, for as soon as we put any blessing in it we are shut up to the conclusion, that Paul thanked God that this blessing was not there. This reasoning is exegetically sound; but just as it went with the Talmudic *tabalings,* or immersions, until this day, because of the traditions of the elders, - so the Church of Christ also has with all too little passion for the rock-bottom facts of God's Word shown a great zeal for the traditions of the elders. Our Lord said that the leaders of His day *paralyzed* the Word of God by means of their traditions from the fathers, and we find after two thousand years the same constellation of the spirits; indifference to the exact Word and will of God and a great zeal for the words of men.

In Paul's estimate baptism could neither have been a confession of Christ or of sin, for then he would have thanked God that so few had confessed Christ or their sin, and this idea is absurd, of course. Neither did he believe that it was a matter of obedience for in that case he would have thanked God that so few had been obedient. And again, it is equally certain that he saw no burial or resurrection in baptism, because it is entirely unthinkable that he would have thanked God that none or a few only had been buried and raised with Christ. Nor is it a matter of good conscience for them he would have thanked God that this was absent.

That Paul does not mean to apply this praise to the peculiar circumstances in Corinth alone, as has been averred, is evident from the fact that his statement is as broad and as general as his preaching. Just as he was sent not only to Corinth to preach, but everywhere, so, by virtue of the absolute contrast he draws, he was sent nowhere to baptize. Everywhere to preach, nowhere to baptize, and this proves by the way, that he was not one of the twelve and did not work under the mandate of the so called Great Commission. The circumstances in Corinth do not in any way circumscribe his argument, for regardless of reason, place, and purpose, all must admit that he did thank God for not baptizing, and he simply could have never done this, if there had been any real benefit in it whatsoever. Could slanderous Corinthians ever be a reason for a man like Paul to stop doing good? The Lord's Supper was also greatly abused in Corinth, but Paul did not put this aside, but reformed it in detail upon a special revelation from heaven. It is a standing rule in sound theology that the abuse of a truth, never takes away the use of that truth. If water baptism was then deformed, why did he not reform it? Negatively, because he had no revelation from heaven about it, and positively, he knew that it was not God's order for this day of grace, but had to disappear with all the signs and miracles given to Israel. The Church had to live by faith alone and this excludes signs, visions, angel visits, and material rites like baptism.

CHAPTER XVI

Baptized Into Christ

We read in Gal. 3:27: "For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ." The phrase "as many as" does not mean with Paul that only some believers had received this baptism. It is the same phrase as is used in Rom. 6:3, but there as well as here he spoke of all the believers. He says here emphatically, addressing the churches of Galatia, "Ye all are the children of God by faith in Jesus Christ." First, all the believers are participants of this baptism. Now all through the ages there have been many sects like the Quakers who did not believe in water baptism, and yet were truly hiding by faith in Christ and therefore had received this particular baptism. All the godly Quakers who reject water baptism as contrary to God's will, have indubitably received this baptism and have put on Christ as their garb of righteousness and holiness.

Second, as soon as you bring water in this passage you must accept baptismal regeneration. Practically all Baptist writers admit, that if you put water in this passage it drives you promptly into the stagnant pool of baptismal regeneration, and this is one of the most universal and most pernicious errors of all Christendom; but there is no logical middleground between this error and the Pauline truth on baptism.

Third, this baptism was not merely in the name of Christ, but *into* Christ. Where the candidate formerly was in Adam, there he was by this baptism incorporated into Christ. This baptism equated a transfer from the old Adam into the new Adam from out of the curse and beyond the curse, from ruin into redemption and the refuge in Christ, where there is no condemnation or separation, Rom. 8:1, 39.

Fourth, this baptism was a putting on of Christ. If the baptizing *into* Christ has reference to the internal secret work of God, this has reference to the public work of the believer. Just as a person who puts on a lovely new garment, so the believer has accepted and confessed Christ as the Lord of his life, for whom he slaves in gratitude, as the love-slave, and whose spirit and life he now reflects by lip and life, by word and walk, by creed and conduct.

Fifth, all the modernists and other mere professors that have been immersed, are the living proofs of the fact that water baptism could here not be meant for they simply have not put on Christ. They go around in the garb of their own self-righteousness or of worldliness, but not in the mantle of his righteousness and holiness. Their unbelief and life give the concrete lie to this interpretation.

If now this baptism cannot be water-baptism what kind of baptism is it then? This question cannot be dodged, if we want to give a fair interpretation of this passage. In answer to this question it must be stated that we have here the one baptism of Eph. 4: 5, 6, which is valid for this day of grace and whereby we are invisibly taken out of the old Adam and his curse to be unified with the new or last Adam, thus establishing the most glorious union with the risen Lord.

This union was altogether *new* and is not found in the Old Testament or in the Gospels. This union is entirely *unique.* In all marital and moral unions, there is not any union like this. All human unions are breakable and violable, and are actually broken with death, but death can never break this union, nor any creature in heaven, earth, or hell. It is a *federal* union in that it is based upon the covenant of peace between the Father and the Son. This union is *forensic* in that God as Judge imputes all that Christ has done to the believers. God gave them from eternity to the Son, but in this wondrous, glorious baptism he joins them to the Son. It is a *vitalizing* union for the saints have now the same resurrection-life as Christ, Rom. 8:10; I Cor. 12:12, 13; II Cor. 5:17; Gal. 4:19; I John 3:24. Christ is now not only the source and succorer of our life, but He is our life, Col. 3:3, 4.

This is a *spiritual* union, made by the Spirit, Eph. 4:1-6. All that are joined to the Lord are one spirit with him, I Cor. 6:17; 12:12. It is an *organic* union as that of the head and body. The head controls, cares, plans, and protects the various members of the body and bears the burdens for the body.

It is a *liberating* union. If saints now want to know what their position is before God, then they only have to ask what the standing of Christ is before the Father. If the Head, who once was made under the law, Gal. 4:4, is not now under the law, then neither are we. If Christ is not now under the rites and ritualisms as once He certainly was, Rom. 15:7, 8, then neither are those who have been unified through this baptism into Him.

This union is a *resurrection*-union with the risen Lord. This mystical union was never made with the Christ of the incarnation at Bethlehem, but with the crucified and risen Lord. Hence, if saints want to know whether they should follow Christ in the waters of death and into the watery grave, they should ask themselves if the risen Lord ever went into a watery grave and under the element of the curse, and they should know that they have been raised with him in newness of life, Rom. 6:5-14; Col. 2:13, 20; 3:1, 2.

It is an *all-embracive* union, since all true believers were crucified, buried, baptized, quickened, raised, ascended, seated, and hidden with Him and all will also soon appear with Him in the glory. It is for the union and communion of the saints of vast importance to see that not only those immersed in much water, but also those sprinkled with little water, and just as well those who have not, religiously, touched any water, are truly baptized with this baptism before God. A sound grasp of this fact would eliminate all exclusivism in regard to church membership, the Lord's table, and all Christian fellowship.

However, it is nevertheless an *exclusive* union in that it excludes all the unsaved. No science or culture, no church membership, rite, or religion can ever bring about this union but only this baptism in the way of faith. It not only excludes all unbelievers, but also all externalism, formalism, legalism, ritualism, traditionalism, and all exclusivism.

This union is *effective* and most *consequential,* transforming the lives of the believers. All the communion of saints is based upon it. All Christian sympathy, alms giving, and helpfulness flows from it. Also all weeping with those who weep, and rejoicing with those who rejoice. Here are found all the fellows as e.g., fellow-laborers, Phil. 4:3, 4 ; 4:3, 4, 15, 17; fellow-heirs, Eph. 3:6; Rom. 8:17; fellowservants, Col. 1:8; 4:7, 12; Rev. 22:9; fellow-soldiers, Eph. 6:11-24, fellow-prisoners, Philem. 1; Col. 4:12;

Phil. 2:25. This union rules and regulates every detail of a believer's life and is the only basis for sound Pauline mysticism.

It is an *interminable* union not only, but an *eternal* one in that it was laid through God's election in eternity, Eph. 1:4, and it never will be dissolved. If the Arminian saints who always dread to be cut off from Christ would have a wholesome grasp of this glorious baptism and how it submerges us forever into the risen Lord never to be taken out of Him, then they would never fear that a true saint can fall away and be lost forever. Eternal security is wrapped up in this glorious baptism.

This union is almost exclusively *Pauline* and *Johannine.* Paul especially has made this union of the believers with the risen Lord the leading thought of his theology. In view of this wondrous and indissoluble union, we cannot suppress the wish that the day might be hastened when all the saints would see the divine baptism, that, without any human officiator, accomplishes such a glorious union with the risen Lord.

This union, effected by the one baptism, is therefore of the utmost practical value for our Christian life in that it lifts us sky-high above all sectarianism and heresy. With our baptism into the risen Lord we cannot be under the law, since our Head is not under the law. Neither can we be Sabbatharians, since in Him we have been lifted far above Jewish sabbaths. Nor can we go down under the element of the curse, since He was once made a curse for us, and since we now have been made to sit with Him in super-heavenly places. Having been quickened, i.e., made alive, with him and now having our life hid with Christ in God, we find it to be utterly contradictory to be told to "be buried in the waters of death."

CHAPTER XVII

The One Baptism of Ephesians

This word (Eph. 4:4-6) must be taken in its right setting. As to time it came perhaps a year or two after the exhortation of Heb. 6 to leave the doctrine of baptisms, and now in complete harmony with this, the saints are begged to cling to this one baptism. How marvelous is the harmony of the Scriptures! Everything dovetails! Leave the many water baptisms and cleave to the one spiritual baptism! How could God have ever revealed a truth more plainly than He did in regard to this truth?

It would be inconceivable that Paul would first say that the water baptisms should be left behind, and then prescribe it here. God does not so contradict Himself in his infallible Word nor is the human author Paul so inconsistent.

Note, after the mystery of the Body, that was hid from all ages and generations, Col. 1:26 and hid in God Eph. 3:9, was here first revealed, thereupon immediately the truth of the one baptism and its vast and unique importance was stated. This baptism shows how we became one with Him.

It should further not escape our notice how earnestly and how solemnly Paul reveals this one baptism in connection with the seven-fold unity of the saints. He does not command but prays. He prays as the prisoner of the Lord. He prays with a seven-fold plea that they in all the lowliness, meekness, and gentleness of Christ may endeavor zealously to keep the perfect unity. Before the seven-fold unity, which is sanctified union, is expressed, there is this touching and heart-melting plea from this shackled man in the rat hole of Rome, here signified as the prisoner of the Lord, and not a jail-bird of Nero.

It is further evident that this one baptism is *objective* and not subjective; God-made, not man-made. The human factor is here completely eliminated. No human officiator is needed in this baptism.

This baptism is *non-material* and just as deeply *spiritual* as all the other six unities. The Body is spiritual, the Spirit, the Hope, the Lord, the one faith and the one God and Father are all equally spiritual and he who would put a material water link in this heavenly chain has simply vitiated this whole chain, for a chain is never stronger than its weakest link. It certainly would be the greatest incongruity.

This one baptism is positively *divine* and *heavenly,* since it is put on a par with the three Persons of blessed Trinity. It is just as heavenly as the Father, Son and Holy Ghost, and just as divine in its origin, character and effects.

And since this Baptism is divine and perfect, it must be *inviolable, interminable* and *unbreakable,* in fact just as well as the three Persons of Holy Trinity.

How is it possible that men could ever find water baptism in this galaxy of spiritual unities ! How could an enlightened brother like the late Dr. Harry Ironside fight here, might and main, for water baptism? He called a spiritual baptism here nonsense, simply because the Spirit had already been named, but this argument is certainly weaker than

weakness itself, for there the one and unique Person of the Spirit is mentioned, while in this baptism His most important work is named by which he makes all true believers one with the risen Lord. Most Baptist brethren readily see that this baptism simply could not be water. It would be too contradictory and altogether too incongruous to put within this golden chain of heaven one earthly and material water link, since this would vitiate the whole chain. However, there still are many who think that the apostle here actually commands immersion as the only form of water baptism, but to that view, common as it still is through Dr. H. Ironside's great influence, it need only be said that then immersion is lifted up to the high sphere of the triune God Himself, and this is considerably higher than even the most rabid immersionist brethren would like to see it lifted as it would amount to "hydrolatry."

Then, we need only to remind these brethren that there is not *one* water baptism even among our immersionist brethren. In all there are fully a score of water baptisms, but since the immersionists do not acknowledge sprinkling or pouring either in paedobaptism or in adult baptism, it is enough to remind them that even if they are agreed as to the main form of the much water, that they are by no means agreed among themselves whether there should be a baptism in the name of the Holy Trinity or just in the name of Jesus or Jesus Christ, whether the dip should be once or thrice, forward or backward, etc.

What a pity that such an exalted truth should have found such a materialistic, ritualistic application with a total oblivion of that one glorious baptism or submersion into Christ. The blinding power of the old serpent is here noticeable. What God had meant for comfort, joy and strength, man had made a materialistic and ritualistic point of debate, and for no good whatever.

A double expository sin has here been committed! God's Word of *one* baptism has been pushed aside as meaningless and worthless, while at the same time the false interpretation of a Jewish, legal rite of purifying has been read into this one baptism. What could be more bold and blatant than this contempt of God's Word on the one hand and the high esteem for man's religion on the other hand? How sly on Satan's part to substitute an ancient rite for a glorious doctrine of union.

God's numerals are always real and literal. When Israel was seventy years in captivity, it was exactly ten times seven years. When Moses fled from Egypt he was forty, when he was called to Egypt, he was eighty, when he had been forty years with Israel in the desert, he died at the age of three times forty or one hundred twenty years. When Christ was presented he was forty days old, forty days he was tempted of *Satan*, and forty days he taught after his resurrection. When God says thousand in Rev. 20, he means a thousand; and similarly here, when he says *one* baptism, he does not mean twenty, but one baptism.

It is a remarkable fact that all Christians will admit a six-fold unity, but God has made a perfect seven-fold unity. There is a marvelous consensus or unanimity in regard to the six to the exception of the one baptism. What a superlative blessing it would be, if in our day of ecumenicity all true believers would admit that there is one spiritual and divine baptism as surely as there is one God and Father, one Lord and one Holy Spirit. This would open the way for sweet fellowship and harmonious cooperation.

CHAPTER XVIII

Baptism and Our Completeness in Christ

Ye are complete in Him, says the Apostle in Col. 2:10, and he then goes on in the rest of the chapter to explain how wondrously complete the saints are in Christ in that they were both circumcised and baptized unto Him. We must know that the baptism is just as spiritual as the circumcision. Here is no material element.

They are, as Gentile believers - Gentiles by race and Christians by grace - so complete that they have in Christ, even the real antitypical circumcision. Jewish believers generally looked down with some contempt upon the Gentile Christians as uncircumcised. That the circumcision was typical is admitted by all but that it definitely typified the cross is not so universally conceded by all, and this is nevertheless the fact. Christ had a literal circumcision on the eighth day, as all the little Jews had, and he had the real antitypical circumcision of Calvary. There the old Adam was cut away not merely symbolically and ceremonially or typically, but in reality. And now even the Gentile saints have in the crucified One the real circumcision made without hands. From now on the circumcision of the unbelieving Jews who rejected the Messiah was only a *concision,* Phil. 3:2, a laceration.

But Gentile believers have now not only a complete circumcision, but also a complete baptism. They have been laid together with him in the tomb through *the* baptism, as Col. 2:12 says literally. The omission of the definite article is most mischievous because this gives the idea that the water baptism of the saints is meant and yet this is not the thought at all. The definite article in Greek has in a case like this the weight of an adjective. Modern grammarians want to regard the definite article even in English as an adjective. But, any student of Greek knows, in Greek it certainly means often *that well known, that great, that special, particular.* The same definite article is given in that important passage of Rom. 6:4. If water baptism is not meant, what baptism was then meant? The article points to a unique and vastly important baptism, well known at that time. In Matt. 20:22, 23 a baptism is also twice mentioned with the same definite article, and there it meant the great and unique baptism of His blood at Calvary, and this is exactly *the* baptism here. This baptism of blood came three years after his water baptism. In his water baptism he identified himself with Israel and with us, Luke 12:50; Mark 10:38, 39; Rom. 6:3, 4; Gal. 3:27; Col. 2:12. We have here therefore in the last three passages the same waterless baptism into the crucified, buried and risen Christ. Here is no imitation of His Jewish water baptism, but an identification with His blood bath on Calvary. We have been baptized into His death, Rom. 6:4. The shame of Christendom for missing this important truth and for thinking only of a Jewish purification with water!

When we were just dead Gentile dogs, He also gave us a quickening and a resurrection through that special operation of God by way of faith. Christians are a people that had a resurrection from among the dead, and this was certainly not material.

Christians were dead, but now their life is hid with Christ in God, Col. 3:3. How anomalous is it now to bury the living! The dead are buried, not the living!

Christians were raised up and have a resurrection-life. Again how frightfully unnatural and how intrinsically absurd it is to bury those who have already experienced a glorious resurrection. What has a risen person to do with the deep waters of death? Why should a saint, made to sit with him in heavenly places, leave his high seat and get dressed in his oldest clothes, or some immersion robes, in order to go down into the waters of death? Whenever Abraham, Isaac, or Jonah went down, there was a moral slip. Our call is never down, but ever up!

The waters are indeed waters of death and still laden with miasma and with the curse of earth; but God has redeemed us from the curse. Our Christ bore the curse for us, so that we need not go down under the element of the curse. Oh that believers might believe the Word of God and really act upon it!

By negligence of our wonderful baptism with Christ the Church has lost out tremendously in every way. She has exalted the law above our union with Christ, man's will above God's will.

She identified herself with earthly Israel and became legalistic, formalistic, externalistic, - and often felt called to exterminate the Canaanites. She caused on this account actually rivers of blood.

She filled the earth with the meaningless forms of ritualism and do-religion. She time and again joined up with the powers of the state, and instituted state churches, and built great temples and cathedrals, while the poor saints were oppressed with taxes and kept paying, while they were complete in Christ.

The blessed Hope was lost, and even the doctrine of justification and many other precious truths were relegated to the scrap heap.

The doctrine of the Millennium was wrung and twisted into an earthly kingdom and state kingdom, not to be brought in from heaven through Christ, but through the Church itself. The truth of grace went by the board, and also the joy and the assurance of faith. Even the finished work of Calvary was entirely lost sight of while in our day the simple way to heaven is not known in many Protestant Churches.

The Pauline Theology and practice went completely into eclipse, and the Book of Acts was made the first chapter of church history. There was no doubt, but the god of this age has had his hand in this spiritual catastrophe, for such it surely is. Since the Church had taken the place of Israel, there was no sense in a territorial and spiritual restoration of this nation. Here the door was opened wide for the Anti-Semitism that cropped out on every occasion from the time of the crusades on.

Not believing in Israel's glorious future and kingdom, they naturally had to spiritualize the glowing predictions of Israel's coming grandeur, and so the Psalms and Prophets were "wrung into the corset" of church truth.

Just as sure as our circumcision was *without hands,* so also our *baptism* was *without hands,* Col. 2:10-12. We were quickened with Christ, and raised with Christ, but not in or through water baptism. Water baptism could not possibly be a burial with Christ for Christ was not buried in a liquid grave, but in the rocks, Christ was buried when dead, while the baptismal candidate is buried as soon as he has received life. The saint *was* raised, Col. 3:1, 2 and the sinner was buried!

Believers are not *to be* buried, but are most emphatically declared to have been buried. Even those who religiously never touched a drop of water! It is not to happen, but it happened long ago when he died and was buried, Rom. 6:3-5, praise His name forever!

Oh that believers could ever get so mixed up with the tenses of God's Word! They often seek for righteousness, while Christ was long ago made our righteousness. They seek for purification of the flesh where God has now dealings with man on the high level of the Spirit. They fervently seek for holiness, while Christ was long long ago made our Sanctification, I Cor. 1:30-32.

They frequently yearn for redemption, while Christ Himself is their redemption. They do long for sins forgiven, while in Christ they have forgiveness of all sins. They search for the true unity of believers, while the Spirit of God long ago made a perfect, divine, and unbreakable unity, Eph. 4:1-6. And so they still seek baptism, whereas they were all long ago baptized into Christ Jesus and into his death, Rom. 6:2-5; Gal. 3:27; Col. 2:10-12, Eph. 4:5. Through unbelief Christians make themselves back numbers beyond any other class. They read baptism in the imperative mood, whereas God wrote it in the past tense. They read baptism as a prerequisite, God states it as a prerogative. They regard it as something material, God regards it as deeply spiritual. They regard it as for the few that obey; God says He baptized all believers. They want it to be done; God says, He did it long ago. God buried the dead Christ; they want to bury the living Christian. God buried in rocks, they want to bury in water. God redeemed from the curse; they want to dip the saint under the element of the curse. God made us to sit in super-heavenly places, they take delight in going down into the waters of death. God of old never applied man to any element; they want to apply the buried, risen, seated, saint to the element of death.

CHAPTER XIX

Born of Water, The Washing of the Water, The Washing of Regeneration

The first expression we find in John 3:5, the second in Eph. 5:26, and the third in Tit. 3:5. Since many read here water baptism, it is well to review these expressions. As they all deal with water and washing, they are all applied to water baptism, whether by sprinkling or immersion, both in regard to babes and adults.

Many brethren have felt, however, that if these expressions are applied to water baptism in whatever form it may be then baptismal regeneration is clearly taught; in fact, these passages are the Roman, Lutheran, and Episcopalian proof texts for that doctrine. If water baptism is meant here then they are absolutely right. Then too, the Pelagian or at least the Semi-pelagian system is right; man first works and then God works. Then the statement that the blood of Christ cleanses from *all* sin, cannot be true. Then Peter was lying when he said that we must be saved by the one name given under heaven. Then Paul was wrong when he said that Christ is our redemption and our life. Then salvation is not of the Lord.

When our Lord used this expression he was thinking of the ancient running water of purification, and he used this as a clear picture of the purifying power of the Word of God. What the water did for the unclean body, the Word does for the unclean soul, through the invisible operation of the Spirit. We see every day in the mission fields at home and abroad that no soul is ever won for God without the Word. John does not wish to stress either of the two media mentioned here to the exclusion or implied detriment of the other, but he stresses the necessity of both media and their mutual relationship in the regeneration of the sinner. The Spirit works with the Word that He inspired, and that God exalted above all His name. The Word never operates independently from the Spirit, and the Spirit never works without the Word. That the Word is used before the Spirit only means that the instrument is used before the agent.

As to the second passage too, if this washing of water be baptism, then the conclusion is inescapable that there is baptismal regeneration, something that the orthodox Baptists rightly hold in horror as an abominable doctrine of men. Just consider, after Christ loved the Church and proved his love on Calvary's cross, and after His blood was shed and He sanctified the Church, then he must cleanse it yet with the element of water, still miasmatic and under the curse! What a frightful doctrine this is! How dishonoring to the blood and the finished work of Christ! What a depth of iniquity to teach that man's sprinkling, pouring or splashing could ever add anything to the loved and sanctified saints, yes, add something to the shed blood of our Savior and to His sanctifying work of the Spirit.

Water often blurs the clarity of vision, and this is here the case, for the Lord has emphatically explained the washing of water by the appositional phrase, *by the word.* He sanctified and now daily cleanses the believers by the Word. If the former passage in John said that the birth or beginning of our new life is through the instrumentality of the Word, here we are told, that the continuous sanctifying and cleansing of the saints is

through the same medium of the Word of God. We have in these verses (Eph. 5:25-27) so to say, four sweet peas: the preference of his love, the purchase by the price of himself, the purifying by the Word, and the presentation of the Church to himself. The first two happened in the past, the third is going on throughout this age of grace, while the last lies still in the future of his glorious appearing.

The third passage, Tit. 3:5, reads: "According to his mercy he saved us, through the washing (bath, laver, *loutron)* of regeneration and renewal of the Holy Ghost, which he poured out upon us richly, through Jesus Christ our Savior."

Read water baptism in this passage, and we must read again, that He saved us by water baptism and by the renewing of the Holy Ghost. Then the water stands on a par with the blood that cleanses from all sin and is also coordinate with the renewal of the Holy Spirit. The thought figure is here that of the ancient laver. Just as that laver cleansed the priests of old so now antitypically the Spirit utilizes the Word to regenerate and renew us. The Word and Spirit never work separately for the indwelling Spirit never directs apart from the Word, far less contrary to it, but He ever operates with and through the Word and this Word is the antitypical laver. "Ye are clean" said Christ, "through the Word which I spoke unto you." The Word is the cleansing agency. Many believers are defiled because they neglect the Word of God. Just as sure as the laver of old was for purification, so now the Word as the antitypical laver is for the cleansing of the believers. Just as the ancient priests had to wash repeatedly at the laver, so we must constantly apply the Word to our heart and life, our walk and work and word. The laver stood between the altar (emblematic of the cross) and the Holiest, to show that the cleansing of the laver was only for those who had been at the cross and were saved. The Word of God was once for all delivered to the saints, and it cleanses only the saints, never the sinners who first must be cleansed by the blood of the cross. Christ prayed for his own, saying," Sanctify them through thy truth'; thy Word is truth, John 17:17 and just as the priests spent more time at the laver than at any other article of furniture, thus the child of God ought to devote more time and attention to the Word of God than to any other matter.

A daily bath in God's Word clothes the lives of believers with purity, power and purpose, with fragrance and fearlessness. What a sad commentary on human nature it is that man always gravitates to the material and away from the Word that is forever settled in heaven. He is in love with the element of the curse, while he forsakes God's foundation of living waters. He loves to go down where God's call is ever up. It is just as David says, his soul cleaves to the dust - and to the water, and this prevents him from winging upwards to the sublime mountain peaks of faith, hope and love and to the glorious baptism into Jesus Christ and into His death.

CHAPTER XX

What Is the Baptism of I Cor. 12:13?

The passage of I Cor. 10:2 can be of real help to the right interpretation of our passage. We read there that all Israel, consisting of about three million men, women and children were baptized *into* Moses. They were not baptized by immersion because they went dry shod through the sea, while the waters stood up on both sides like a wall. Not a drop of water touched them. They were neither immersed nor sprinkled, and they were, nevertheless, baptized. It is therefore evident that Paul uses the word *baptize* in his own peculiar way of complete identification. This view is corroborated by the usage of *eis, into,* in both passages. Israel was made one with Moses, was made Moses' people, to obey him as their leader and O. T. mediator. This happened "under the cloud," the presence of the Lord, typically. This light cloud was their leader, their guide, their shade and shield in day time, and their fuel, illumination, protection and beauty at night. It was from this cloud the Lord spoke to Israel and hence we can call it Israel's holy oracle. The idea is here clearly given, that it was the Lord who identified the nation with Moses, the lawgiver, and leader.

It is the same Lord, now crucified and risen, that in Corinth through his Spirit baptized all *into* one Body. They were taken from the outside and put inside the Body. Just the same little preposition *eis* is used and conveys here the identical meaning of *into.* Where the preposition *heos* means *up to,* there *eis* means *into.* The Jews and Gentiles were not brought merely near the Messiah, but put into the risen Lord of all. Now the question *is: when* was this baptism or identification accomplished?

Most commentators think here of the Pentecostal baptism. But then we must face the fact that there was one Body revealed at Pentecost, consisting of Jew and Gentile. Then there was an identification not only of the Body with Christ, but of Jewish and Gentile believers as well, and we see all during Acts how the Jewish believers were under the law and kept the law and how the twelve apostles preached to the Jews only. In fact, according to Acts 10:28, it was an unlawful thing for a man that was a Jew to keep company or come unto one of another nation - and so there were still Jews and Gentiles.

Then we have the tongues and healings, and Christian communism, and angels, and immediate judgments and miraculous jail deliverances all in the Body, the Church, and the question arises: if these signs were then in the Body, why not today?

Many maintain that the sectarianism, schisms, and divisions hinder the Lord from performing these signs and wonders now. However, they regard themselves as faithful, and then the Lord should work unhindered among the faithful people. The Lord has always in apostate days and circles honored the faith of the faithful. How is it then that these signs are also absent among the faithful?

The signs and wonders are not conditioned at all upon man's will and fidelity, but upon God's will as we are emphatically taught in I Cor. 12:11. The Greek verb

boulomai is used, and this means God's sure and immutable counsel. It therefore does not depend upon man's will, but upon God's will. It was His will that these signs were there during Acts and, that they are not, here during the day of grace. Pentecost was a Jewish Kingdom feast and not part of the mystical Body that had been hid in God from all ages and generations. The Pentecostal age had much grace, hut. was not the age of grace.

There are four views in regard to the signs and miracles of Pentecost. and the Pentecostal Acts period: Roman Catholicism teaches that these wonders are and have always been with the Church, and in the daily papers we can often read about these spurious and counterfeit miracles that seduce many. Fundamentalism holds with J. N. Darby that our unbelief and divisions have become the cause of the discontinuation of these signs, but see what was just said in reference to this matter. It was not man's work, but God's will.

Pentecostalism and other sects, like Mormonism, teach that these signs disappeared for many centuries because of man's unbelief, but that their faith has brought them back into their midst, and in the last fifty years many have fallen for this.

The only true and consistent view is that God willed them in His dealings with Israel. We see that as long as He dealt in mercy with Israel these signs were there. Israel and his temple and the law were there and hence He worked as the God of Israel who alone does wondrous things, Ps. 72:18. This word is the golden key in this matter of miracles. God works wondrous things, as long as He works as the God of Israel, whereas He stops operating this way as soon as He sets Israel aside and works as the Lord of heaven, and now as the glorious Head of the Body, where faith and grace suffice.

We are therefore constrained to reject the view that sees in I Cor. 10:1, 2 the Pentecostal baptism of Acts 2. We must however also reject the view that sees here a special outpouring of the Spirit upon the Corinthian believers at the time of the organization of the church in the year 63 A. D., although it must be conceded, that we read at least of four such special affusions of the Holy Spirit during the Acts period; and in the first seven Epistles of Paul we read of these signs and wonders; but he is here not thinking of an outpouring of the Spirit anymore than of an immersion under the baptismal waters of death.

He is thinking here with the *we all* not of the whole Corinthian Church as such, but of *all* saints in contrast to the exclusive Israel as the object of God's concern alone. He explains the *all* by saying Jews and Gentiles, bond or free. The *all* is not collective but distributive. Up till now it was the one elect nation, now it was the elect from all nations.

Then we must not be oblivious of the fact, that Paul is not thinking here of water baptism at all, but of the unification of the elect Jews and Gentiles and their incorporation into one Body. Just as Israel was submerged into Moses' authority and leadership, so these Corinthian Jews and Gentiles were submerged forever into the *soma,* or Body, never to be taken out. They were now inseparably joined to the Lord.

The verb *baptize* is in the past tense and not in the present as our A. V. has it. If this specific baptism did not take place at Pentecost nor at the year 53 A. D., when did it happen? Paul means to say that all the believing Jews and Gentiles were baptized each individually at the time of their faith in the Lord Jesus Christ. We have here the same baptism as in Rom. 6:4; Gal. 3:27; Col. 2:10-12, the one baptism of Eph. 4:5, and consequently this baptism acted in the same individual, invisible, inaudible, mysterious, and efficacious way as when every true believer in this age is taken out of the old Adam and incorporated into the Lord Jesus Christ. The verb *baptizo* could in such cases be rendered by our *submerge,* but never by *immerse,* for the latter word means that the baptismal candidate will be put in and taken out of the element, whereas the Pauline and divine idea is that he is sunk into the crucified and living Lord never to be taken out of Him. At the cross Christ identified Himself with our sin, here He identifies us with His endless glory.

We see what tremendous difference this makes. It is the difference between a hollow and meaningless rite - never even commanded as a law to the Body of Christ! - and the most glorious reality of being forever and inseparably united to the risen Lord and Savior. It is the difference between fleeting time and eternity, between the old and the new creation, between the curse and blessing, between death and life, between Israel and the Body, between form and reality, between the old and the new Adam, between earth and heaven, between the flesh and Spirit, between religion and spirituality, between self-will and God's will, between man's imperfect and breakable work and God's unbreakable and heavenly work.

CHAPTER XXI

Baptism a Question of a Good Conscience?

This is often the strongest argument we hear in the defense of baptism. They think that Peter gave a defense of water baptism whereas exactly the opposite is true. Let us honestly get at the right meaning of I Peter 3:21.

He has spoken of the awful judgment of the deluge in which only eight souls were *saved by water.* This last may seem strange and yet it is not strange when we realize that the same water which drowned many millions lifted up and carried Noah in the ark above the destruction. The element which drowned the wicked and beat upon the ark brought him and his safely through. From that dim past, Peter looked at the *antitype* as the Greek has it. The word *figure* is an incorrect translation of *antitypon.* He is thinking of the Lord Jesus as the personal Antitype of whom all the types were but faint shadows. Just as in the flood the angry billows beat upon the sheltering ark, so also our blessed Lord was baptized and beat upon by the billows of God's wrath. And even as the ark sheltered Noah, so we are saved by His baptism. Even as the ark passed through the waters, so He passed through, and as the ark rose upon the top of Mount Ararat, so Christ rose from the waters of death in His resurrection. And again, even as the ark did Noah no good until the flood came, so today we can only find shelter in the crucified Christ over whose innocent head the waves and billows of wrath have passed, Ps. 42:7; Jonah 2:3. We are reminded here of the fact that Christ Himself has called His death on the cross a baptism, and we have the same baptism here as in Col. 2:12. Both the circumcision and baptism are Calvary, where the old man has been cut away entirely in God's judicial reckoning, and also washed away by the baptism and flood of the billows of His wrath. As soon as a sinner lays hold upon Christ by faith, God looks judicially upon him as baptized into His death and as raised with Him from the dead. Circumcision and all the "divers baptisms" in Israel were simply faint shadows of the glorious reality of Calvary's unique baptism.

That Peter is thinking of Calvary and not of water baptism is also clear from the last clause: "*by* (through) *the resurrection of Jesus Christ."* The baptism of Calvary saved us, but if the antitypical ark should have sunk away under the billows without rising again, then we could not have been saved. There is water in the type, none in the Antitype.

This thought is still more corroborated by the fact that Peter emphatically states that he does not mean *"the putting away of the filth of the flesh,"* Now this is exactly what water does. If water is the subject, then the water saves us, and no Baptist brother would accept this.

If the foregoing be correct, and it is at least an exposition which exalts the Lord as the crucified sin-bearer, then Peter could not mean to say that water baptism is an answer of a good conscience toward God. He never did say such a thing. The word *eperotema is* found only here in the New Testament and it is of uncertain meaning. It has been translated in many different ways, but the literal meaning is *urgent request.*

Leighton has hit upon the true meaning perhaps better than any other man, when he says: *"The word intends the whole correspondence of the conscience with God."* Exactly. Peter evidently means to say that the baptism of Christ on the cross and His resurrection should not be materialized in the water and the body, but that it should rule our whole inner life and give us a good conscience to God as well as to man. In I Peter 3:16, he spoke of a good conscience toward men, here of a good conscience toward God.

We cannot refrain from quoting the note of W. B. Godbey on this verse. Translating literally: "Which antitype baptism even now saves us," he goes on as follows: "This passage has suffered terribly in the hands of preachers, Papistical and Protestant, who have done their utmost to drag it into the soul-destroying heresy of baptismal re-generation, whereas it positively certifies the opposite'.' Throughout the Bible, water symbolizes the Holy Ghost, hence the plain teaching of this passage is that the baptism of the Holy Ghost under the Gospel dispensation saves us. "Not the putting away of the filth of the flesh," should rule our whole inner life, and give us "a good conscience." While Peter certifies that this antitype is not water baptism, he simultaneously tells us it is the *"answer of a good conscience"* i.e*.,* when God baptizes us, He thereby gives His answer to our conscience, assuring us that it is good. Most expositors get here water in the type and in the antitype and this violates all rules of typology.

How and when does the objective baptism of the cross and resurrection become our baptism? Not through some kind of seeking or tarrying or any effort on our part, and not through some kind of a Pentecostal or second blessing, but as soon as we come in faith to Christ, the Holy Spirit silently as the dew from heaven slips into us and baptizes, identifies us with His death and resurrection. To suppose then that Peter here speaks of water baptism as a matter of a *good conscience, is* to miss the argument of Peter: is to attribute to conscience a ruling power which does not belong to it: is to degrade the one real baptism for this age into a carnal and legal shadow; and to unavoidably run sooner or later into the doctrine of baptismal regeneration. It is ever the trick of Satan to get the Church from her heavenly position to a low, carnal position, and he has always twisted this text of Peter to this end. Peter mentions Christ's death in verse 18, His resurrection vs. 21, His ascension, session and Lordship over all vs. 22, and this is with him clearly the antitypical baptism, which now, in the way of faith, saves us. Every believer is gloriously saved by the antitypical baptism of His death and resurrection. Praise God, for this "baptism that now doth save us!"

CHAPTER XXII

The Diversified Claims Made for Baptism

We wish to review in this chapter the most important claims made for water baptism whether by Paedobaptism or adult baptism of believers.

Is Water Baptism a Seal of Believers?

This is the general teaching of the Protestant Churches. Let us apply the touchstone of the Word to it and quote the words *seal* and *sealed* as found in the New Testament.

John 3:33 - "He that hath received His testimony hath set to his *seal* that God is true."

Rom. 4:11 - "And he received the sign of circumcision, a *seal* of the righteousness of the faith which he had yet being uncircumcised."

I Cor. 9:2 - "If I be not an apostle unto others, yet doubtless I am to you: for the *seal* of mine apostleship are ye in the Lord."

II Tim. 2:19 - "Nevertheless the foundation of God standeth sure, having this seal, The Lord knoweth them that are His."

Rev. 6:3 - "When He had opened the second *seal."*

Rev. 6:5 - "When He had opened the third *seal."*

Rev. 7:2 - "And I saw another angel ascending from the east, having the *seal* of the living God."

Rev. 8:1 - "When he had opened the seventh *seal."*

Rev. 9:4 - "Only those which have not the *seal* of God in their foreheads."

Rev. 10:4 - *"Seal up* those things which the seven thunders uttered, and write them not."

Rev. 20:3 - "Shut him *(Satan)* up and get a *seal* upon him."

Rev. 22:10 - *"Seal* not the sayings of the prophecy."

The word *sealed is* found a few times, but never with water baptism.

John 6:27 - "Him hath God the Father *sealed."*

Rom. 15:28 - "When therefore I have performed this, and have *sealed* to them this fruit."

II Cor. 1:22 - "Who hath also *sealed us,* and given the earnest of the Spirit in our hearts."

Eph. 1:13 - *"Sealed* with the Holy Spirit of promise."

Eph. 4:30 - "Grieve not the Holy Spirit of God whereby ye are *sealed* unto the day of redemption."

Rev. 5:1 - "A book written within and on the backside, *sealed* with seven seals."

In Rev. 7:3-8, we have the *sealing* of 144,000 Jews. Not once have the words *seal,* or *sealed,* ever been used in connection with water. We have not been sealed with water, but with the Holy Spirit unto the day of redemption, Eph. 4:30. The whole seal-doctrine as applied to water baptism is exegetically a piece of stupendous nonsense, that would elicit a smile, if it were not so serious.

Is Water Baptism an Ordinance for the Church?

Let us see what the Word says about ordinances.

Luke 1:6 - "And they (Zacharias and Elizabeth) were both righteous before God, walking in all the commandments and *ordinances* of the Lord blameless."

The word *Dikaioma* means judgment, justification, ordinance, righteousness, and has here, of course, nothing to do with baptism.

I Cor. 11:2 - "Now I praise you, brethren, that ye remember me in all things, and keep the *ordinances* as I delivered them to you."

The Greek *Paradosis* means tradition, and here it could never be referring to baptism as we conclude from I Cor. 1:14.

Eph. 2:15 - "Having abolished in His flesh the enmity, the law of commandments in ordinances; for to make in Himself of twain one new man, so making peace."

The root Dogma, here translated *ordinances,* means a law, decree, ordinance, regulation. We here have an emphatic statement that the ordinances have been abolished for the Church.

Col. 2:14 - "Blotting out the handwriting of *ordinances* that was against us, which was contrary to us, and took it out of the way, nailing it to His cross."

The same word as in Eph. 2:15 is used here and the same truth is established that namely the blood of the cross has abolished all ordinances for us.

Col. 2:20 - "Wherefore if ye be dead with Christ from the rudiments of the world, why, as though living in the world, are ye subject to ordinances."

This is a remarkable statement, since the man subject to ordinances is here put on a level with the worldling. May God burn it into many souls!

Heb. 9:1 - "Then verily the first covenant had also *ordinances* of divine service and a worldly sanctuary."

Here the ordinances are as ever applied to Israel where they ever should have been left.

Heb. 9:10 - "'Which stood only in meats and drinks, and divers baptisms, and carnal *ordinances,* imposed on them until the time of reformation."

The baptisms here are called *carnal ordinances* legally imposed as a heavy yoke and until the time of reformation or the first coming of our Lord. If in the face of these Scriptural facts anyone wants to speak of water baptism as an ordinance for the

Church, he must know that he runs counter to the Word of God, and that he puts dishonor upon the cross of Christ which has abolished all ordinances.

The Lord's table is no ordinance as is proved by the expression *"as often as*" ye eat and drink. This is not the legal language of an ordinance. This table is no law but love, a true *Agape,* or love feast, as Turingli rightly taught. Luther and Calvin both unscripturally overestimated it.

Baptism Took the Place of Circumcision

This is the stock-in-trade argument of the Paedobaptist brethren, but as we have seen before, the apostle (Col. 2:11, 12) is not thinking of one atom of water. He speaks of *the* baptism. While John's water baptism was a water baptism, here Paul means the unique and special baptism, by which we have been forever submerged into the risen Lord. Just as all believers have the antitypical circumcision, so they all have this great and wondrous baptism that buried or sunk them into Christ. We are assured that this was done without hands. Both for circumcision and water baptism the human hands are needed. There man can act as a religious agent, but here he is most emphatically excluded as worker or co-worker. God did not need his hands and could not, and would not, use his hands. Just as the uplifted but rejected Stone shall smash the world-image without the help of man's hands, so this great but all too little known baptism was accomplished by God Himself without a man's help. Here the baptismal candidate must have faith in the operation of God exclusively.

Furthermore, it is plain that here not only some babies are baptized but *all* believers, as clearly appears from the preceding and following context. Grammatically this passage positively forbids this interpretation. Then, only the boys and not the girls were circumcised, whereas now the both sexes are baptized or sprinkled. The circumcision was for Israel alone and not for the Gentiles. This bloody rite was performed strictly on the eighth day, and some doctors claim even now this is the best time for this minor operation. Another argument against this assertion is that in the Acts period baptism and circumcision ran parallel, which could not have happened, if the one came in the place of the other. Since there is positively no proof for the sprinkling of infants, God could not have used it as a substitute for anything whatsoever. That they were practiced concurrently by Jewish believers during Acts appears from Acts 11:3; 21:20, 21; Gal. 2:7-9, Baptism did not supercede circumcision, because all saints now have both antitypically in the crucified Lord; but even apart from this, there is no Scriptural ground for Paedobaptism. The whole covenant theology runs counter to Rom. 9:4, 5. If baptism took the place of circumcision, this would have been stated in the Apostle's decrees of Acts 15. These decrees were "the necessary things" for Gentile saints but baptism is not found as a necessary thing.

Water Baptism a Sign for Unbelievers?

This is another claim put forward daily, but without a shred of Scriptural evidence. The Pharisees of our Lord's day were always hankering for a sign and they asked the Lord Jesus on three or four different occasions for a sign in spite of the fact that they could daily behold His miracles. He characterized them as a generation seeking after a sign, Matt. 12:39; 16:4; Mark 8:12. They proved by their inordinate desire for a sign that

they were an evil and adulterous generation. Paul also said of the Jews that they require a sign, I Cor. 1:22. The word *sign* in the New Testament is always used in this sense, of miracles, except in one or two places. In Rom. 4:11 it is said that Abraham received the sign of circumcision, and in I Cor. 14:22 it is said that tongues are a *sign* to the unbelievers. In the plural the word *signs is* found twenty-three times in the New Testament, but water baptism is never put forth as a sign to the unbelievers. Signs invariably belong to Israel and his times, never to the Body and this day of grace.

It is a fact, however, that the water baptism ran concurrently with the miracles and the apostolic signs and wonders. We know from Acts and the Epistles that the Apostles wrought many signs and wonders, Acts 2:22, 43; 4:30; 5:12; 7:36; 8:13; 14:3. Paul preached also through mighty *signs* and wonders. He could say to the Corinthians that the *signs* of an Apostle were done by his hand, II Cor.12:11 and in Heb. 2:4 we find it stated also that the gospel had been witnessed both with *signs* and wonders. There is nothing spiritual in *signs* as such, for we know from II Thess. 2:9 that the man of sin shall be revealed with all power and *signs* and lying wonders. The wonders and signs have never been given to the Church, but to Israel and the Kingdom. They were never meant for this age, but for a time in order to give the truth of the gospel at the beginning a push. Israel has been the nation of signs throughout her long career. There were great signs in every step of Israel's Messiah during His sojourn upon earth: at His birth, baptism, transfiguration, death, resurrection, ascension; and the next thing that Israel shall see will be the *sign* of the Son of Man from heaven. The five *signs* that would follow them that believe, Mark 16:17, were meant for the thirty years time of transition, and when that was passed Paul could not heal Trophimus, Epaphroditus, Timothy, nor himself. Three times he said: *"The just shall live by faith,"* - and this excludes signs. Moreover the orthodox Baptists have only believers and no unbelievers. For this reason alone this whole claim is void and untenable in their churches.

Is Water Baptism a Confession of Christ?

This is also claimed on all sides, but we have learned not to accept any pious people just at their face value. There is too much pious ecclesiasticism which needs a scriptural debunking. It is high time that this pious bombast be stripped and laid bare. To the Word and Testimony!

In Rom. 10:9, 10, we read emphatically that with the *mouth confession* is made unto salvation. With the *mouth* and not *water,* or with the *baptistery* as the late Dr. Haldeman would make us believe, when he says in his *The Truth About Baptism:* "A baptistery set in the midst of a church proclaims the death, burial, and resurrection of our Lord as the good news of salvation by His vicarious death, and immortality by His triumphant resurrection." Here is not only a confession, but even a wonderful orthodox preacher. Wonder that Paul in his swansong did not say to Timothy: "By all means build baptisteries." If Dr. Haldeman wanted to be consistent, he ought to have gathered immediately a baptistery fund and built thousands of baptisteries in Asia, Africa, South America, and in the islands of the sea, for the dark world needs many proclamations concerning the vicarious death and resurrection of our Lord.

Every *tongue* shall confess to God, Rom. 14:11, and in the coming day every *tongue* shall confess that Jesus Christ is Lord to the glory of God the Father, Phil. 2:11. The

saved folk at Ephesus *confessed* and showed their deeds. The word *confess* in the Greek is *homologeo,* which means to *speak the same thing with somebody else.* When we confess our sins, we say the same thing about them as God does in His Word, and when we confess our Lord we speak out the same thing as God has done in His Word about His Son. Hence the very word confess tells us that. we must do it with our mouth and not by some kind of an act. There is just one text where confession of sins is connected with water baptism. It is found in Matt. 3:f, and is said of Israel. But this was a national movement and a mass baptism, since all Jerusalem and Judea went out to be baptized, and this was the baptism of repentance *for* the remission of sins. They were not baptized because they were saved, but in order to be saved. The Pharisees daily baptized, but hated Christ without a cause and did not confess Him. The purpose of John's baptism should be kept in view; it was that Jesus might be manifested to Israel. It was the mass purgation of an unclean people.

Water Baptism a Matter of Obedience for Saints?

This is the claim of our brethren, but what does the Word say? In the New Testament the verb *obedient is* used twelve times and *obedience* eight times, but in all these twenty times it was never connected with baptism. Paul was the Apostle of the Church, and he has not once exhorted to obedience in connection with baptism. Especially by him who pathetically expresses himself, that *"the care of all the churches"* came upon him, you would expect it. Not to detain the inquirer longer from the investigation, we shall, in one view place every passage in the epistles relating to this subject before him.

Rom. 6:3-6 - "Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized *into* Jesus Christ were baptized into his death? Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death; that like as Christ, was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life. For if we have been planted together in the likeness of his death, we shall be also in the likeness of his resurrection: knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him, that the body of sin might be destroyed, that henceforth we should not serve sin."

Col. 2:12 - "Buried with him in baptism, wherein also ye are risen with him through the faith of the operation of God, who hath raised him from the dead."

Eph. 4:5 - "One Lord, one faith, one baptism."

I Con 1:14 - "I thank God that I baptized none of you."

I Cor. 10:1 - "Moreover, brethren, I would not that ye should be ignorant how that all our fathers were under the cloud, and all passed through the sea; and were all baptized unto Moses, in the cloud and in the sea."

I Cor. 12:13 - "For by one Spirit are we all *baptized* into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit."

I Cor. 15:29 - "Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?"

Gal. 3:27 - "For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ."

I Pet. 3:20 - "Which sometime were disobedient when once the long suffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, eight souls, were saved by water. The like figure whereunto even baptism doth also now save us."

John has never referred to baptism in his epistles nor in Revelation. Neither did James and Jude. In Heb. 6:2 we are told to leave the doctrine of baptism behind, while in 9:10 we are told in the Greek that the *baptisms* were imposed as carnal ordinances on Israel until the time of reformation, i.e., the time of Christ's first coming. Here it was a law for Israel until Christ.

Just a few brief remarks on the words quoted:

1. There is no obedience to an ordinance, but praise over an accomplished fact. All saints have been baptized.

2. Here is no baptism in the name of Christ, but *into Christ*.

3. Paul does not mention the water at all, and where he does mean it, he praises God for not baptizing, since he was not sent to baptize.

4. Immediately after the time of transition, he states that there is *one baptism.* Now we all know that there is not one water baptism, but at least a score; but there is one baptism for the members of the Body of Christ, Rom. 6:4; Gal. 3:27; Col. 2:10-12; Eph. 4:5.

Should We Follow Christ in the Waters of Death?

This presupposes that believers of this age should follow Christ, whereas we cannot follow Him, since He was the minister of circumcision, worked under law, and to one particular people. Not the idea of *following* Christ is the predominant idea of the Epistles but of *being* and *abiding in* Him. "Even as ye have received Christ, so walk ye in Him." My little finger does not follow me, but walks in me, and so the least saint of this age is *in* Him and not following Him. *In Christ* is the special monogram of Paul. In one form or another he uses it eight times in his Epistles. It is the very core, the center and sum, of all his teaching for the Church of this age.

We should never forget that Christ was made under the law, and allowed Himself to be treated as a sinner in circumcision, baptism, and in His suffering on the cross. He was baptized *to fulfill all righteousness,* as He Himself has said. Now then, could any believer after Calvary, where all righteousness has been fulfilled, and after the Gospel has revealed this satisfying righteousness of God, ever be baptized for the same reason as his Lord was baptized? It would be a virtual denial of Calvary. We could as well be circumcised as be baptized, if we wish to follow Christ in everything. The watchword for us is not *imitation,* but ever *identification.*

There is another side to water baptism where it would be more befitting to follow Christ. We read in John 4:2 that *"Jesus Himself baptized not."* Now why did He not do this? He went through the land doing good: He preached, taught, healed, cleansed, comforted, but why did He not baptize? He was baptized and thereby treated as a

sinner under law, but *He did not baptize.* The imperfect tense is used and this means that He was not in the habit of baptizing. He habitually and willfully refrained from it. Why? The answers to this have greatly differed, but *He did not baptize with water, because He was to baptize with the Spirit. He did not give the shadow but the substance.* We do not imitate a Palestinian Jesus, but we are identified forever with the Lord of Glory! And we refuse to leave heaven's wealth for the "beggarly elements of the world."

Water Baptism a Burial with Christ?

Water baptism is not a burial with Christ for *a.* Christ was not buried in a liquid grave but in rocks, *b.* Christ was buried when dead, while the baptismal candidate is buried as soon as he has received life. *c*. The believers are not to be, but have been buried. It has happened in the past. Rom. 6:3-5. *d.* We were baptized not into water, but *into Jesus Christ. e.* We were buried with Him by *the* baptism into *the* death, as it literally says, evidently referring to the death on the cross, when, we were crucified with Him. In fact, he expressly tells us so. Able commentators like J. Brown, Shedd, C. Morgan, Venn, Williams, Godbey, Lenski, James M. Gray, Gaebelein, Norman Harrison, L. Tucker, S. J. Baird, R. Thomson see in our day that Rom. 6:3-6 has nothing to do with water, but that our identification with Christ is in view. The reason why the verb *baptizo is* used lies in the fact that with Paul its real meaning is to *immerge, submerge, so as never to get up*. We have been put in Christ never to be taken out of Him. It is a pity that the place for a rite that is not even here, and a material element place for a rite that is not even here and a material element that is not here. The word used for *buried* can in Greek never mean the descent into a so-called watery grave. The following image of the plant is never materialized and then it is no logical consistency to materialize the baptism used in the same breath. See what was said before of this subject of burial.

Our Bodies Washed With Pure Water?

This phrase in Heb. 10:22 is explained by Alford and most exegetes as a distinct allusion to Christian baptism, but it is certain that we have here the divers baptisms of Israel and not Christian baptism so-called. The author writes to the Hebrews, and the Key to Hebrews is that it was written to the Hebrews. There was in Israel access to God only by one man on one day and in one way, and to the unclean there was a separation from the tabernacle for one day or for a week, according to the grade of uncleanness. The seven day's defilement could not be purified without sacrificial rites and water sprinkled by the hand of one that was clean. After the leper had been pronounced clean, he had to wash his clothes and wash himself in water. This washing was self-performed without any administrator. Did Christ entomb Himself? And do Christians bury themselves?

Those ancient washings in Israel become to the writer of Hebrews, a beautiful figure of the believers. The new and living way has been consecrated for us through His flesh, His broken body. We can enter into the inner sanctuary, heaven, with a true heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled by the blood of sprinkling from an evil conscience. But the lepers that had been pronounced clean still had to have their bodies washed in pure, i.e., running water. The believers have been leprous with sin, and their bodies must be clean in approaching God. Now just as of old, the washed

leper could appear before God, so we have been washed, after the blood of the perfect sacrifice on the cross, by the pure water of the Word. The language of the Old Testament is used with application to the Hebrew believers of the new covenant.

Baptism as a Symbol of Death and Resurrection

Fatal for this claim is that all symbols as well as the types precede in Israel the coming and death of Christ as well as all the Messianic prophecies. However, many who will readily admit this do nevertheless maintain that the immersion of the believer symbolizes the death of the believer on the cross while this emerging is a symbol of the resurrection of the saint, but for various reasons this cannot be maintained, because it would be utterly incongruous for the believer who has everlasting life and a resurrection in Christ with even a seat in the super heavenly places to symbolize his death and burial. Symbolization implies shadow of the dim hoary past. The living and the risen are not buried and do not need a symbolization of it. Death is an ugly monster and we do not relish pictures or symbols of it. Neither do we need a symbol of our resurrection, since we have the glorious reality of the resurrection. The law was a shadow, symbol, and type of coming things, but we have in Christ the bright realities. The types were fulfilled when the Antitype was present, and the shadows fled when the Body was present. In a symbol is necessarily always a prophetic and predictive element that comes to fulfillment and realization in our crucified and risen Lord. A symbol is a token or outward material sign of something spiritual and immaterial to come, and hence it is inherently impossible that a risen, living saint seated with Christ in the super heavenlies can emblematize anything by going under the waters of death or the element of the curse. Water, unless just fallen fresh from heaven, is always an element of the curse and laden with bacteria. The going down was for the patriarchs and for Jonah, going down to Joppa, a serious lapse of faith. Instead of symbolizing something good, it ever symbolized something evil. Where is the chapter and verse that asserts that a risen, living saint must emblematize or picturize his former death and his past resurrection? The latter is so mysterious and at the same time so glorious that there is no symbol on earth that could ever portray it. Old things have passed away and all things have become new, and He wants us to forget the things that are behind in order to reach out for the things before us. It is a rule of Scriptural symbolization that the former foreshadows the future and the less the greater, but here the latter would symbolize the former and the greater the less. The symbol-theory proceeds upon the fallacious idea that we can be at the same time in the shadow and in the body of Him who fulfilled all shadows. It is simply impossible that the saints can be at the same time in the superheavenlies in Christ and under the law on any given point.

Baptism and the Lord's Supper

Let go the one, you must let go the other, they say. We have heard it often said that there are two ordinances left us of the Lord, namely, water baptism and the Lord's supper. If we are true Bereans we are ready to search the Scriptures and see if this is really so or not, and as we freely gather about the Lord's table in our day, it is well to set forth a few of the definite distinctions and contrasts between water baptism and the table of the Lord. Never, never, have these two been combined in Scripture. Here man has joined what God had put apart. Water baptism is an Old Testament ordinance. "Leaving behind ... the doctrines of baptisms." Heb. 6:1-2.

The Lord's supper is a New Testament celebration for our present dark night - "For I have received *of the Lord . . .* This cup is the new testament in my blood . . . This do in remembrance of me." I Cor. 11:23-26. Paul did not get it of the twelve, but of the Lord.

Water baptism, like all ordinances, was *imposed. "Di*vers washings (baptisms) and carnal ordinances imposed until the time of reformation." Heb. 9:10.

The Lord's supper was never *imposed. "As* often as ye eat this bread, and drink this cup." I Cor. 11:26. Water baptism was for Israel a *requirement for salvation.* "Be baptized everyone of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins." Acts 2:38. This is to get remission of sins. The Lord's supper never! "But to him that worketh not, but believeth on him that justifieth the ungodly, his faith is counted for righteousness." Rom. 4:5.

Water baptism was associated with our Lord's *manifestation to Israel.* "That he should be manifest to Israel, therefore am I come baptizing with water." John 1:31.

The Lord's supper is associated with our Lord's rejection and absence. "Ye do show the Lord's death till He come." I Cor. 11:26. Paul's revelation was to a large Gentile Church.

Water baptism denotes an *unfinished work of cleansing.* "I baptize you with water but he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost." Matt. 3:11.

The Lord's supper speaks of the *finished* work of Christ. "Ye do show the Lord's death." I Cor. 11:26

Water baptism is usually submitted to *once,* whereas the Lord's table is *celebrated again and again, "as often as."*

Water baptism was not included in Paul's commission. "Christ sent me not to baptize," (I Cor. 1:17) said the apostle Paul.

The Lord's table was *included in his commission.* "For I received of the Lord that which also I delivered unto you -- ." I Cor. 11:23. He got this as a revelation from heaven. Baptisms, as purifications were Mosaic, whereas, Paul got the Lord's table not from Moses, nor from the apostles, but straight from the Lord from heaven. While both were seriously abused, we find that baptism was never reformed, whereas the Lord's table was reformed in detail and that even in the year 59 or 60 A. D. If the Lord had intended to set it aside for this age then this would have been the time, occasion, and place for it; but instead of scrapping it, the Spirit did set forth in detail how to use it and how not to use it.

Many do not relish the Latin word *sacraments* and prefer the word *ordinances* for the two, but this is not a scriptural designation any more than the word *sacraments.* The N. T. simply does not employ one term to employ both rites. In fact, never in one single instance have these two rites ever been united as this is done universally in Christendom. This is also an old tradition of the fathers.

Water Baptism a Command for the Church in This Age?

Those in favor of water baptism in one form or another will admit many of the preceding facts and then turn away with the statement: "We must obey God's

command." We would say whole-heartedly "Amen and amen!" to this, if this were the case, but I am sure that God never did such a thing.

It is, of course, gladly admitted that Israel had imposed upon them *divers baptisms* until the time of Reformation, Heb. 9:10. Again, it is admitted that John came with a command to be baptized, but we all admit that John worked (a) under law, (b) under Israel, and (c) for the purpose of manifesting Christ to Israel.

It is also a fact that in the last part of Matthew and Mark we have commands to baptize, but we must remember that our Lord was the Minister of circumcision, i.e., of Israel, Rom. 15:8. We have given above many reasons why the so-called Great Commission could not apply to the Church. Of Mark 16:16 it is clear that baptism is made with faith a condition of salvation, and five great signs were to follow all those who believe. Also the *tongues* are mentioned, but in the year 59 A. D., Paul wrote to the Corinthians that the tongues were to cease with all the other gifts and signs, and that only faith, hope, and love would remain for this whole age. Considering then that baptism could never be a condition of salvation for the Church-age, and that the signs of Mark 16:16 have been done away long ago, according to the forecast of I Cor. 13:8 we can readily see that the command of Mark 16:16 is not any more for- the Church than is Matt. 28:20. Not one of these five signs is in the Church today.

If we want to know the commands for the Church we should go to Paul, the Apostle of the Gentiles, who has said several times that we should be his followers or imitators, and who praised the Thessalonians because they followed him, I Thess. 1:6; II Thess. 2:3, 7.

Did Paul Not Command Water Baptism?

If he did, he contradicted himself, for he wrote "Ye are not under the law but under grace" (Rom. 6:14). As soon as we admit that we are not under law, we cannot accept water baptism as a command or law. Again, then Paul contradicted himself in saying that saints are complete in Christ and have been buried with Him in the baptism of His death (Col. 2:10-12). Just as our being *in Adam* brought us all our guilt and uncleanness, so our being in *Christ* brings us all our innocence and purity. Again, if there were any kind of blessing in water baptism, Paul could never have praised God that he did not baptize any in Corinth except the three mentioned. Furthermore, if Paul tells us to cling to the one glorious baptism of Eph. 4:5; Rom. 6:3-4; Gal. 3:27; Col. 2:10-12; I Cor. 12:13, then he would contradict himself, if he would also have the water baptism for the members of the Body which is the Church. Then it is simply not true and cannot be true that there is one, but there then must be at least two baptisms.

It should not escape our notice that Paul has not used the word *water* once in his profound doctrine of baptism. When he once does speak of water baptism, he places his gratitude on the foreground that he had not applied it except in a few rare cases just as he temporarily applied the rite of circumcision. In contrast to baptism he puts his commission to preach the Gospel. A word like this is a strong presumptive argument that the Apostle to the Gentiles, and our great paragon saint, has excluded water baptism as an integral part of the Gospel of Grace for this age. No preacher clinging to water baptism in any form whatever, can follow Paul in his praise for not baptizing. If there were but the least of blessings in it, he could not have honestly and consistently

have uttered such thanks to God. His praise clearly proves that after Calvary there is no essential blessing inherent in water baptism.

His praise for not baptizing is fully consistent with the statement of Hebrews 6:2 that even the Hebrew believers should leave behind the water baptisms. The ancient baptisms of water they had to leave in order to cleave to the one glorious baptism of Eph. 4:5.

When God gave an ordinance in the Old Testament, He always gave specific instructions and detailed descriptions of the "how" of it. Just think of the Passover Lamb, the Tabernacle, the Feasts, the Sacrifices, and the Tithes. If He had meant water baptism for this age, is it then at all conceivable that He would have omitted the specifications as to the manner and thus let his people quarrel and strive for nearly two thousand years as to the method and subjects of this rite? If water baptism was for this age, why do the letters of Paul and those of James, John, Jude, and Revelation never mention it? "Think on these things."

"There is Absolutely Nothing in Baptism - But"

This is a quotation taken from many Baptist brothers and preachers of the gospel. We have especially one dear man of God before our mind who repeated the above statement over and over, till we told him, that there is really much in Scriptural baptism. Our Lord's baptism with water was part of his complete identification with man. By His baptism He was numbered with the transgressors, as Isaiah had predicted. Like a filthy sinner He asked for cleansing, proving thereby that He was made in the likeness of sinful flesh. During His earthly life He was repeatedly charged with sins He had never committed, but He held His peace. Why? Because He stood laden with our sins. He who knew no sin was made sin for us. This first baptism of Christ was certainly glorious, since He restored that which He took not away, Ps. 69:4.

His second baptism was still more wondrous, when He took sin's wages upon Him and died. He "loved me and gave himself for me!" Oh priceless baptism of which He had foretold, saying, "I have a baptism to be baptized with," by which he meant His death-baptism on the cross.

Third, our baptism into Christ and into His death (Rom. 6:4) is for us still more wonderful. Just as surely as our Lord became one with us in His baptism so we are one with Him in that one great baptism by which we have put on Christ.

A school boy playing with a dead sparrow has something wonderful, because all the scientists together cannot make one little feather or hair on the back of the dead bird, but do you mean to tell us, brother, that God would take something less than a dead sparrow and divide his people with it for centuries? Even the Old Testament baptisms were more than nothing. A boy blowing soap bubbles has something marvelous in coloration, form and essence when we think of the many hydrogen atoms in one soap bubble, with all their inherent atomic power, but do you mean to tell us that God would take a nothing, something less than a soap bubble and let His people be wrangling about this for two thousand years? Such speaking shows, brother beloved, that you have never understood the one glorious baptism of Rom. 6:4; Gal. 3:27; Eph. 4:5; and Col. 2:10-12.

It is in reality the acme of thoughtlessness when many brethren first minimize baptism, and then come with a *but* of traditionalism and conventionalism. God has exalted His Word above all His name. We should as dear children of God follow our heavenly Father in this and not deal in pious generalities in which can lie deceit and a cowardice, dishonoring to His Word and name. The Lord who is a God of order does not lay something less than a dead sparrow or a soap bubble in His Church to confuse His saints for many weary centuries. The Lord arose and ascended in order to *fill all things*, and not to divide His children with a nothing. This attitude is completely self-condemnatory.

Does Water Baptism Make Us a Member of the Visible or Invisible Church?

This assertion is also often made, but without any Scriptural ground. Let us briefly put it under the searchlight of the Word. There are in all ten different baptisms in the Word of God:

1. The O. T. purifications, called "divers baptisms."

2. John's mass baptism with water and *for* repentance. Those who *only* knew his baptism had to be taught the way of God more perfectly, Acts 18:25,26.

3. The five times predicted baptism of Christ with the Spirit, Matt. 3:11.

4. Christ's being baptized to *fulfill all righteousness* on our behalf, Matt. 3:13-15.

5. Christ's baptism upon the cross, Matt. 20:22, 2'3.

6. The mass baptism of Acts 2:38 preceded by repentance and followed by remission of sins.

7. The national baptism of Israel, I Cor. 10:1, when they went dryshod through the sea.

8. The blood of baptism of the martyrs in I Cor. 15:29.

9. The typical baptism of Noah, when millions of the ungodly were submersed, I Peter 3:20, 21.

10. The future baptism of Christ with fire at the judgment, Matt. 3:11.

Numbers 3, 5, 7, 8 and 10 were baptisms without water, and this shows the folly of always thinking of water whenever the word *baptism* is mentioned. In all these ten baptisms there is not one which is said to make us a member of the visible Church. The baptisms into Christ makes us a member of His Body and thus also a living member of Himself. This is the one baptism of Eph. 4:5, which is meant for this whole age. God never put this on a par with the Lord's table as two "inseparable sacraments." The one baptism of Eph. 4:5 is not and has never been a "sacrament" nor was any other baptism. And where in the Word does it say that Water Baptism and the Lord's Supper go together? There is not even a hint in that direction, but this sacramentalism is a Roman leaven. Sacramentum is *sacrum secretum, i.e.,* a holy thing hidden. Rome used this word to mystify its, laity, and the Protestants never broke away from this word. If baptism makes a member of the Church, then Paul thanked God for having made so

few church members. In Acts 19 there were two different baptisms; which of the two then made church members? The one Baptism makes us, however, a living member of Christ Himself, Rom. 6:4, Gal. 3:27, Col. 2:12. Mormons, Russellites, Adventists and other sectarians are often immersed without ever having been made members of the Body.

It has often been said that man is at heart a legalist, but he is also by nature a ritualist, and sacramentarian. The natural man loves to see beautiful forms. Seeing is believing is his order, but God has this order reversed, for He says, that if we believe, we shall see the glory of God. The evil and adulterous generation sought after a sign, but the man of faith, Moses, saw Him Who is invisible. All sacramentation is based upon seeing, and follows in the footsteps of Mother Eve who also *saw* that the tree was good for food, she then ate and fell. Achan *saw* and sinned. David saw and sinned. The one baptism cannot be seen; water baptism can be seen, therefore man feels nothing for the former and much for the latter.

Only two classes of people can be baptized: the unsaved and the saved. John's baptism and also the Pentecostal baptism was for the remission of sins. This was for Israel. If we in this age pour water over an unsaved person, be it little or much, will this benefit the one dead in trespasses and sins? Water has no restorative power for a corpse. If, on the other hand, a person is saved, then he has in Christ Jesus all spiritual blessings, then he is perfect in Him and is a member of Christ even with his humbled body and the water, as part of the world under the curse, can add nothing to him.

Water baptism has had a most pernicious influence upon the interpretation of the Scriptures. It has often darkened the counsel of God and put exposition in a thick fog. To illustrate this with Gal. 3:27, "For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ." As with Rom. 6:4, so it fared with this statement. It was nearly always explained as meaning water baptism; this naturally led into the awful doctrine of baptismal regeneration. Not only the immersionist expositors, but also the Roman, Episcopalian, Lutheran, Methodist, and Reformed commentators, have interpreted this to mean water baptism. Way has translated: "All of you who have by baptism passed into union with Messiah have clothed yourself with Messiah's personality," which is a lie on the surface. Jowett, Sanday, and others think of the baptismal robes in which they think the newly baptized person was arrayed on coming up out of the water. Henry says: "Having in baptism professed their faith in Him." A. W. Robinson says: "Incorporation with Christ. This change had come to pass when they were ban_ tired. In the act of baptism they had been invested with all the privileges which can result from identification with Him." Burkitt wrote: "Happy they who are not only sacramentally but really and spiritually baptized into Christ." Fact is that. the Word of God knows absolutely nothing of a sacramental union with Christ. The very idea is a pernicious chunk of Papistic leaven. O'Connor wrote: "Christian baptism signifies the assumption of Christ's character." If this were true, he and his church were extremely cruel in not sprinkling all the inhabitants of the earth. Sober believers ought to reject this hydrology on the following grounds:

The thief on the cross went unbaptized unto Paradise.

Simon Magus was baptized, but did not put on the character of Christ.

Millions of believers have never been baptized with water and yet they had put on Christ. This is especially true of many godly Quakers.

They read this passage as if it read: "baptized *in the name* of Christ," but it says: *eis Christon,* and this means that the mystical union was brought about, but water could not do this, only Spirit baptism could and did effect this.

If the immersionist brethren will see immersion here, then their *"much water"* proves altogether too much, as in Rom. 6:4. Then they must admit, which they would be loath to do, that salvation is by water. They may talk all they want of a sacramental way of speaking, Paul is not talking here of something external, but of a sanctified union with Christ and a putting on of Christ.

Supposing that immersion was meant here, then immersionist brethren could never logically be immersed according to this text, because they want believers' baptism, i.e., baptism because they are in Christ, *whereas this baptism was for putting into Christ.*

The immersionist interpretation of this text presents many problems they must consider, such as, the multitude of immersed people today who are not in Christ Jesus and have never put on Christ.

The immersionist interpretation of this passage is extremely cruel, because logically, if baptism here means immersion, all the non-immersed are not in Christ, but still in the old Adam. I know full well that dear men of God like Ironside and a host of others would never accept this position, but I for one refuse to be put in a position where I must be the object of patronizing, condescending airs, because according to this word all saints are baptized into Christ and no one has a right to look down upon any saint of God.

The context conflicts with the general view, because in the previous verses Paul has fought might and main for the believers as not being under law, and now he does not turn around to put them under some kind of a water-law.

Finally, for those baptized into Christ, all narrow nationalism, bondage and sex-discrimination has ceased and of water baptism this could never be said.

As soon as we think of the glorious baptism of I Cor. 12:13, everything is clear, since through that baptism we have been put into Christ, and into His death and resurrection, having put Him on as the garments of righteousness and holiness. Hence, it is passing strange that enlightened men as Hogg and Vine do not see this but still think of water baptism here.

The Roman annotations have this on this passage: "We learn that by the Sacrament of Baptism also we put on Christ, which is to put on faith, hope, charity, and all Christian justice. By the same we prove also that the Sacraments of the new law give grace, because the receivers thereof put on Christ. And the evasion, that it is the faith which worketh in the Sacrament, and not the Sacrament itself, is plainly false: *Baptism giving grace and faith itself to the infant that had none before."* This wicked interpretation of Rome is more consistent than the Protestant and immersionist exposition, because if there is water here, there is salvation by water; it is inescapable.

The fruits of water baptism in its various forms have been evil continually in Rome and Protestantism. Millions have vainly trusted in their baptism as "a means of grace."

The Pauline doctrines of justification by faith alone, and the resting in the finished work of Christ have been greatly obscured by it. And the baptismal font has not been a common point of union, as Bowes said, but rather an apple of discord between true believers. The manners and methods of water baptism have always been manifold, and if anything has caused wrangling, division, and bitterness between the members of His body, it has been the clinging to this ritual. How strange that after 1900 years of wrangling about water baptism, without having made any advance to a solution, the Church should not yet be ready to take the Pauline attitude of I Cor. 1:13-17. That the Roman and large Protestant bodies are tied to their water idols can be understood; they will never drop their "means of grace," but that those who know that we are not under law but under grace, are not ready to take the Pauline doctrine of the mystical union and with that the absolute freedom from all formalism, is most lamentable, to say the least.

It would seem, nevertheless, that a change is coming in regard to this matter. Many spiritual saints in England and America begin to see that the watery appeal to the outward senses, in every way fitted to excite the natural feeling imparts no grace whatsoever and was never meant by the Lord for this age. They begin to see that the "waters of death" have been like the waters of Marah and Meribah - an endless source of confusion, strife, and bitterness. With anointed eye they see that their position is in Christ and with Him in the heavenly places far beyond all legalism and ritualisms, which were only given to the one nation, Israel, Rom. 9:3-5; Heb. 9:10.

In order to get clear on water baptism, it is necessary that one distinguish between Israel as God's earthly people and the Church as His heavenly people. The Word clearly teaches that all ceremonialisms belong to Israel and never to the Church. God never had a Gentile Priest, Prophet or Apostle, and He never had a Gentile miracle worker. He never permitted a Gentile to heal or to baptize, or even to lay the hands on another, and of old He never put blood or oil on a Gentile. With all his formalisms Israel could not even draw near to God, but we by His matchless grace have not only been brought near to Him, but even in Him, it is through that wonderful union, in which Paul gloried not less than eighty times, that we have been lifted far above all ablutions.

Were the Ancient Washings Not Immersions?

Positively not, for the Hebrew words *duak, kabas* and *rachats* do not permit the meaning of immersion, far less the immersion of one by another. These words are often used. The word *kabas is* used over forty times and nearly always for the washing of clothes, by stamping them with the feet.

Rachats is used fully seventy times, and generally means the washing of parts of the body, as the face, Gen. 43:31; the feet, Gen. 18, the hands and the feet Ex. 30:19, 21; the inwards and the legs of the sacrifices, Lev. 1:9, 13; 8:21; 9:14 and the flesh, by which is especially meant the defiled parts, Lev. 15:16; 16:4, 24; 22:6. In the supposition that immersions were the mode in these washings, this would render three things absolutely necessary in every home, first, a large supply of water; second, a bath tub or tank; and third, a bathroom. But these are all modern American blessings such as even the poor in other continents do not possess in our day, and far less did the ancient Israelites enjoy these privileges.

It is often thought that the washings of the Priests at least were immersions. The instructions for the laver, in which they had to wash themselves, are found in Ex. 30:17-21. Twice we here read that they had to wash their hands and their feet. We do not read of the exact form and the dimensions of the laver, because it typified the purifying power of the Word of God and this is without any limitation or measurement.

The Psalmist said that God's law was very broad, but he did not tell us how broad. We know, however, that the laver stood on a pedestal or foot, Ex. 30:18. But if the laver was large and deep enough for immersion, and then had a pedestal, this would involve an elevation which would have made it practically inaccessible without steps and without a screen for decency around it, and we do not read of these things. The laver was never used as a bath tub. The bath tub is a relatively modern instrument. In the temple there were ten lavers used for the washing of the sacrifices, and the one sea of brass, which was about fifteen feet in diameter and seven and a half feet high. It was resting on the elevation of twelve brazen oxen, the height of which is not given, but it is generally thought that they were near or wholly of life-size. But the height of the sea's edges must have been at least twelve feet and this would be most inconvenient for immersions. This brazen sea was no part of the tabernacle furniture when God directed Moses to *wash* Aaron and his sons, Ex. 29:4; 40:12; Lev. 8:5, 6. The clear command was to wash them. Not the word *tabal* but *rachats* is used. The transaction is thrice described, but not a word is given about immersion or the conveniences for this act. When the laver was to be made, its purpose was definitely stated "to *wash* their hands and their feet thereat," Ex. 30:19, 21. The difficulties with immersion were practically insurmountable and totally against God's command. On the day of atonement the High Priest had to *wash* his flesh instrumentally *with* water, Lev. 16:24. Apart from this last case all the washings were self-performed, never by an immerser.

Washing is with us no immersion, but the washing in Israel was far less so, since the washing was done there by the sprinkling or pouring of the water upon the object to be washed. In II Kings 3:11 we see the manner of washing: *Elisha poured water on the hands of Elijah.* Dr. Ditzler in his brilliant work on Baptism has shown philologically and historically that the primary meaning of neither *bapto* nor *baptizo* is to dip or immerse. The word wash occurs in the Bible about 125 times, and about 40 of these belong to the legal purifications, but not one could mean immersion. The only word in Hebrew that means to dip is never used in Scriptures to express the ceremonial cleansing of a person. However, even this word means primarily to sprinkle. In all the symbology of the Bible the thought, that the blessings must come from God and drop as the rain from the skies, is never lost out of sight.

But Paul Baptized the Twelve in Ephesus

This general opinion and claim deserves careful attention and is important enough to cause us to quote the words that are found in Acts 19:1-7.

"And it came to pass, that while Apollos was at Corinth, Paul having passed through the upper coasts came to Ephesus; and finding certain disciples,

2. He said unto them, Have ye received the Holy Ghost since ye believed? And they said unto him, We have not so much as heard whether there be *any* Holy Ghost.

3. And he said unto them, Unto what then were ye baptized? And they said, *"Unto John's baptism."*

4. Then said Paul, John verily baptized with the baptism of repentance saying unto the people, that they *should believe* on him which should *come* after him, that is, *on Christ Jesus.*

5. When they heard *this* they were *baptized* in the name of the Lord Jesus.

6. And when Paul had laid *His hands* upon them (a) the Holy Ghost came on them (b) and they spake with tongues (c) and prophesied.

7. And all the men were about twelve."

A lack of correct translation is frequently the cause of misconceptions and this is the case here also.

First, Paul was not asking about *the* Holy Ghost. The definite article is not in the original, and it is a rule in Acts that when the definite article is used for *pneuma* or spirit, the Person of the Holy Spirit is meant, but if the Holy Spirit Himself has left it out, He wants to have the special wonder working power of the Holy Spirit emphasized, and it is about this miraculous Pentecostal power that Paul is inquiring, not about the Person of the Holy Spirit.

Second, a world of fanaticism and confusion in regard to a special baptism and a second work of grace has originated through mischievous rendering of "since ye believed," whereas the apostle clearly meant *when, at the moment* they believed. The actual rendering gives the idea that there is a reception of the Holy Spirit after the belief in Christ and it has led to the minimizing of the faith in Christ and salvation on the one hand and to the magnifying of the wonder-working power of the Spirit on the other hand. On faith all the three Persons of the Godhead become our possession.

Third, the answer of these twelve disciples, or followers of Christ, is as it stands absurd. Could any converted Hebrew that had heard John and heard at least about Christ, truly say, that they did not know that there was any Holy Spirit. They use the same phrase as Paul *pneuma hagion,* and they mean exactly what Paul asked. While they knew full well of the Person of the Holy Spirit from the Old Testament alone, they did not know anything about the miraculous power of the Holy Spirit as had been manifested at Pentecost.

Fourth, Paul's second question "unto what then they were baptized" refers to the six times repeated antithesis between John's water baptism and Christ's Spirit baptism. Paul asked which one of these two they had received. For a Scriptural man like Paul this was a very natural question.

Fifth, the answer of these twelve disciples was that they had been baptized with the water baptism of John and not with the Pentecostal Spirit baptism. They had the less, but not the larger. They had water, not the Spirit's power from on high. They believed, as all John's disciples did, *epi, "on, upon"* the Lord, but not yet *eis,* "into the Lord."

Sixth, the original was seriously slighted by our translators in verse 5. This rendering and verse division has led to the well nigh universal notion, that when these twelve men heard Paul, they were re-baptized with water, but grammatically this is dead wrong. The

verb *akousantes is* a first aorist participle and this could not refer to the hearing of Paul, but only to the hearing of John. The fifth verse is part of verse four. If it referred to the hearing of Paul, then the imperfect or even the present could have been used; but the first aorist refers to an indefinite past and could only be used of John and not of Paul. So the idea is that when they heard John, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus, which interestingly shows, by the way, that John baptized already in the name of the Lord Jesus. To get the sense one must add verse 5 to verse 4. We have here also proof that John's water baptism is the same as the later water baptisms.

Seventh, Paul gave them here not water for John had already given this to them, but the baptism of the Spirit's power by the imposition of his hands; and that this was not a hollow form of empty hands on empty heads is evident from the fact that the Holy Ghost actually came upon them in Person and with power. In verse six the Greek has *"to Pneuma to Hagion"* clearly referring to His Person. The Holy Ghost did not come *into* them but *upon* them in mighty Pentecostal power as appears from the two results: they spoke with tongues and like prophets they prophesied. The Spirit came upon them just as of old He came upon judges and prophets.

Eighth, these mighty signs and miracles point us clearly to Israel in the Jewish Kingdom-period of Pentecost. The number twelve of these disciples clearly reminds us also of Israel, because this number invariably refers to God's earthly people just as the numbers one, three, and seven have special reference to the Church. Paul gave here not the one baptism for this age, nor any teaching in regard to it, but he gave the sharp contrast to John's baptism with water, namely the baptism of the spirit. It would have been in fact, impossible for the apostle to give the one baptism, since this is exclusively the work of God and as such was not yet revealed at that time.

These considerations make it palpably patent that Paul gave here no water baptism, nor an anabaptism or rebaptism. It would have been utterly superfluous to baptize truly baptized believers for the second time. This would not only have been unnecessary, but without precedent, and without any rhyme or reason whatsoever. The Bible knows not one water baptism, but only the divers baptism of Israel and the one baptism into Christ.

The Use of the Prepositions in Baptism

In the course of history a good deal has been made about this, and hence we want to review this argument briefly.

The preposition *en,* first of all, whose primary meaning *is in.* Of the 2660 times in the Greek N. T. it is rendered *in* 2045 times. In the other 615 instances its primary sense is frequently traceable as *with,* Matt. 22:37 *by* 22:1; *on* John 5:10; Matt. 26:5, *among* 2:6. In many instances the *en* with the dative is clearly instrumental. The *Koine,* or Hellenistic vernacular Greek, has in this respect felt the influence of the Hebrew *be* as in *beshem,* in the name. This little *en* occurs in the Greek N. T. fourteen times with baptism, but whether we translate those cases instrumentally by *with or by* or locally by in, this does not disturb greatly the main argument, for if we take it strictly as place or sphere, then it is not *under.* When a mother screams to her child: "What do you do *in* the water? she does not mean to say to her little one, what she does *under* the water. To be *in* the water presupposes washing and pouring rather than immersion. All were baptized *in* Jordan, Matt. 3:6, does not mean *under* Jordan.

John did baptize *in* the wilderness, Mark 1:4 does not mean *under* the wilderness. John was baptizing *in* Enon, John 3:23, cannot mean *under* Enon. The things were done *in* Bethabara, John 1:28, and here John was not *under* Bethabara. This preposition means generally simply location on the surface, but not under the surface.

The preposition *eis* occurs in the four Gospels 795 times and is translated 372 times *into.* Its most general idea is entering *into.* But this word does not furnish much of an argument for our brethren as we can readily deduce from two examples. Christ was baptized of John *eis, into* the Jordan, Mark 1:9. This only means that Christ descended from the high Jordan banks into the deep gorge, or gully of the Jordan, but does not prove that the going into the water was per se the baptizing or immersion.

Both Philip and the eunuch went down *eis, into* the water, Acts 8:38. Since the preposition *eis* is applied to both, must we suppose that both were immersed? *Eis* often means to, John 4:5, 8, 28, 30; 8:26; 13-1; *among, 6:9, on,* Matt. 5:1; *at,* Matt. 12:41; *in,* Luke 8:26; 11:32, Acts 4:5; but in every case the primary meaning of *eis* is discernible. This preposition is no real help to the immersionist brethren, whilst it is the greatest help to the right grasp of the one baptism for in all the main texts for this baptism it is used to express the cause of our union with the risen Lord. This eternal and unbreakable union was laid by the one baptism by which all true believers have been incorporated into Christ and into his death, Rom. 6-4; I Cor. 12:13; Gal. 3:27; Eph. 4:5; Col. 2:10-12.

The preposition *ek* means out of the center as in eccentric, and not *out from under* exactly, as our brethren want to have it.

Both Phillip and the eunuch came *ek,* out of, the water. They take this to mean from under the water, but then they must have both been under, the baptizer as well as the baptized. They simply came out of the water, from a particular spot to the shoreline.

The preposition *apo* means from the limit, the edge, and is often confused with *ek,* out from the center. Our A. V. version says that Jesus went up straightway *out of* the water, Matt. 3:16; but *apo* never means *out of* but always *away from.* The usage of *apo* in this passage clearly hints that our Lord had not gone into, or under, the water, but only to it and therefore was not baptized by immersion.

From these few examples, which could be multiplied, it is manifest that these prepositions will not bear the stress laid upon them by the immersionist argument. They disprove far more than they prove and *eis* furnishes a perfect proof for the one unique baptism by which we have been made one with the Lord of heaven.

But Do All Theologians Not Concede That "*Baptizo*" Means Immersion?

Several books and booklets are circulating in which this is the main contention, but this is thoroughly unscientific, false and deceptive as Dr. Dale in *"Baptizo"* clearly demonstrates. Such volumes should be read by Bible students. Long lists of Paedobaptist scholars are given who at one time or another have written that "Baptizo" means dip, immerse, which is partly true of the classical Greek, but untrue in the Septuagint, and especially way beside the mark in regard to the Pauline use of this word. Cox, Conant and Morell make it *overwhelmed;* Campbell and Ingram, *submerged,*

superfused, sunk, soaked, soused; Campbell and Conant again *undergo,* a contradiction of logic and sense.

When we remember that Paul is the apostle of the Gentiles and, under the Spirit of God, the great teacher of the Body of Christ, who claimed so often that he is *for* us, and that we are to follow him even as he followed Christ then we can freely draw the conclusion that in regard to the great doctrine of baptism we are not to follow the heathen writers but our great apostle. And we challenge any scholar to prove that the word "baptizo" in Paul's Epistles merely means a momentary dipping or an immersion. His great teaching on baptism as found in Rom. 6:4; I Cor. 1:14; 10:1, 2 ; Gal. 3:27; Eph. 4:4, 5 ; Col. 2:11, 12 cannot be thus lightly put aside with the sophistical show of learning that Luther and Calvin and other noted Paedobaptists have given as the classical meaning of "baptizo." We call this sophistry, because the impression is given that this is the only, and the Biblical meaning of this word while slyly the Old Testament meaning of the Septuagint and the Pauline meaning are hidden from the people. Such a garbling of the facts must be stigmatized as unfair, unscientific, unscriptural, untrue, and sophistical.

What Does "Ye Are Washed" of I Cor. 6:11 Mean?

Many commentators think here of the blood, but many also of water baptism. If the latter is the meaning, then the reference is to the washing of the Gentile proselytes on their entrance into Judaism. Then they were baptized not on their faith, but before they were sanctified and even justified by faith. It is a remarkable fact that Paul never found it necessary to define baptism. In referring to it he assumes that his readers know full well what it means. They knew that the water baptism stood for Jewish purification according to the law, and they also knew that the waterless baptism *into* Christ was the initiation into Christ and the identification or unification with Him. It is most regrettable that when people read of baptism in Paul's Epistles, they thoughtlessly think only of water. Water has blurred the vision of millions. There can be no doubt, says an able writer, "that it always was to baptism in water that he referred." The fact of the matter is just the opposite, he *never* referred to baptism except once, in I Cor. 1:13, 14 and then he thanked God that he did not baptize any or so few. With Paul the eternal union of the believer depends on the waterless baptism into Christ and from it flow all the great doctrines of justification, sanctification, and redemption. Being baptized into Christ, we have been baptized into all His benefits and blessings forever; and we died and rose with Him.

CHAPTER XXIII

Baptism Exalted and Paul Neglected

In his introduction on Colossians, the great scholar, Lightfoot expresses amazement that the Council of Laodicea in 363 still found it necessary to condemn those confessors who kept the Jewish Sabbath, worshipped angels and were addicted to sorcery and astrology; but knowing the facts as they are, we in reality need not be surprised about this at all, for the simple and sole reason that Christendom paid no attention whatever to what the risen Lord had taught through Paul's ministry, and specifically in regard to the baptism into Christ.

The "Teaching of the Twelve Apostles" is an old document to which scholars give the early date of the end of the first or the beginning of the second century. Therein we find that the way of life is to love God and the neighbor and keeping of the golden rule. "By thy hands thou shalt give a ransom for thy sins," it says. According to Acts 2, there should he Christian communism. At the end of chapter 4 they say once more, *"This is the way of life."* Hence no room for misunderstanding. In chapter 6 they say: "Bear the whole yoke of the Lord, but if you are not able, do what you can." Here is no grace but works.

They must baptize in running water or pour water upon the head thrice; but all must; fast one or two days prior to baptism. They should pray thrice daily the Lord's prayer. Thanksgiving is prescribed in a given formula. Prophets are still acknowledged and also known are false prophets. First - fruits must be brought:. The prophets are the chief priests. Those who endure in their faith shall be saved. *Clement* looked upon all this as Scripture and quoted it as having like authority with it. *Eusebius* classes this treatise among the controverted books.

Ignatius at the turn of the first century speaks of an *altar;* thanksgiving is the flesh of our Savior. The overseers must be followed "as the Lord Himself." It is not good to be baptized apart from them. It is here also law plus the Lord.

The *Pastor of Hermas* like the others does not know justification by faith alone, and he had some extravagant and carnal ideas on the Millennium.

Polycarp in his letter to the Philippians is also legalistic through and through while Paul's free grace is evidently forgotten.

Eusebius speaks of fasts and vigils as common, the strict abstinence from blood and wine. Many kept the Passover and many traditions of the fathers.

This brief review makes it clear as day, that the early Church did not follow the Apostle of the Gentiles and of the Mystery, the Body, as he had exhorted, but on the other hand, followed those in Asia and Rome who even during his lifetime forsook him. They wanted the popular gospel of doing something for God, and did not even know the gospel of pure grace.

CHAPTER XXIV

Baptism with the Great Church Fathers

The thought has been fostered generally that the Fathers of the early Church were giants in knowledge, but the contrary is the truth. They can safely be called giants in love for Christ, willing to suffer and die for Him, and many actually did die a martyr's death for their Lord and Savior. But, strange to say, there was a great lack of illumination with all of them. When we inquire as to the cause of this, then we can only come to one conclusion: just as all of Asia and all of Rome left Paul at the end of his life, so the Church Fathers like the apostolic fathers had forsaken Paul's teaching in regard to baptism and the Mystery of the Body of Christ. They never left behind the doctrine of baptisms and never clung to the one glorious baptism of Eph. 4:5 and they identified baptism with regeneration, which led to baptismal regeneration teaching of our day.

Ireneus was born prior to the death of John the Apostle and he was acquainted with Polycarp, the friend of John. Speaking of heretics, he says "that they have been sent out by Satan to frustrate the *baptism* of regeneration unto God."

Justin Martyr was born soon after John's death. Speaking of the washing of baptism, he says, they are regenerated.

Clement of Alexandria (A.D. 150-213) says: "He that is once regenerated as the name of that sacrament is." Again: "Whether John's baptism was regeneration, we do not discuss."

Tertullian (A. D. 193-216) was one of the most enlightened church fathers and dearly loved the Lord. We quote him: "Whereas it is an acknowledged rule that none can be saved without baptism," this he affirms especially by the sentence of our Lord: "unless one be born of water he cannot be saved." He has the phrase: "regenerated of water and the Spirit."

Cyprian, born 200 A.D., was the greatest church man of the third century. Fie has this: "That the old man dies and the new is born in baptism, the blessed apostle clearly proves, saying: "He saved us by the laver of regeneration."

Origen, a learned Alexandrian of the third century was a fervent lover of the Lord and his Word, but became nevertheless the father of many heresies. He says: "Everyone that is born of water and the Spirit is clean from pollution and it is by this washing of regeneration that he comes to the future regeneration."

Jerome, A.D. 340-420 was a great Biblical scholar for that day. His translation of the Vulgate was the only translation of the middle ages and became the infallible version of the Catholic Church until our day. He uses the phrase "the waters of saving baptism."

Athanasius, who fought so heroically for the doctrine of the absolute Godhead of our Lord has this: "He who is baptized puts off the old man, and is renewed, being born again from above."

Ambrose, bishop of Milan from A.D. 374 to 391, speaking of the cleansing of the leper, says: "No one can be cleansed from the leprosy of sins by the water of baptism, except through invocation of the Father, Son and Spirit."

Chrysostom, A.D. 347-407 upon whom the title of golden-mouthed was bestowed, because of his peerless pulpit eloquence, eloquently sums up as "the benefits of baptism," and says the baptized are free saints, justified, sons, heirs, brothers of Christ, co-heirs, members of Christ and his temple and organs of the Spirit.

Gregory of Nazianzus, (A.D. 329-390) was a most influential theologian of the Eastern Church. He says: "The Word teaches us that generation is threefold, that of our bodies, that of baptism, and that of resurrection."

Cyril of Alexandria, (A.D. 376-444) says: "We have been baptized not with water alone, - but with the Holy Spirit and fire."

Augustine (A.D. 354-430) had more influence on the church until this day than any other Church Father. He says: "The baptism of infants is necessary, so that they who by their generation are subject to condemnation, may by regeneration be freed from it." Again: "The force of that sacrament is such that he who is once regenerated by it, etc."

These few quotations of the leading Church Fathers make it unmistakably clear that they all taught the doctrine of what is now known as baptismal regeneration. These godly men by disregarding the Pauline teaching of leaving the water baptisms and cleaving to the one glorious baptism of our identification with the risen Lord have led the historical church astray on the doctrine of baptism with the ghastly result that there are in our day 400 million Roman Catholics who firmly believe in baptismal regeneration, and fifty million Lutherans who teach this unscriptural doctrine. Another fifty millions of Episcopalians teach this doctrine, with millions of other sectarians. Archbishop Tillotson wrote about this as follows: "I cannot imagine why so great a scruple should be made of those expressions which our Church uses in the office of baptism, regenerated and born again by baptism and being thereby made the children of God and heirs of eternal life - and so likewise all the Liturgies of the Reformed Churches." In this last he is correct. After the baptism of every infant, the Reformed Churches thank and praise God that He has "forgiven us and our children all our sins," and Kramer in his dissertation on *Baptism and Regeneration* has quoted scores of Reformed theologians who if they were not full baptismal regenerationists put at least some close and causal connection between water baptism and regeneration. This was also the stand of the celebrated Dr. A. Kuyper. Upon his word many Neo-calvinistic fathers rushed the newly born infant to the church in order to have it sprinkled while the mother of the babe still lay sick in bed. It might die and then it would die unregenerated and be lost.

The Norwegian theologian, Dr. O. Hallesby wrote a work some years ago on Baptism in which he strongly teaches baptismal regeneration. The Scandinavian Lutherans in Europe and America closely follow him in this stand.

Most revolting of all is that many Protestants have taken from Rome the doctrine of infant damnation of the unbaptized children. The Roman writer Fulgentius had taught that the unborn offspring dying in mother's womb, or just after birth, unbaptized, must be punished by the eternal torture of undying fire, for, said he, although they have

committed no sin of their own, they have nevertheless drawn with them the condemnation of original sin by their carnal conception and nativity. Another medieval theologian gave the assurance that babes not a span long were crawling unbaptized over the floor of hell. This is superstition and cruelty combined.

In all fairness it. must be said that now most Lutherans, Calvinists, and all Methodists, have renounced the infant damnation, but not of course the imperative duty of infant sprinkling and its supposed benefits.

The old Puritan theologians did not fully renounce the ancient Roman leaven. Baxter wrote: "We are made *new creatures* when we are baptized." Poole's *Annotations* identify baptism with regeneration and so do many Puritan expositors. The Presbyterian Churches also teach a mysterious sacramental union between the sign and the thing signified and they teach that baptism secures all the benefits of the covenant of grace. Calvin also has many benefits conferred on us by baptism. To use his own words: "We are the children of God, because we have put on Christ in baptism," and he uses many statements similar to this. The Calvinistic theologians have followed in the footsteps of their master. Beza says that we are to be *regenerated by His Spirit in baptism.* Many of the great Dutch theologians, as Kramer has pointed out, spoke the same way about baptism. Macknight refers both expressions, "born of water" and "washing of regeneration" to baptism. Doddridge, Watts and Saurin and many others do the same. They all take for granted that the Pauline baptism into Christ meant water.

The Congregational Churches declared in the Saybrook Platform "that by the right use of this ordinance the *grace* promised is really *conferred* by the Holy Ghost; that baptism is a *sign of regeneration,* which shows what grace is conferred in that rite, and that it is the means of introducing us into the family of God." In his System of Theology, T. Dwight makes of *born of water* in John 3:5 baptism.

The Methodist Churches have, of course, the stand of Wesley himself, and he expressly teaches that baptism washed away original sin. After the baptism of the infant, God is praised "for receiving the infant for his own child." Dr. A. Clarke, the Methodist commentator, makes of the *washing of regeneration* baptism.

The Campbellite or Christian Church teaches baptism for the remission of sins. As proofs they point to Mark 16:16; "He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved;" to John 3:5 "Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the Kingdom of God;" and to Acts 2:38, "Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ, for the remission of sins"; and to Rom. 6:3, 4. The doctrines of the Baptist Churches are that we should be baptized because our sins have been forgiven, the Campbellites strenuously hold that we should be baptized in order to have our sins forgiven. The little word *eis* used in Acts 2:38 can never mean *on account of,* but must of necessity mean here as expositors admit; *in order to, with a view to obtain, It* is the blunder of blunders that they did not distinguish between Israel and the Church. For Israel, indeed, faith and baptism were united as conditions of remission of sins. The word *eis* is always prospective and never retrospective. In English we can say: "A man is hung *for* murder," i.e., because of murder and not in order to commit murder, but in Greek we could not say this with *eis.*

All the denominations fight Rome and one another on baptism, and yet they are essentially all one on this point in that they attribute somehow a mystical, if not magical, value to water baptism, and thereby unconsciously detract from the blood of Christ which alone can cleanse us from all sins. The right grasp of Pauline baptism would have kept men from all this error.

CHAPTER XXV

Water Always Popular in Religion

Grotius, the most learned man in his day, tells us that some ancients baptized with water in memory of the waters of the deluge. Religious man has always loved the water. It is well known how sacred the waters of the Nile were to the Egyptians. The Etruscans, the Greeks, Romans, Druids and the Alts all had their purifying religiously by water. The waters of the Ganges are sacred to the 400 million of the inhabitants of India.

When the Spaniards came to California they found that the Indians baptized both sexes between three and twelve years. This was done against the evil spirits.

Most ancient nations had their ablutions. The nearly 300 thousand million Mohammedans do not want the blood of Christ for cleansing, but they have deliberately chosen their ablutions for pollutions, and their lustrations for frustrations. The Gospels show that the selfrighteous had extended their baptism to beds and couches. The proselytes in the Talmud were always baptized by immersion. Scholars are fairly unanimous in the claim that water baptism was inherited not only from the Mosaic institutions, but also from the proselyte baptisms of the Talmud.

Unity there has never been in regard to the form and the objects. Some immersionists said: "If only our finger remains above water the whole rite is invalid," now most Christians claim: "A few drops of water are as good as a river." Many pagans washed to propitiate the wrath of the gods, now many baptize to make the child of wrath an heir of grace and glory. Baptism is for millions an absolute necessity for salvation. Dante has peopled in his Inferno the *limbus infantum* with unbaptized children, but this was and is the Roman view.

The water as we have seen, belonged with the blood and the oil, to the Jewish law, and John the Baptist was sent to fulfill the demands of the law, and since our Lord was *made under the law*, He submitted to this rite to fulfill all righteousness, but no one was ever commissioned by Christ, or by the Apostles after Acts 28 to baptize any Gentile with water. John had to prepare the way before Him. He wanted to meet a clean people and a law-abiding nation. John gave the reason for his water baptism clearly in John 1:31: "That He should be manifest to *Israel*, *therefore* am I come baptizing with water." - He baptized only Jews, since it was only for them and not for the Gentiles. The Gentiles Naaman, the Eunuch, Cornelius and the Jailer of Philippi, were all regarded as Proselytes. Three times in John 1:26-33 the Baptist says that his baptism is of water, thereby emphatically differentiating it from Christ's baptism with the Spirit. The one baptism of Col. 2:11 and Eph. 4:1-5 was still hidden as part of the mystery, later to be revealed to Paul.

The fact that our Savior on the one hand was baptized, because He was made under law and therefore subject to the whole law, and on the other hand did not baptize Himself, speaks, as we saw, also a volume, since He went through the land doing good. If now there had been any lasting good, any spiritual blessing in water baptism, then our blessed Lord would have certainly administered it to many, but we are emphatically

assured that He Himself did not baptize, John 4:1, 2. He was the Antitype of all the shadows and He could not come with an ancient Levitical shadow, nor could He give a single direction or instruction about it. He kept the whole law perfectly, also the law of Levitical baptism, but He did not baptize nor command it. He said to John: "Suffer it to be so *now,"* in the last little word clearly indicating that it should not be so always.

In the year 60 A. D. Jewish believers were exhorted to leave behind the doctrine of baptisms, Heb. 6:1, 2. It belonged both historically and doctrinally only to the beginning or first principles of the teaching of Christ. They are urged to leave it behind in order to go on to *perfection*, i.e., full Christian maturity. Perfection in this sense cannot be reached with water baptisms. It stands on a par with the Jewish laying on of hands and with the ancient faith toward God in contradistinction to the faith that incorporates into Christ. How sad that this exhortation has been so flagrantly disobeyed! Romanism and many isms would have never come if it had been obeyed.

If we turn the page to Heb. 9:10 then we see that these divers water baptisms stand on a par with the Mosaic meats and drinks and other *carnal* ordinances. They were as legal enactments *imposed* like an unbearable yoke upon the neck of Israel and it was such a heavy yoke that neither the fathers nor their children could bear it, as Peter said, but strange to say many saints fondly cherish that unbearable yoke.

These water baptisms had a definite end, because they were *until* the time of reformation, i.e., the first coming of Christ. The Baptist hinted at it when he said: "He must increase, but I must decrease." Think of the amazing fact! Whereas Christendom at large teaches that Christ has instituted water baptism, there this word of God tells us in unmistakable language that the water baptisms were in Israel *until* Christ should come, Heb. 9:10. Instead of starting baptism, He ended it. Christ has come and has clearly taught that the religious water belonged to Israel, but Christendom has in rebellious disregard of His Word taken upon its neck the unbearable yoke. Is it any wonder that a great darkness and fog has settled down upon all Christendom? It is a fog that no reform or revival can lift. Rom. 6:3-5 is a baptism into Christ and into His death. We see here no more water than we see a literal plant. The thief on the cross was not baptized into water but he nevertheless went to Paradise with Christ that same day.

Simon Magus was baptized, but the waters had not washed away his gall, his bitterness and his bond of iniquity.

That there is no water baptism for this age has been believed all through the centuries by many martyrs who have sealed their testimony with their blood.

Dean Stanley rightly says: "It has been the misfortune of churches that they have imagined a primitive condition which never existed. The reluctance to look the facts of history in the face has favored the growth of a vast superstructure of fable. Many early Christians evidently repudiated water baptism. At any rate, Tertullian in the third century, complains that many tried to destroy it. These many may have been right and their foes dead wrong.

A sect named Ascondrutes, rejected water baptism as a material thing unable to communicate spiritual blessings.

One reason for the perpetuation of the Jewish Levitical water was the greater facility to win Paganism by the rites of water. The Lampetians, Adelphians, Estations, Marcionites, Enchites, Massalians, Enthusiasts, and other sects rejected water baptism for this age.

Of the Paulicians, Neander says that they rejected water baptism as a perpetual ordinance. In Armenia one hundred thousand of them were martyred. Their enemies represent them as a people loving, spiritual, peaceful, and as diligent Bible readers, but the Church at large was so infatuated with the baptismal waters, that these heretics were deemed unworthy of life. The Catharists, the Beghards, the Bequines, the Turpines and the Albigenses all rejected water baptism, but the Church hunted them down like mad dogs. Anything that the old mother harlot hates has in it the presumptive evidence of truth.

The Christendom of Europe has started in the rivers, since many tribes and tongues had heard the preaching of the baptism for the remission of sins. King Vladimir of Russia, like Cloris, King of the Franks, four centuries before him, commanded his people to repudiate their gods and be baptized for the remission of their sins. His heathen subjects enthusiastically obeyed, and thousands plunged into the cold waters of the Dnieper, and thus was established the Russian state church of the Holy Greek Orthodox Church, that helped the Czars to oppress the poor, persecute the Jews as Christ-killers, and prepare the way for the Reds that now frighten the whole world. Alas, Christianity never moved far from the banks of the river.

CHAPTER XXVI

Answers to Some Questions

A Baptist friend from Holland, Michigan has asked the following questions in his book on Baptism entitled *"Is Water Baptism for Today?"* On page 11 he writes, "My dear nonbaptist friends will you please "search the Scripture" and see if you can find -

1. One positive statement that says that water baptism is not for today?

2. One positive statement that says water baptism is Jewish after Pentecost (Acts 2:1) ?

3. One positive statement that says that the command of water baptism was to be repealed?

4. One positive statement that says that the command of water baptism has been repealed?

5. One positive statement that says that the Acts period or any part of it was *Jewish?*

6. One positive statement that says that the "signs" that "follow them that believe" after Pentecost were *Jewish* (Mark 16:17; Acts 2:1-4) ?

7. One positive statement that says that the "signs" (Mark 16:17) and water baptism were *to stand or end together?*

8. One positive statement that says that "the Body of Christ (I Cor. 12:27) was not formed by Holy Spirit baptism at His coming at Pentecost (Acts 2:1-4)?

9. One positive statement that says that "the church" referred to in Acts 2:47 was not the same "church" referred to in Eph. 1:22, 23?

10. One positive statement that says that the Gospel of Christ, which the Old Testament prophets did not understand, but "which are NOW REPORTED unto you with the Holy Ghost sent down from heaven" at Pentecost (I Peter 1:10-12; Acts 2:1-1:8) was not the same "mystery referred to in Rom. 16:25; Eph. 3:2-6; Col. 1:24-27?"

Our brief answers follow in the same numerical order.

1. Heb. 6:1, 2 clearly states that we should leave behind the doctrine of baptisms.

2. Heb. 9:10 says that the "divers baptisms" were imposed on them, i.e., the Jews.

3. I Cor. 1:14 and the preceding texts are clear enough for all who will take God at His Word. Strictly speaking, God never repeals His perfect law, once given to Israel, and never to the Body.

4. A constructive interpretation of I Cor. 12:13; Rom. 6:4; Gal. 3:27; Eph. 4:4, 5; Col. 2:11, 12 clearly shows that the Apostle for this age had no water in his program, neither little nor much.

5. Christ was a minister of the circumcision in His personal ministry on earth, Rom. 15:8. In Acts 1:1 we read that He continued in Acts what He began to do and to teach in

the Gospels. All through Acts we distinguish Jew and Gentile, such distinction is not recognized in the Body of Christ. Paul has here a Jewish and a Roman citizenship while in Phil. 3:20 he has only one citizenship in heaven. All the Jewish miracles are found in Acts. Further the law, the temple, the sabbaths, the synagogues, the bloody sacrifices, the rituals, the feasts, the fasts, the angels, the tongues, the mass healings, prophets, prophecies, fulfillments, prophetic types, symbols, and actions, and it was in these Jewish acts that the baptisms were in their proper place when we remember that they were nothing but the Levitical purifications. Jerusalem was still the center of authority.

6. The patent fact is that these signs did follow the believers in the Acts period A.D. 33-63 and that they do not follow the believers in this age. All modern miracles prove to be counterfeit miracles when compared with those of Acts. If we claim that they now follow all believers and must follow all true believers we must be consistent and accept the whole Pentecostal program, including even the raisings from the dead.

7. The fact is they stood together all through Acts and they ended together after Acts 28, because after Israel was there put under the judgment of blindness, we never find either any water baptism or any signs and wonders. God's acts speak as loudly as His words.

8. The Body of Christ was formed by the instrumentality of the cross, Eph. 2:16; Acts 20:28 and not before or after. At the Jewish feast of Pentecost the early rain of the Spirit came upon the men of Israel as we read three times, and hence we find many of the Jewish signs. There was an *ecclesia*, an elect group of people at Pentecost, but the Body made by the cross was still not revealed. In that mystical Body are no Jews or any other nationalities as separate units such as we find in the ecclesia of the Acts.

9. The *ecclesia* of Acts 2:47 consists of believing Jews and Jewish proselytes only, whereas in the Body of the mystery there are no nationalities or signs. When Paul speaks of "the *ecclesia*, which is His Body," then this clearly implies that there was an *ecclesia*, which was not His Body. There is for this age one Body, just as there is one Gospel of Grace, but in that transitional period there was an *ecclesia*, or group of Jewish believers who did not follow the whole law, and an *ecclesia*, or group of Gentile believers who did not follow the law. In Gal. 2:7-9 we see that each of these two groups had different leaders and two different gospels. that of the circumcision and un-circumcision. These two groups were even then one in the crucified and risen Christ. God spoke here again most eloquently through His acts in that the one *ecclesia* had many mighty signs and wonders, while the *ecclesia*, which is His Body, is entirely signless. The believing Jews in that day did not only follow the circumcision and the "divers baptisms" of the law, but the whole ceremonial law in all its details. As soon as we admit that there was an *ecclesia* at Pentecost which was not the Church which is His Body, we have conceded that there are two *ecclesias*.

10. The mystery of the Body was hid from *all ages* and hence before Paul, to whom it was revealed, not one of the Prophets could have known it. It is said also to have been hid from *all generations,* and hence even the generation of Christ during the period of the four Gospels could not know it. It is also said to have been hid *in God,* and hence no man or angel could know it, unless God was pleased to reveal it through His Holy Spirit who alone knows and searches the depths of God. Whatever was foretold by the ancient

Prophets could in no sense be called a mystery, since it was a revelation. The word *mystery* means that it was not found in the Old Testament.

The real burden of proof lies, however, not upon those who have obeyed God and have left behind the doctrine of baptisms and are cleaving to the one baptism of Eph. 4:5, but upon those who have disobeyed God on these important matters. They need to produce a lot of proof why they as baptized together with us into Christ and buried, and risen together with Him and us, still cling to the Talmudic rites, and want to be buried under the waters of death.

All the brethren who of late have written in defense of water baptism as Ironside, Haldeman, Jennings, Bloore, Rice, Pollock, Bol, and others have studiously avoided the heart of the matter, the baptism, or submerging *into* Jesus Christ. According to Rom. 6:3 all believers should know this grand and glorious baptism, and instead of helping the believers to get this much needed knowledge, they have hindered them, though of course unintentionally.

CHAPTER XXVII

Baptism and the Various Translations of the Bible

Baptist scholars generally are not satisfied with the A. V. nor with any version that does not definitely bring out the immersion idea. This dissatisfaction has even led to several immersionist versions, in which John the Baptist becomes John the Immerser. It is nevertheless wise on the part of the translators that they commonly transliterated the baptismal words, for a sectarian translation would have made the Bible itself partly sectarian. As it is, its foes call it a sectarian book and with this stigmatizing of the Bible as sectarian they try to keep it from all public schools. The Talmud, the Koran, and the Book of Mormon are sectarian, but not the divine Book that led to the building of this great Republic. Yet as soon as we render *baptizo* by immerse, we have made the Bible sectarian and Baptistic. If however, we are not satisfied with a transliteration of this word and are bent upon a translation, then we are duty bound before God and men to give a correct rendering of its exact meaning, and even so we are to differentiate between the Old Testament meaning of *purifying by sprinkling or pouring* and the exact Pauline idea of *submersion into Christ.* There is not one version from the Apostolic times that has ever rendered *wash by immerse.* Up to the time of the Reformation, and even up to our present times, there is not a reliable version, made from the Hebrew and Greek, that supports a single case of real immersion of one person by another. Beza left immersion out of his Latin New Testament. It simply cannot honestly be put in. On the other hand every scientific version supports aspersion and affusion, The King James translators were all obsessed with the ancient Roman notion, that immersion was the common practice of the Apostolic church. Nearly all Paedo-baptist theologians of note still are of the opinion that the primitive Christians practiced baptism by immersion. Prof. Van Oosterzee, Kuyper, Bavinck, Vos, Heins, Warfield and a host of commentators favored that idea. Many who believe this nevertheless do not practice immersion, since they do not deem this mode of administration important or binding. This Romanistic opinion, though honestly held, has had its effect upon the translation of our A. V. (our authorized version) to this extent that where the original would allow two renderings, they uniformly gave the translation that favored immersion, so that even the strong immersionist Dr. Alex Campbell remarks that they never "favored the innovation of sprinkling by any rendering or marginal note," and Dr. Conant, the greatest Baptist scholar of his day, says the same thing.

Notwithstanding all this, these King James translators of our Bible have been charged with a hiding of the facts of immersion and of making a Paedobaptist translation; but the translators could not help it that they found an abundance of sprinkling and pouring and not a single case of immersion. Where the word *immerse* does not occur one single time, the word *sprinkle* appears in various forms more than 60 times in the Bible and *pour,* and its cognates about 150 times. But suppose that immersion were in a passage like Matt. 28:19. a putting into the name of the Triune God, then consequently the word *emerse* must signify likewise, the coming out of the name of the triune God and therefore completely nullify this whole baptism at once.

Though half of the famed scholars of the Westminster Assembly in 1643 believed, on historical grounds, in dipping as well as in sprinkling and pouring, they nevertheless on Scriptural grounds did not permit it even as an allowable mode, and by majority vote it was left out.

CHAPTER XXVIII

The Baptism of the Passage Through the Red Sea

A nation of three million marched through the Red Sea, Ex. 14:15-31 and were initiated, incorporated into Moses' leadership. For such a host to have crossed the sea so quickly there must have been a very broad phalanx miles in width, for it was only in the morning-watch when Pharaoh and his hosts were submerged, or baptized in the Pauline sense of the term. The special pillar cloud did not hover over the Israelites, but was behind them as their rear guard, dividing them from the Egyptians. However, from Ps. 77:17-20 we know that there were other clouds over them, and we read that these clouds *poured out water* upon the Israelites. Hence the Lord was the great Baptizer from heaven. The baptismal service was a solemn one with the voice of thunder from heaven. In the course of history Israel never forgot this solemn national baptism, because two thousand years later Josephus wrote in his Antiquities of it in these words: "Showers of rain also came down from the sky, and dreadful thunder and lightning, with flashes of fire." And note this tremendous and solemn baptism of the Lord was not by immersion but by pouring out the water upon them. And the water was not only poured upon believers, but also upon unbelievers and upon the infants. It was a national baptism by sprinkling.